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2020 阅读大赛决赛 (2020 年 12 月 13 日)

Directions : In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Questions 1-3 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the introductions and match them with the authors. Please note there are two extra options you do not need.

- A. Edith Wharton
- B. James Joyce
- C. Thomas Hardy
- D. Henry James
- E. Emily Brontë

1.

The author's last work of fiction, also one of his most gloomily fatalistic, depicts the lives of individuals who are trapped by forces beyond their control. Its protagonist, Jude Fawley, is a working-class young man, a stonemason, who dreams of becoming a scholar. C

答案 : C

2.

Published in 1847, the year before the author's death at age thirty, the novel is one of the nineteenth century's most popular yet disturbing masterpieces and

perhaps the most haunting and tormented love story ever written. The windswept moors are the unforgettable setting of this tale of the love between a troubled orphan and his wealthy benefactor's daughter, Catherine. E

答案 : E

3.

The novel was first published in book form in 1922. Stylistically dense and exhilarating, it is generally regarded as a masterpiece and has been the subject of numerous volumes of commentary and analysis. The novel is constructed as a modern parallel to Homer's *Odyssey*. All the action in the novel takes place in and immediately around Dublin on a single day (June 16, 1904). B

答案 : B

Question 4 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Last year was the first in which low-carbon sources of electricity eclipsed those based on fossil fuels burned in the UK. Wind, solar, nuclear power and imports supplied 48.5 percent of electricity, while 43 percent came from UK coal and gas power plants. In 1990, three-quarters of power in the UK came from fossil fuels.

4. Which is the best title for the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) UK electric power going green ✓
- B) Use of fossil fuels in the UK going down
- C) Renewable energy booming in the UK
- D) Reduction of carbon emissions in the UK

原始的选项顺序

- A) UK electric power going green ✓
- B) Renewable energy booming in the UK
- C) Reduction of carbon emissions in the UK
- D) Use of fossil fuels in the UK going down

Question 5 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

The level of out-of-class reading required in college can be pretty intense. If you are new to college, your reading load is likely to be significantly higher than what you experienced in high school; if you're a senior in college, the level seems to go up each year. Regardless of your specific situation, _____.

Fortunately, there is no one right way to stay on track with your reading. A manageable solution comes from finding something that works for your own learning style—and realizing that being flexible is part of any long-term solution.

5. Which of the following best fits in the blank in the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) it is quite essential to foster a good reading habit when you enter college
- B) there is no doubt that reading ability plays a dominant role in learning
- C) knowing how to keep up with college reading can be a serious challenge ✓
- D) you have to complete your reading assignments as effectively as possible

原始的选项顺序

- A) there is no doubt that reading ability plays a dominant role in learning
- B) knowing how to keep up with college reading can be a serious challenge ✓
- C) you have to complete your reading assignments as effectively as possible
- D) it is quite essential to foster a good reading habit when you enter college

Question 6 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Nobody likes a snorer. Well, perhaps that's too harsh. People who have to sleep in the same general vicinity of snorers aren't particularly fond of those who saw logs as they drift away in gentle slumber. It's not the most pleasant

noise in the world. Especially if you are trying to sleep while a deep and resonant snore is blasting off near your soft and sensitive little ears. Fortunately, there are many sleep solutions out there designed to help ease the burden of anyone born with the dreaded snore gene. But these solutions aren't just limited to masks and devices. Nope, sometimes even changing your pillow can be enough to help with snoring.

6. What can be inferred from the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) The problem of habitual snoring is correlated with a certain biological gene.
- B) The purpose of this text is to promote products that can help stop snoring.
- C) The author doesn't think it's right to make noises when people are sleeping.
- D) The underlined expression "saw logs" refers to people's behavior of snoring. ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) The author doesn't think it's right to make noises when

people are sleeping.

B) The purpose of this text is to promote products that can help stop snoring.

C) The underlined expression “saw logs” refers to people’s behavior of snoring. ✓

D) The problem of habitual snoring is correlated with a certain biological gene.

Question 7 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

U.S. National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration’s National Hurricane Center does not control the naming of tropical storms. Instead, there is a strict procedure established by the World Meteorological Organization. ① In the event that more than twenty-one named tropical cyclones occur in a season, any additional storms will take names from the Greek alphabet. ② For Atlantic hurricanes, there is a list of male and female names which are used on a six-year rotation. ③ The only time that there is a change is if a storm is so deadly or costly that the future use of its name on a different storm would be inappropriate.

7. What is the right order of the numbered sentences?

考试时的选项顺序

A) ②③① ✓ B) ③①② C) ③②① D) ②①③

原始的选项顺序

A) ③②① B) ②①③ C) ③①② **D) ②③① ✓**

Question 8 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Confidence levels can be consistent within groups and populations: Contrast the humility and self-deprecation widespread among *!Kung hunter-gatherers, for example, with the “culture of arrogance” that led the Enron corporation to bankruptcy.

A research team wondered why overconfidence in particular manifests in social clusters. One reason, documented in six experiments, is that it appears to be contagious. In the first experiment, 104 undergraduate students were randomly partnered up after individually completing a computer task and rating their confidence in their performance. Each pair collaborated on an extension of the task, after which participants revised their assessment of their individual performance. The researchers found that working with partners who were overconfident (their self-assessments were not borne out by their actual scores) caused subjects to become more overconfident themselves. Subsequent experiments showed that the effect persisted over time and across varying tasks; it also occurred across indirect social ties and when subjects knew their partner’s confidence was unjustified.

*!Kung: a group of the San people of Southern Africa

8. What is this text mainly about?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) The manifestation of overconfidence in social clusters.
- B) The relation of overconfidence to one's performance.
- C) The social transmission of overconfidence. ✓
- D) The possible trouble with overconfidence.

原始的选项顺序

- A) The social transmission of overconfidence. ✓
- B) The possible trouble with overconfidence.
- C) The relation of overconfidence to one's performance.
- D) The manifestation of overconfidence in social clusters.

Question 9 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Intensification of smog episodes, following harvesting of paddy crops in agricultural plains of the Indus basin in the Indian subcontinent, are often attributed to farming practice of burning standing stubble during late autumn (October, November) months. Biomass burning (paddy stubble residual) is a preferred technique to clear farmlands for centuries by farmers in that basin. However, despite stable agricultural landholding and yield, smog is being increasingly associated with burning agricultural biomass, thus creating a paradox. Here, we show that the concentration of smog (NO_x, PM_{2.5}, SO₂) in

the ambient air exceeds the safe threshold limits throughout the entire year in the region. This study argues that agricultural biomass burning is an ephemeral event in the basin that may act as a catalyst for deteriorated air quality in the entire region. Results further demonstrate that simultaneous saturation of air pollutants, along with high ambient moisture content and low wind speeds following the monsoon season, are strongly related to aggravated smog events. Findings from this study should help make holistic mitigation and intervention policies to monitor air quality for sustainability of public health in agricultural regions where farming activities are a dominant economic driver for society.

9. Which of the following statements is true about the Indus basin according to the text?

考试时的选项顺序

A) The study was to assess the relation of burning agricultural biomass with smog episodes. ✓

B) A steady increase of farmlands and crop yield further intensifies smog episodes.

C) It is found that the primary source for smog is the conventional practice of biomass burning.

D) Biomass burning is a unique technique used to clear farmlands for centuries by farmers.

原始的选项顺序

A) A steady increase of farmlands and crop yield further intensifies smog episodes.

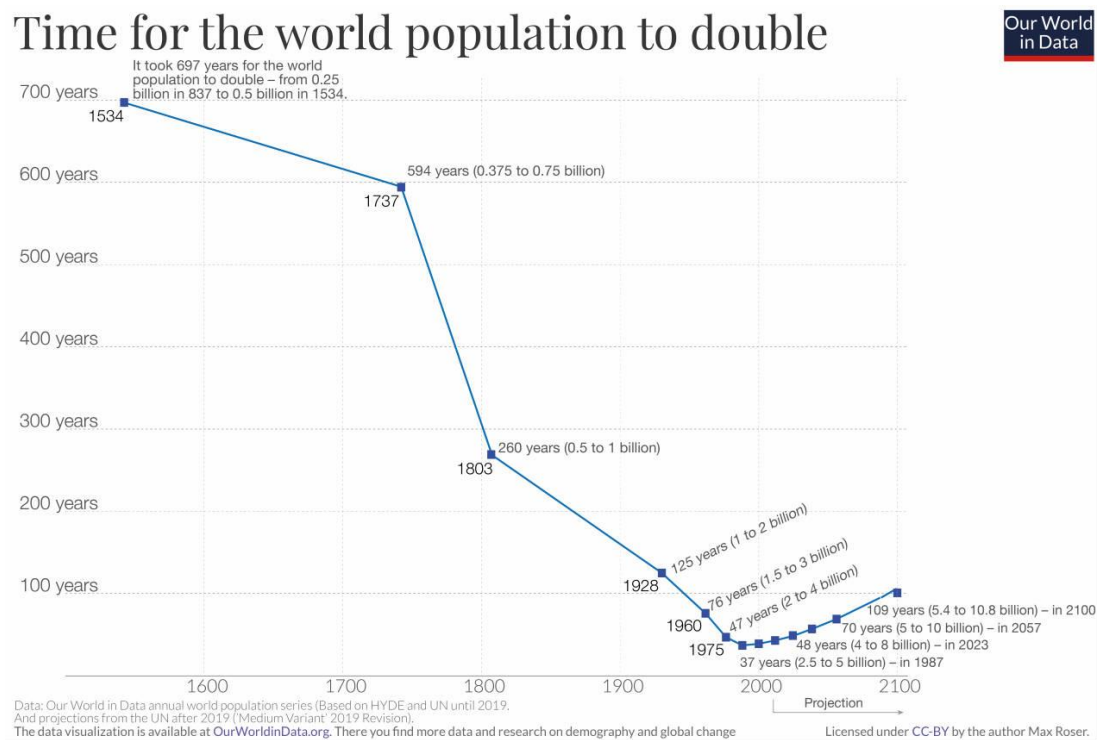
B) Biomass burning is a unique technique used to clear farmlands for centuries by farmers.

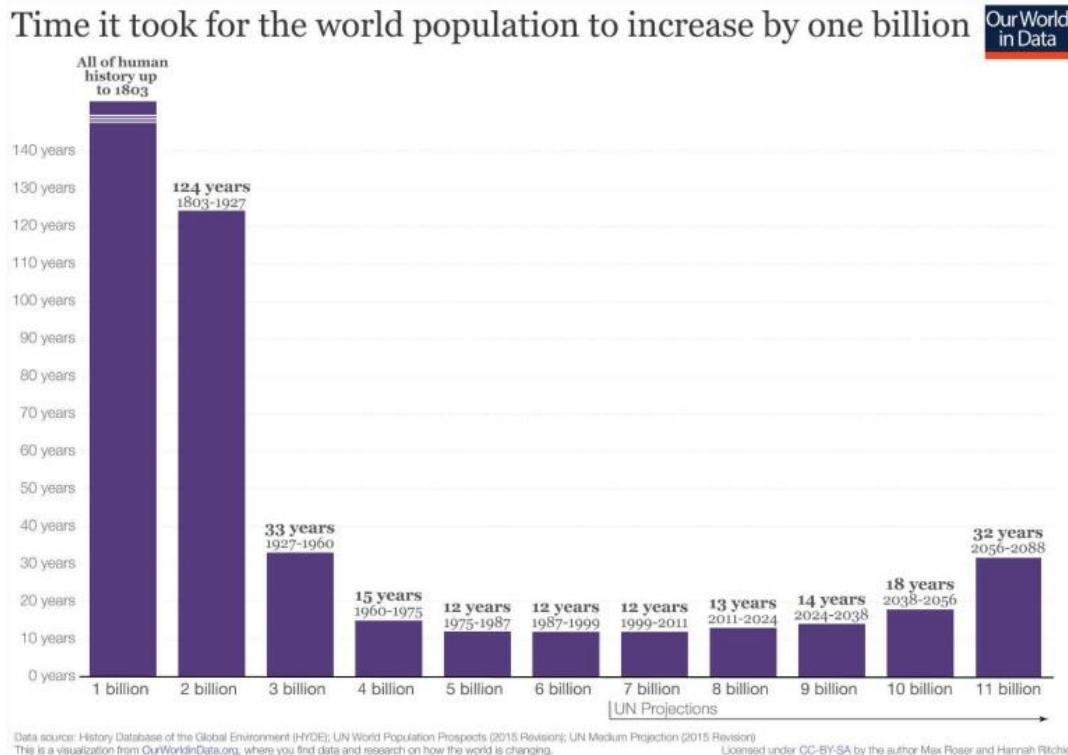
C) The study was to assess the relation of burning agricultural biomass with smog episodes. ✓

D) It is found that the primary source for smog is the conventional practice of biomass burning.

Question 10 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Study the following two graphs and answer the question according to the information provided in them.





10. Which of the following is INCORRECT according to the graphs?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) The world has now surpassed its peak rate of growth, and the intervals between billions are expected to go longer.
- B) Since 1987, the global population growth rate has been slowing, and along with it the doubling time is increasing.
- C) The world population increased steadily from 1975 to 2011, with 12 years for it to increase by one billion on average.
- D) As the global population growth rate was climbing before the late 20th century, the population doubling time rose to the

highest point. ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) Since 1987, the global population growth rate has been slowing, and along with it the doubling time is increasing.
- B) The world has now surpassed its peak rate of growth, and the intervals between billions are expected to go longer.
- C) As the global population growth rate was climbing before the late 20th century, the population doubling time rose to the highest point. ✓
- D) The world population increased steadily from 1975 to 2011, with 12 years for it to increase by one billion on average.

Directions : In Part II, you will read short texts on different subjects. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 55 minutes)

Question 11 (Suggested completion time: 4 minutes)

Directions: Look at the cartoon of a logical fallacy and answer the question according to the cartoon.



11. Which of the following statements demonstrates the same fallacy as the cartoon does?

考试时的选项顺序

A) How can you accuse me of stealing a donut? You take food from the cafeteria all the time!

B) He is a convicted felon. You can't believe a thing he says.
I don't believe he is innocent of his crime, despite the evidence.

C) You think we should get more women into science? You only say that because you are a woman yourself, so it must

be false. ✓

D) Voting for Paul Blank will lead to increases in property taxes, a slowdown in the economy, and loss of jobs in the area.

原始的选项顺序

A) How can you accuse me of stealing a donut? You take food from the cafeteria all the time!

B) Voting for Paul Blank will lead to increases in property taxes, a slowdown in the economy, and loss of jobs in the area.

C) He is a convicted felon. You can't believe a thing he says. I don't believe he is innocent of his crime, despite the evidence.

D) You think we should get more women into science? You only say that because you are a woman yourself, so it must be false. ✓

Question 12 (Suggested completion time: 4 minutes)

Directions: Read the following example of a logical fallacy and answer the question according to the example.

"I think it is agreed by all parties, that this prodigious number of children in the arms, or on the backs, or at the heels of their mothers,

and frequently of their fathers, is in the present deplorable state of the kingdom a very great additional grievance; and, therefore, whoever could find out a fair, cheap and easy method of making these children sound and useful members of the common-wealth, would deserve so well of the public, as to have his statue set up for a preserver of the nation.”

—*A Modest Proposal* (By Jonathan Swift)

12. Which of the following logical fallacies does the text illustrate?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) **Hasty Generalization:** It occurs when someone makes a general statement based on an insufficient or nonrepresentative sample, rather than looking at a broader range of available data.
- B) **Chronological Snobbery:** It considers modern ideas superior to those from earlier ages. This fallacy specifically targets ideas from art, culture, science, and philosophy.
- C) **Guilt by Association:** It occurs when someone connects an opponent to a demonized group of people or to a bad person in order to discredit his or her argument. The idea is that the person is “guilty” by simply being similar to this “bad” group and, therefore, should not be listened to about

anything.

D) **Reductio Ad Absurdum:** It is in logic, a form of refutation showing contradictory or absurd consequences following upon premises as a matter of logical necessity. Actually, it is a method of refuting a claim by extending the logic of the opponent's argument to a point of absurdity. ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) **Hasty Generalization:** It occurs when someone makes a general statement based on an insufficient or nonrepresentative sample, rather than looking at a broader range of available data.

B) **Chronological Snobbery:** It considers modern ideas superior to those from earlier ages. This fallacy specifically targets ideas from art, culture, science, and philosophy.

C) **Reductio Ad Absurdum:** It is in logic, a form of refutation showing contradictory or absurd consequences following upon premises as a matter of logical necessity. Actually, it is a method of refuting a claim by extending the logic of the opponent's argument to a point of absurdity. ✓

D) **Guilt by Association:** It occurs when someone connects an opponent to a demonized group of people or to a bad

person in order to discredit his or her argument. The idea is that the person is “guilty” by simply being similar to this “bad” group and, therefore, should not be listened to about anything.

Questions 13-14 Reasoning (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

13.

The Law of Demand, an essential rule in economics, states that the quantity demanded for a good or service rises as the price falls. Similarly, the quantity demanded should fall with a rise in price. However, when the price of bread went up in the early 19th century in Britain, the low-paid workers purchased more bread and not less of it.

Which of the following may best explain the apparent paradox given in the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) The quality and variety of bread improved as its price went up, thereby attracting more people to consume it.
- B) The price of bread went up too slowly for most consumers to realize the price differences within a short period of time.
- C) Out of the apprehension that the prices might still go up, the British workers chose to buy more bread in advance to store it.

D) When the bread price rose, the British workers, unable to afford meat, substituted bread for meat to maintain their food intake. ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) When the bread price rose, the British workers, unable to afford meat, substituted bread for meat to maintain their food intake. ✓

B) The quality and variety of bread improved as its price went up, thereby attracting more people to consume it.

C) The price of bread went up too slowly for most consumers to realize the price differences within a short period of time.

D) Out of the apprehension that the prices might still go up, the British workers chose to buy more bread in advance to store it.

14.

In the 1860s, the British government contracted with ship captains regarding the transportation of some of its prisoners to Australia. Unfortunately, the survival rate of the prisoners shipped to Australia was only 40%. Humanitarian groups, the church, and governmental agencies appealed to the captains on moral grounds to improve the survival rate with more decent treatment. Despite these appeals, the

survival rate remained at 40%. Nothing changed until a few years later, when the survival rate of the prisoners increased to over 98%.

Which of the following, if true, is the weakest evidence for the increase in the survival rate of the prisoners?

考试时的选项顺序

A) The government raised funds to provide better food and sanitation for the prisoners.

B) The government reduced the number of prisoners who were packed onto the ships. ✓

C) The government imposed a fine on the captains for the low survival rate of the prisoners.

D) The government paid the captains a fee for every living prisoner who got off the ship.

原始的选项顺序

A) The government imposed a fine on the captains for the low survival rate of the prisoners.

B) The government raised funds to provide better food and sanitation for the prisoners.

C) The government paid the captains a fee for every living prisoner who got off the ship.

D) The government reduced the number of prisoners who
were packed onto the ships. ✓

Questions 15-16 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

When consumers slam companies in ways that are obviously undeserved (“More like ‘Mediocre Canyon,’” complained one unhappy visitor to Grand Canyon National Park), brand managers may try to suppress the review, publicly shame the reviewer, or even sue. A series of new studies suggest that _____15_____.

In one experiment, the researchers randomly assigned 223 graduate students to read one of three reviews of a reusable-water-bottle company before indicating their purchase intent. In the positive review, a customer described getting an answer to a customer service query within 24 hours. In the fair negative review, the customer described having to wait two weeks. In the unfair negative review, the customer complained about not getting through on Christmas Eve. Subjects who read the unfair negative review were just as likely to say they would buy from the company as were subjects who read the positive review. Subsequent experiments found that at very high levels of unfairness, negative reviews actually generated greater purchase intent than did positive reviews.

Surveys of participants showed that these dynamics were driven by empathy. According to the “just world” theory, _____16_____.

Consequently, “firms may want to highlight unfair negative reviews and strategically leverage their positive downstream consequences,” the researchers write—and indeed, organizations including the Snowbird ski resort and the Vienna Tourist Board have used such material in ad campaigns. Brand managers can apply the findings even when critical reviews are justified, the researchers note: “Creating employee-focused narratives as a form of firm communication ... or even responding to reviews in a way that is more personal ... enhances empathetic responding on the part of consumers and protects the firm against the potentially adverse impacts of negative reviews.”

15. Which of the following statements best fits in the blank in the first paragraph?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) though ignoring consumers' critical reviews, they can still gain excess benefit
- B) consumers' negative reviews do not necessarily impact their purchase intention
- C) most of the complaints of their consumers are actually specious and groundless
- D) by taking a different tack, they can turn such broadsides to their advantage ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) though ignoring consumers' critical reviews, they can still gain excess benefit

B) by taking a different tack, they can turn such broadsides to their advantage ✓

C) most of the complaints of their consumers are actually specious and groundless

D) consumers' negative reviews do not necessarily impact their purchase intention

16. Which of the following statements best fits in the blank in the third paragraph?

考试时的选项顺序

A) it is usually undesirable to get what one wants by walking over other people in an ideal world

B) people tend to refuse to accept that bad things can happen to themselves due to circumstances beyond control

C) it is necessary for companies to show concern for their staff who receive unfair criticism from their customers

D) people often try to restore fairness when they observe someone being treated in an obviously unfair way ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) it is usually undesirable to get what one wants by walking over other people in an ideal world

B) it is necessary for companies to show concern for their staff who receive unfair criticism from their customers

C) people often try to restore fairness when they observe someone being treated in an obviously unfair way ✓

D) people tend to refuse to accept that bad things can happen to themselves due to circumstances beyond control

Questions 17-19 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

Ahead of GCSE (General Certificate of Secondary Education) results on Thursday, the government has announced all A-level and GCSE marks will be based on teacher assessments rather than on the controversial algorithm. It is a welcome U-turn, although it does little to address the underlying issue. This was always a clear-cut matter of class: Private schools uniquely benefited from the statistical model used to replace A-levels last week, increasing the proportion of students achieving top grades—A* and A—twice as much as pupils at comprehensives.

You only have to see the heartbroken teenagers posting on social media to understand the pain of these past few days: Working-class young people had their dream future in front of them only to lose it because they live in the wrong postcode. These pupils deserved justice. The government is right to fix the

system in England but it would be a mistake to treat this debacle as a one-off mistake that can be solved with a better grade calculator. The scandal is simply a blown-up version of the reality we've long known: Working-class kids work hard and too often get tossed away, while private-school families buy their way in.

In the year before the pandemic, the Sutton Trust found that independent school pupils were seven times more likely to gain a place at Oxford or Cambridge than those in non-selective state schools, and were more than twice as likely to take a place at Russell Group institutions. In 2018, another study found almost half of "clever but disadvantaged" students failed to secure top GCSE grades. Just 52% of the disadvantaged high achievers at primary school gained at least five A* and A grades in England, compared with 72% of their wealthier, equally clever, peers.

Far from being wrong, the infamous algorithm in many ways succeeded in replicating the socio-economic bias that has plagued the education system for centuries. Or to put it another way: The educational inequality laid bare by the government's incompetence is not a shock. It is business as usual.

Just look at how the exam crisis is being discussed. The focus in much of the media has been on A* students missing out on a place at Oxbridge (perhaps in part because much of the media followed this route themselves) with barely any attention on working-class teenagers who hoped to go straight into employment or on the fact that the proportion of people awarded grade C and

above fell most in deprived areas. Even the supposedly comforting claim that “exams don’t matter” is steeped in privilege. It is easy to say grades are irrelevant if you have parents with connections and a flat in London, but considerably harder if you’re at your local comp in a low-income town.

17. What is the author’s attitude toward canceling the algorithm as a way to calculate A-level and GCSE grades?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Enthusiastic support. B) Slight contempt.
C) Reserved consent. ✓ D) Strong disapproval.

原始的选项顺序

- A) Slight contempt. B) Strong disapproval.
C) Reserved consent. ✓ D) Enthusiastic support.
-

18. According to the author, what problem does the debate aroused by the algorithm mainly reflect?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) The government remains characterized by bureaucratic inefficiency and incompetence.
B) It is unfair for students to get their grades depending on the area they live in.
C) The phenomenon of inequality is still commonplace in the

educational system. ✓

D) Assessment in education is a very complicated issue involving every student's interests.

原始的选项顺序

A) The phenomenon of inequality is still commonplace in the educational system. ✓

B) It is unfair for students to get their grades depending on the area they live in.

C) The government remains characterized by bureaucratic inefficiency and incompetence.

D) Assessment in education is a very complicated issue involving every student's interests.

19. Which of the following statements best summarizes the text?

考试时的选项顺序

A) The flip-flop of government's education policy is what undermines its credibility.

B) There is no easy solution to the underlying issue facing England's education system.

C) There is a gap between the ideal of equal opportunity for all students and reality.

D) The real problem is that England's education system heavily favours the wealthy. ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) The real problem is that England's education system heavily favours the wealthy. ✓

B) The flip-flop of government's education policy is what undermines its credibility.

C) There is no easy solution to the underlying issue facing England's education system.

D) There is a gap between the ideal of equal opportunity for all students and reality.

Questions 20-22 (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.



Ancient Roman poets emulated their Greek predecessors and mixed music, drama, and verse while creating a large audience for Roman literature. The mercantile Romans also launched the first bookstores, stocking them with hand-printed scrolls or stone-carved tablets. Taking printed poetry beyond the private shelves of rulers and the wealthiest citizens, these stores enabled the general public to read verse and literature for the first time. The buyers of great libraries—such as Alexandria, Ephesus, and Constantinople—hoarded originals and quality copies, so merchants hired scribes to copy Roman and Greek manuscripts and fill the growing public thirst for written material. It was in the best interest of poets to be prolific, as they received percentages of sales, the first known “royalty” arrangement.

The demand for printed poetry—along with the bookstores, many libraries, and countless thousands of scrolls and tablets—went up in flames (literally) when Rome was sacked. The Holy Roman Empire took over and thrust Europe into the Dark Ages. For ten centuries, poetry became an oral tradition used to spread news beneath the ears and eyes of the Church; only in Persia did scribing continue, becoming an art form. The commerce of poetry skidded to a standstill, not to be revived until a confluence of social awakening, intellectual and creative pursuits, and technology changed the world.

As the 15th century Italian Renaissance began to spread to England, France, and Spain, Germany’s Johann Gutenberg created a machine that could reproduce original manuscripts. Gutenberg’s press changed the course of

history, but it was nearly another century before William Shakespeare facilitated the marriage between the printing press and poetry.

Shakespeare, who imbedded his sonnets and verse into theater to redefine drama in the Western world, was perhaps the first to make substantial amounts of money from poetry. As the popularity of verse spilled over to Elizabethan society, countless poets published broadsides—single sheets of paper printed on one side, sold for a pittance—of their sonnets, ballads, and other poems. After reading their works on stage or at public readings, poets sold and distributed their broadsides. Self-published poetry vaulted from the excruciating writing and copying of manuscripts to the formation of a business, fueled by printing presses sprouting up throughout England.

Even five centuries ago, poets understood that simply writing, binding, and publishing poems was a sure road to poverty. Poets became orators, public readers, government advisors, academics, shameless promoters and distributors of their work, and writers for dramatists. All published their own work; some, like William Blake, moved printing presses into their homes to control the entire process. This was no small feat, as printing presses in the late 18th century were the size of small bedrooms and reached from floor to ceiling. By the 19th century, the road to achieving success in poetry looked much as it does now.

20. Decide whether the following statement is True or False according to the text.

The first bookstores launched by the Romans helped enhance the popularity of printed poetry among the governing classes and the rich people.

- A) True B) False ✓

答案 : B

21. What can we learn about poetry in the Dark Ages?

- A) The oral tradition of poetry reached its full development.
- B) The general public was denied access again to printed poetry.
- C) The trade of poetry stagnated for a very long period of time. ✓
- D) Poetry became an art form in Persia supported by the Church.

答案 : C

22. What can we learn from the last three paragraphs?

- A) Shakespeare earned more money from poetry than from drama.
- B) William Blake once helped improve printing presses in his home.
- C) Gutenberg's press promoted the spread of poetry soon after its creation.

D) Poets centuries ago found it hard to make a living as a professional poet. ✓

答案 : D

Questions 23-26 (Suggested completion time: 9 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

It may be just 21 years old, but Google is in the midst of a midlife crisis. As so often in such cases, _____23_____. Every day its search engine handles 6bn requests, YouTube receives 49 years' worth of video uploads and Gmail processes about 100bn emails. Thanks to its dominance of online advertising, Google's parent company, Alphabet, made a profit of \$34bn last year. Beyond its core operations, it is a world leader in artificial intelligence (AI), quantum computing and self-driving cars. Along with the bosses of Amazon, Apple and Facebook, its chief executive, Sundar Pichai, was grilled by lawmakers in Washington, DC, who fret that America's tech giants need to be restrained because they are so profitable. Crisis? What crisis?

Being hauled before Congress is, on the face of it, a sign of success. But it also marks a difficult moment for Google's leaders: the onset of corporate middle age. This is a problem as old as business itself. How do companies sustain the creativity and agility that made them great, even as they forge a culture and corporate machine that is built to last? For Google the transition is especially dramatic because its founders, Larry Page and Sergey Brin, tried from the start to build a firm in which this moment would never arrive. As

Google prepared to go public in 2004 they declared that it was not a conventional company, and “we do not intend to become one”. They hoped playground-like offices, generous perks and a campus atmosphere would allow it to retain the agility and innovation of a startup as it grew. The appearance of wrinkles on the corporate forehead is an admission of failure.

The signs of ageing are apparent in Google’s maturing business, its changing culture and its ever-more-entwined relationship with government. Take the business first. The firm is running up against growth constraints in its near-monopolies of search and online-advertising tools. Its market share in search ads is around 90%. Unearthing other gold mines has proved difficult. None of the ambitious “moonshot” projects into which Alphabet has poured billions, such as delivery drones and robots, has been a breakout success. To keep growing, Google is having to try to muscle in on the turf occupied by big tech rivals, such as cloud computing and enterprise software and services.

The cultural challenge is fuzzier but no less urgent for a firm that is proud of its unusual corporate character. The freewheeling ethos that was so successful in Google’s early days has become a *liability*. It works much less well at scale. Google now has nearly 120,000 employees, and even more temporary contractors. Doing things from the bottom up has become harder as the workforce has grown larger and less like-minded, with squabbles breaking out over everything from gender politics and the serving of meat in cafeterias to Google’s sale of technology to police forces.

The third sign of lost youth, the attention of *trustbusters, has long looked inevitable. As big tech has grown, so have its interactions with government—as an institution to lobby, as a customer and as a regulator. America’s Justice Department is poring over Google’s online-ads businesses and may soon file an antitrust suit. Scrutiny is unlikely to wane as the tech titans break out of their silos and compete more. Indeed, regulators may take it as a sign of broadening power.

*trustbuster: a federal official who seeks to dissolve business trusts

23. Which of the following statements best fits in the blank in the first paragraph?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) faint signs of decline appear
- B) things are much better than imagined
- C) all seems well on the surface ✓
- D) almost no hard evidence can be found

原始的选项顺序

- A) faint signs of decline appear
- B) all seems well on the surface ✓
- C) almost no hard evidence can be found
- D) things are much better than imagined

24. What challenge has Google confronted since its establishment according to the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) How to meet the changing culture.
- B) How to sustain its competitive edge.
- C) How to unite its diverse workforce.
- D) How to stay creative and responsive. ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) How to sustain its competitive edge.
- B) How to unite its diverse workforce.
- C) How to stay creative and responsive. ✓
- D) How to meet the changing culture.

25. What does the word *liability* probably mean in Paragraph 4?

考试时的选项顺序

- | | |
|-------------------|-------------------|
| A) valuable asset | B) responsibility |
| C) handicap ✓ | D) hideous guilt |

原始的选项顺序

- | | |
|------------------|-------------------|
| A) handicap ✓ | B) responsibility |
| C) hideous guilt | D) valuable asset |

26. What can we learn about Google?

考试时的选项顺序

A) It is both a customer and regulator when dealing with the government.

B) Its revenue is mainly from ads, followed by delivery drones and robots.

C) Its pursuit of being an unconventional corporation proves to be a failure. ✓

D) It is a sign of full success to be invited to the U.S. Congress as a guest.

原始的选项顺序

A) It is a sign of full success to be invited to the U.S. Congress as a guest.

B) Its revenue is mainly from ads, followed by delivery drones and robots.

C) It is both a customer and regulator when dealing with the government.

D) Its pursuit of being an unconventional corporation proves to be a failure. ✓

Questions 27-30 (Suggested completion time: 9 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

Philosophers as far back as Plato have defined knowledge as “justified true belief (JTB).” However, skeptics and Pyrrhonists (绝对怀疑论者) have challenged this notion for centuries, reasoning that the same evidence that one person considers valid in justifying a belief as “true,” another may consider biased or incomplete.

Against this backdrop, Enlightenment-era thinkers, including René Descartes and Charles Sanders Pierce, have promoted the scientific method as the best means for acquiring *justifiable* evidence to establish *beliefs* as *true* knowledge. In his influential 1877 essay, “The Fixation of Belief”, Pierce extolled the virtues of the scientific method over other means of knowing, including blindly accepting facts from authority figures and reliance on pure reasoning to establish knowledge, without testing one’s conclusions in the real world.

① Indeed, the scientific method, with its insistence on direct observation and —
the objective testing of hypotheses, has been a major advance for our civilization, allowing us to catapult over superstitions and other belief systems that were either invalid or unreliable. Furthermore, it is still the best system for helping our species progressively advance toward truth. However, the scientific method, if not the entire scientific process, is not without its limitations in its ability to yield *justifiable* evidence to establish knowledge.

② Over the past decade, we have learned that many of the scientific findings we have taken as fact have been retracted, either due to error or fraud. In the

field of psychology, specifically, we have been coming to terms with our own reckoning, known as the “replication crisis,” since 2011. Though slightly less publicized, a replication crisis in the field of neuroradiology may end up having more serious consequences. In 2016, researchers from Sweden discovered a statistical anomaly that likely invalidated 40,000 fMRI (Functional magnetic resonance imaging) studies of neurology over a 15-year period.

③ As Bec Crew points out in a summary of Ecklund et al’s findings, “when scientists are interpreting data from an fMRI machine, they’re not looking at the actual brain ... what they’re looking at is an image of the brain divided into tiny ‘voxels’, then interpreted by a computer program.”

④ Indeed, even mathematics, the purest of the STEM disciplines (science, technology, engineering, and math), seems to be suffering from a crisis of confidence, as the validity of countless proofs that form the foundation of modern mathematics has recently been called into question. Mathematician Kevin Buzzard told attendees at a 2019 conference that “the greatest proofs have become so complex that practically no human on earth can understand all of their details, let alone verify them,” and he fears that many proofs widely considered to be true are wrong. In paraphrasing Buzzard, journalist Mordechai Rorvig explains that “new proofs by professional mathematicians tend to rely on a whole host of prior results that have already been published and understood ... but there are many cases where the prior proofs used to build new proofs are clearly not understood.” In philosophy, this is called the

problem of infinite regress: where each current article of knowledge is dependent on some previous article of knowledge that is blindly taken as true or cannot be proven to be true, *ad infinitum*.

27. Which of the following is NOT true about the scientific method according to the text?

A) Justified true beliefs could be recognized as a scientific method to justify claims and conclusions. ✓

B) With scientific methods erroneous data could be duplicated, which causes serious consequences.

C) The scientific method still offers the most reliable way for people to obtain truth and knowledge.

D) A scientific method could be wrong because the validity of countless proofs could not be verified.

答案 : A

28. Where would the following sentence best fit in the numbered spaces?

Part of the problem with science is that as we try to study more sophisticated phenomena, we need more sophisticated equipment, which removes us further and further from direct observation and requires that we place our scientific *faith* in machines and other people's work.

A) ① B) ② C) ③ ✓ D) ④

答案 : C

29. What does *ad infinitum* probably mean in the last paragraph?

- A) off and on B) again and again ✓
C) in all circumstances D) in a meticulous manner

答案 : B

30. What does the author mainly talk about in the text?

- A) What the “justified true belief” really means.
B) How our confidence in knowledge was eroded.
C) The benefits and limitations of a scientific approach. ✓
D) The subjectivity of knowledge in scientific experiments.

答案 : C

Directions : In Part III, you will read passages on the same subject. You will be required to identify the writers’ positions and evaluate the effectiveness of the writers’ arguments. (Time allowed: 35 minutes)

Questions 31-40 (Suggested completion time: 35 minutes)

Directions: Read the three passages about consumption. Answer the questions according to the passages.

Passage A

Do your clothes make you happy? Or, after the excitement of the shopping spree fades, does your new stuff tend to lose its in-store magic by the time it

has reached your wardrobe?

A new survey of international buying habits has found that we buy far more than we need and use. About 60 percent of Chinese and more than half of German and Italian respondents admit they own more than they need. But the mindless overconsumption of fashion has become our cultural norm.

Online shopping fuels this overconsumption. It's easier than ever to buy new clothes by clicking through social media feeds whenever you see something you like. And it's a time-consuming habit: A great many consumers spend at least two hours shopping online every day.

The reasons for this are emotional and social. For many, comfort buys occur when people need to channel their anxieties. Shopping is a way to kill time, relieve stress and avoid boredom. But the cheap thrill of buying something new dies away pretty fast. Half of the people surveyed said that the immediate excitement of a shopping spree lasted less than a day. After the binge comes the hangover.

When they're not shopping, around a third of the East Asian people surveyed admit feeling empty, bored or lost. What's more, around half feel guilty about their shopping habits, sometimes hiding their purchases from others for fear of negative reactions or accusations of wasting money.

_____31_____. We already own too much and we know it.

So why do we shop? We are searching for excitement, looking to increase our self-worth, confidence and recognition. The American media activist and

advertising critic, Jean Kilbourne, has commented about how deeply advertisers insinuate themselves by exploiting basic human desires like friendship, happiness and success in advertising for profit.

The result is “Stuffocation,” a term coined by British cultural forecaster James Wallman. It describes a state where people’s lives are trapped in a vicious cycle of working and accumulating products in order to keep up with the pace of consumerism. This fuels the anxiety of modern life, destroying the planet while keeping us from leading more imaginative, fulfilling lives. Materialism is eating us inside out.

So how do we stop it? Our survey showed that ads, promotions and one-click buying functions are all designed to trigger impulse buying. The more the rate of buying increases, the more companies speed up delivery. Therefore, the slower the buying process, the lower the desire to shop. To break free from the cycle of consumerism, we need to slow down.

Next time you find yourself about to buy something new online, give yourself a few minutes to think. Sleep on it and see if you still want it in the morning. When we switch off our phones and go outside instead of into shopping malls, we won’t buy so much.

The joy of life is ultimately defined by our relationships to each other and the connection we feel to the natural environment. Instead of stuffocating ourselves, let’s enjoy the genuine happiness that stems from leading a fulfilled life.

Passage B

As consumers, we have much more power than we realize. So much, it could be said that every day we vote by what we buy, as if purchasing was a political choice. In what way is this true? Specialized consumer affairs journalist Brenda Chávez, author of the book *Your Consumption Can Change the World*, explains that: “Through our consumption, we are able to reward fair and responsible models of production. Voting is something we do every few years but buying is something we do every day. We give our money to a string of companies and at times this money benefits productive systems which, if we knew what kind of norms they operate by, we would probably think twice about it.”

What is a responsible consumer? Boiling it down, the responsible consumer could be defined as someone who is conscious of their consumption habits and who chooses to have, even demands, a more positive impact on society and the environment from the producers of goods and services. In this way, according to the magazine *Ethical Consumer*, the profile of the responsible consumer is determined by five factors. He or she helps by:

- 1) Reducing consumption
- 2) Being more active
- 3) Consuming local products and contracting local services, as well as secondhand products

4) Keeping and investing their money in an ethical bank

5) Reusing, repairing and recycling

One of the factors that notably influences this kind of responsible consumption is proximity, also called local consumption. It is often heard that local consumption has environmental, social and economic benefits, but what are those benefits? By buying from local producers who respect the environment and labor conditions, why are we supporting sustainable development?

The main environmental benefits of local consumption are energy saving and the reduction of greenhouse gas emissions, given that the means of transporting the products from far-off places generate more emissions.

Likewise, it cuts back on packaging because a product that does not travel so far does not need so much protection. Also, as concerns food, the consumption of seasonal products favors the local economy and reduces imports of products and their corresponding transportation.

Product traceability is much simpler when bought locally than when that product comes from another part of the world. As such, it is much more likely that workers' rights and workplace standards have been respected in its creation, cultivation, production, treatment, transformation, storage, sending, etc.

Consuming local products helps the economy in the area: A euro spent on local products generates double for the local economy. Also, if local producers gain from their work, they will continue to generate wealth and jobs in the

community.

The market also benefits, since it creates a gap for smaller competitors, which results in a better offer and eventual lowering of prices and greater accessibility for users and consumers.

Although the responsibility of achieving a more sustainable world does not fall only on the shoulders of consumers, their role and possibilities for influencing fair and responsible productive models make a big difference in bringing about global sustainable development.

Passage C

In a new study, published in the journal *Young Consumers*, Helm and her collaborators explore how culturally entrenched materialistic values influence pro-environmental behaviors in millennials, who are now the nation's most influential group of consumers.

The researchers focused on two main categories of pro-environmental behaviors: 1) reduced consumption, which includes actions like repairing instead of replacing older items, avoiding impulse purchases and not buying unnecessary items; and 2) "green buying," or purchasing products designed to limit environmental impacts, such as goods made from recycled materials.

The researchers also looked at how engaging in pro-environmental behaviors affects consumer well-being.

More materialistic participants, the researchers found, were unlikely to engage in reduced consumption. However, materialism did not seem to have an effect on their likelihood of practicing “green buying.” That’s probably because “green buying,” unlike reduced consumption, still offers a way for materialists to fulfill their desire to accumulate new items, Helm said.

“There is evidence that there are ‘green materialists,’” said Helm, an associate professor in the Norton School of Family and Consumer Sciences in the College of Agriculture and Life Sciences. “If you are able to buy environmentally friendly products, you can still live your materialist values. You’re acquiring new things, and that fits into our mainstream consumption pattern in our consumer culture, whereas reduced consumption is more novel and probably more important from a sustainability perspective.”

Study participants who reported having fewer materialistic values were much more likely to engage in reduced consumption. Consuming less was, in turn, linked to higher personal well-being and lower psychological distress.

Green buying—which may have some positive environmental implications, although to a lesser degree than reduced consumption—was not found to improve consumer well-being, Helm said.

“We thought it might satisfy people that they participated in being more environmentally conscious through green buying patterns, but it doesn’t seem to be that way,” Helm said. “Reduced consumption has effects on increased well-being and decreased psychological distress, but we don’t see that with

green consumption.”

The take-home message for consumers: “The key is to reduce consumption and not just buy green stuff. Having less and buying less can actually make us more satisfied and happier,” Helm said.

“If you have a lot of stuff, you have a lot on your mind,” she said. “Maybe you have a lot of debt because you bought all that stuff, and now you have to manage all that stuff. It requires maintenance and being organized. It’s not like you buy it and you’re done with it. There are a lot of burdens of ownership, and if you relieve yourself of that burden of ownership, most people report feeling a lot better and freer.”

Helm and her colleagues additionally looked at how materialism affects millennial consumers’ proactive financial behaviors, such as budgeting and saving. Examining financial behaviors alongside pro-environmental behaviors provides a picture of how young adults proactively cope with resource limitations in two contexts: environmental and financial, Helm said.

As expected, Helm and her collaborators found that those who reported having more materialistic values engaged in fewer proactive financial behaviors than their less materialistic counterparts. The researchers also found that, consistent with previous studies, proactive financial behaviors were associated with better personal well-being, life satisfaction and financial satisfaction, as well as lower psychological distress.

“For very obvious reasons, if you have a proactive financial strategy and put money to the side and live within your means, it has positive well-being effects,” Helm said.

The researchers’ findings were based on data from a longitudinal study that followed 968 young adults from their first year of college, when they were between the ages of 18 and 21, to two years post-college, when they were ages 23-26. The participants responded to online survey questions designed to measure materialism, proactive financial behaviors, pro-environmental behaviors, personal well-being, life satisfaction, financial satisfaction and psychological distress.

Understanding how materialistic values impact consumer behaviors, and how those behaviors in turn affect personal and environmental well-being, is important, Helm said. However, she acknowledges that for many consumers, shifting behaviors to be more financially proactive and consume less will be challenging.

“We’ve been told since childhood that there’s a product for everything and it’s OK to buy, and it’s a good thing because that’s how the economy works,” she said. “We’re brought up this way, so changing behaviors is very difficult.”

31. Which of the following best fits in the blank in Passage A?

A) Shopping does not make us happy ✓

B) It is time to break the vicious circle

- C) Shopping drains our money and energy
- D) It is ironic that people are paying to suffer

答案：A

32. According to Passage A, what is the main reason for “Stuffocation”?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Materialism raises more and more worries in modern society.
- B) The buying process has become faster and more convenient.
- C) Advertisers are doing their utmost to trigger more buying.
- D) People are afraid of falling behind in the trend of consumerism. ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) Advertisers are doing their utmost to trigger more buying.
 - B) The buying process has become faster and more convenient.
 - C) Materialism raises more and more worries in modern society.
 - D) People are afraid of falling behind in the trend of consumerism. ✓
-

33. According to Passage B, which of the following is true about responsible consumers?

考试时的选项顺序

A) They advocate a more economical, environmentally friendly way of buying. ✓

B) They prefer purchasing domestic products instead of imported goods.

C) They are as cautious about making choices in buying as they are when voting.

D) They are supposed to influence market supply and demand in a positive way.

原始的选项顺序

A) They are as cautious about making choices in buying as they are when voting.

B) They are supposed to influence market supply and demand in a positive way.

C) They advocate a more economical, environmentally friendly way of buying. ✓

D) They prefer purchasing domestic products instead of imported goods.

34. According to Passage B, what might be the socioeconomic benefits from local consumption?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) The return on investment can be doubled and thus promotes local economy.
- B) Consumers can get local products at a lower price due to packaging cut.
- C) The quality of local products, as well as workers' rights, can be better ensured.
- D) Local consumption can activate the local economy to step into a virtuous cycle. ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) Consumers can get local products at a lower price due to packaging cut.
- B) The return on investment can be doubled and thus promotes local economy.
- C) The quality of local products, as well as workers' rights, can be better ensured.
- D) Local consumption can activate the local economy to step into a virtuous cycle. ✓

35. What is the best title for Passage B?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) The connection between responsible consumption and local consumption
- B) Local consumption—a way of achieving sustainable development
- C) The definition and significance of responsible consumption
- D) Responsible consumption and the benefits of local consumption ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) The definition and significance of responsible consumption
- B) Responsible consumption and the benefits of local consumption ✓
- C) Local consumption—a way of achieving sustainable development
- D) The connection between responsible consumption and local consumption

36. What can be inferred about the materialistic participants mentioned in Passage C?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Green materialists prioritize an environmentally friendly consumption.
- B) They live with their materialistic values that surely lead to overconsumption.
- C) They generally do not practice “green buying,” in fear of reduced consumption.
- D) Their desire to purchase represents the mainstream consumption pattern. ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) They generally do not practice “green buying,” in fear of reduced consumption.
- B) They live with their materialistic values that surely lead to overconsumption.
- C) Their desire to purchase represents the mainstream consumption pattern. ✓
- D) Green materialists prioritize an environmentally friendly consumption.

37. In Passage C, what does Helm’s research about millennial consumers show?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Millennial consumers with less materialistic values tend to be more content. ✓

B) Millennial consumers are environmentally positive in their consuming behaviors.

C) Proactive financial behaviors are uncommon among millennial consumers.

D) There are more millennial consumers who tend to have materialistic values.

原始的选项顺序

A) Proactive financial behaviors are uncommon among millennial consumers.

B) There are more millennial consumers who tend to have materialistic values.

C) Millennial consumers with less materialistic values tend to be more content. ✓

D) Millennial consumers are environmentally positive in their consuming behaviors.

38. It can be learned from Passage C that _____.

考试时的选项顺序

A) materialism harms personal and environmental well-being

B) all considered, buying less is better than buying “green” ✓

C) there is a dilemma for consumers to change their behaviors

D) it is challenging to eliminate inherent materialistic values

原始的选项顺序

A) materialism harms personal and environmental well-being

B) there is a dilemma for consumers to change their behaviors

C) it is challenging to eliminate inherent materialistic values

D) all considered, buying less is better than buying “green” ✓

39. What has been mentioned in both Passage A and Passage C?

考试时的选项顺序

A) It's sensible for consumers to think things through before making buying decisions.

B) Shopping is a way to relieve pressure and anxiety for people in modern society.

C) Overconsumption often casts a heavy psychological burden on consumers. ✓

D) Real happiness lies in less pursuit of materials and more money management.

原始的选项顺序

A) Overconsumption often casts a heavy psychological burden on consumers. ✓

B) Real happiness lies in less pursuit of materials and more money management.

C) Shopping is a way to relieve pressure and anxiety for people in modern society.

D) It's sensible for consumers to think things through before making buying decisions.

40. Which of the following is true concerning the three passages?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Sensible consumption is discussed in all the three passages. ✓

B) All the three passages are written from the consumers' perspective.

C) All the three authors are strongly against mindless consumption.

D) Mental well-being is discussed more or less in all the three passages.

原始的选项顺序

A) Mental well-being is discussed more or less in all the three passages.

B) All the three passages are written from the consumers' perspective.

C) All the three authors are strongly against mindless consumption.

D) Sensible consumption is discussed in all the three passages. ✓

Directions : In Part IV, you will read three texts and then write a short essay according to them. You should write with clarity and logic. (Time allowed: 40 minutes)

41.

Question 41 (Suggested completion time: 40 minutes)

Directions: *Gewu-zhizhi* (格物致知) is an important term in the Chinese philosophy, often interpreted in literature as “to study or investigate things and acquire or extend knowledge” (*Key Concepts in Chinese Thought and Culture II*). Read the following three excerpts about *gewu-zhizhi*. Write a short essay according to them.

Excerpt A

What the *Great Learning* teaches, is to illustrate illustrious virtue; to renovate the people; and to rest in the highest excellence. ... The ancients who wished to illustrate illustrious virtue throughout the kingdom, first ordered well their

own states. Wishing to order well their states, they first regulated their families. Wishing to regulate their families, they first cultivated their persons. Wishing to cultivate their persons, they first rectified their hearts. Wishing to rectify their hearts, they first sought to be sincere in their thoughts. Wishing to be sincere in their thoughts, they first extended to the utmost their knowledge. Such extension of knowledge lay in the investigation of things.

Excerpt B

For Zhu Xi, the purpose of the “investigation of things” is to extend our knowledge of the external *Li*(理). When it simply speaks of the “investigation of things,” it means that we should seek for “what is above shapes” through “what is within shapes.” We investigate the abstract through the concrete. What we as a result come to see lies both within the eternal world and within our own nature. The more we know *Li*, the more nature, ordinarily concealed by our physical endowment, becomes visible to us. This is why the student must, for all the separate things in the world, by means of the *Li*, which he already understands, proceed further to gain exhaustive knowledge of those (with which he is not yet familiar), thus striving to extend his knowledge to the farthest point. When one has exerted oneself for a long time, finally one morning a complete understanding will open before one. Thereupon there will be a thorough comprehension of all the multitude of things, external or internal, fine or coarse, and every exercise of the mind will be marked by complete enlightenment.

Excerpt C

According to Wang Yangming, *ge* means to rectify and *wu* means affairs. *Gewu*, therefore, does not mean “investigation of things,” but “rectification of affairs.” The intuitive knowledge, he maintains, must be extended through our daily experience in dealing with ordinary affairs. ... The *wu* may be right or wrong, but as soon as this can be determined, our intuitive knowledge will immediately know it. When our intuitive knowledge knows a thing to be right, we must sincerely do it, and when our intuitive knowledge knows it to be wrong, we must sincerely stop doing it. In this manner we rectify our affairs and at the same time extend our intuitive knowledge. There is no other means of extending our intuitive knowledge except through the rectification of our affairs. That is why the *Great Learning* says: “The extension of knowledge consists in the rectification of affairs.” Therefore, the cultivation of the self is the same as extension of the intuitive knowledge. In extending our intuitive knowledge, we must love people, regulate our family, contribute our best to creating order in our state and bring peace to the world.

41. Write a short essay of about 250 words based on your understanding of the excerpts. Remember to write in your OWN words. Your essay should respond to the following questions:

(1) What are the differences and similarities between Zhu Xi and Wang Yangming regarding their ideas about *gewu-zhizhi*?

(2) What is your understanding of *gewu-zhizhi*?

2020 阅读大赛复赛第三场 (2020 年 11 月 7 日)

Directions : In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Questions 1-3 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the introductions and match the introductions with the people.

Please note there are two extra options you do not need.

- A. Charlotte Brontë
- B. Percy Bysshe Shelley
- C. Jane Austen
- D. Henrik Johan Ibsen
- E. Eugene O'Neill

1.

She was an English novelist known primarily for her six major novels, which interpret, critique, and comment upon the British landed gentry at the end of the 18th century. Her plots often explore the dependence of women on marriage in the pursuit of favourable social standing and economic security. Her use of biting irony, along with her realism, humour, and social commentary, has long earned her acclaim among critics, scholars, and popular audiences alike. C

答案 : C

2.

Known for his lyrical and long-form verse, he was one of the epic poets of the 19th century. He is best known for his classic anthology verse works such as *Ode to the West Wind* and *The Masque of Anarchy*. He is also well known for his long-form poetry, including *Queen Mab* and *Alastor*. B

答案 : B

3.

He was one of the greatest playwrights in American history and a Nobel Laureate in Literature. Through his experimental and emotionally probing dramas, he addressed the difficulties of human society with a deep psychological complexity. His disdain for the commercial realities of the theater world he was born into led him to produce works of importance and integrity. E

答案 : E

Question 4 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Paper is universally festive. In fact, paper factors into many festivals and traditions around the world. From paper lanterns in China to cardboard and paper pinatas in Mexico, paper has a pride of place in many cultural celebrations. We've rounded up some of the more interesting paper-centric traditions featured in festivals and on holidays from across the globe. Some are specific to each place, and others are shared in different cultures, but all their meanings are universal.

4. What is the purpose of this text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) To introduce paper traditions around the world. ✓
- B) To reveal shared meanings of paper in different cultures.
- C) To show how paper traditions developed in history.
- D) To call for people's attention to paper traditions.

原始的选项顺序

- A) To introduce paper traditions around the world. ✓
- B) To call for people's attention to paper traditions.
- C) To show how paper traditions developed in history.
- D) To reveal shared meanings of paper in different cultures.

Question 5 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Drivers will always make errors on the road—it's part of being human. Even if they're not involved in accidents, drivers can make mistakes behind the wheel that make their cars run inefficiently. For instance, pressing down on the gas pedal too quickly or slamming on the brakes at every stoplight can jolt the car in and out of motion. A gentler driving style can help reduce the fuel required to keep the car moving.

Self-driving cars gauge precisely when and where to stop and start. They ease in and out of stoplights in a way that helps preserve a car's resources. Plus, these vehicles will choose the smartest route to get from point A to point B. As such, they need less fuel to navigate passengers.

5. What is the main idea of this text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Self-driving cars help remove human errors in driving.
- B) Self-driving cars will ease our commutes.
- C) Self-driving cars will be much safer.
- D) Self-driving cars save fuel and handle the road more wisely. ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) Self-driving cars will be much safer.
- B) Self-driving cars will ease our commutes.
- C) Self-driving cars help remove human errors in driving.
- D) Self-driving cars save fuel and handle the road more wisely. ✓

Question 6 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Thousands of species have been described, and, although most may agree

that many thousand remain undiscovered, identifying new taxa of charismatic vertebrates, like birds, is rare. Rheindt et al. describe five new songbird species and five new subspecies found on a single small island near Sulawesi, Indonesia, over a single 6-week expedition. They targeted the area because of its geological history and complexity and the historical notes of other explorers. They argue that similar approaches in other regions could also lead to the discovery of new species.

6. Which of the following might be the best title for the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Exploring the undiscovered B) Discovery in Indonesia
- C) Finding new species ✓ D) New birds to be found

原始的选项顺序

- A) Finding new species ✓ B) Discovery in Indonesia
- C) New birds to be found D) Exploring the undiscovered

Question 7 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

The story Tara Westover tells in her memoir *Educated* is remarkable in and of itself—a story of overcoming, to most readers, inconceivable odds before going on to triumphant personal success. And now the journey on which the

book has gone, in just over two years, appears no less astonishing. One woman's story, sensitively and lyrically told, has gone on to sell 4 million copies and emerges as a rare memoir blockbuster, at the level of *Wild* and *The Glass Castle*.

7. What can be inferred from the text?

考试时的选项顺序

A) The author of *Educated* has struck a chord with most of her audience.

B) Tara Westover's memoir *Educated* has gained considerable attention. ✓

C) *Wild* and *The Glass Castle* are books about personal struggle to success.

D) Memoirs are usually difficult to sell very well or to be bestsellers.

原始的选项顺序

A) Memoirs are usually difficult to sell very well or to be bestsellers.

B) Tara Westover's memoir *Educated* has gained considerable attention. ✓

C) The author of *Educated* has struck a chord with most of her audience.

D) *Wild* and *The Glass Castle* are books about personal struggle to success.

Question 8 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Outside of Japan, the U.S. and Western Europe used to dominate the patent game. But since 2000, according to data from the World Intellectual Property Organization, the portion of internationally filed patents granted for IP (Intellectual Property) developed in Asian countries has soared—with China leading the way. While the most recent annual patent figures aren't final, the trend is clear: From 2000 to 2015, the number of patents developed in China jumped tenfold, from 5,680 to 56,312. And in 2018, China's IP office received a record 1.54 million patent applications, or nearly half the global total.

8. Which of the following is true according to the text?

考试时的选项顺序

A) The center of gravity in intellectual property is shifting east. ✓

B) Japan used to rank after the U.S. and Western Europe in the patent number.

C) China is becoming a country with the most patents across the globe.

D) IP protection is gaining more attention in Asia than in

Western Europe.

原始的选项顺序

- A) Japan used to rank after the U.S. and Western Europe in the patent number.
- B) IP protection is gaining more attention in Asia than in Western Europe.
- C) China is becoming a country with the most patents across the globe.
- D) The center of gravity in intellectual property is shifting east. ✓

Question 9 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

①But it wasn't until 2019 that members of the Icelandic Hiking Society, Rice University, and the general public installed the monument at its former site.

②What's left of the first Icelandic glacier lost to climate change was commemorated in 2019 with a memorial plaque. Glaciologist Oddur Sigurðsson declared Okjökull a glacier-no-more back in 2014, when the ice became too thin for glacial movement.

③The August induction of the memorial followed the publication of an April *Nature* study that attributes 25 to 30 percent of the observed global mean sea level rise between 1993 and mid-2014 to glacier melting.

9. What is the right order of the numbered sentences?

考试时的选项顺序

A) ② ① ③ ✓ B) ② ③ ① C) ③ ② ① D) ③ ① ②

原始的选项顺序

A) ② ① ③ ✓ B) ③ ① ② C) ② ③ ① D) ③ ② ①

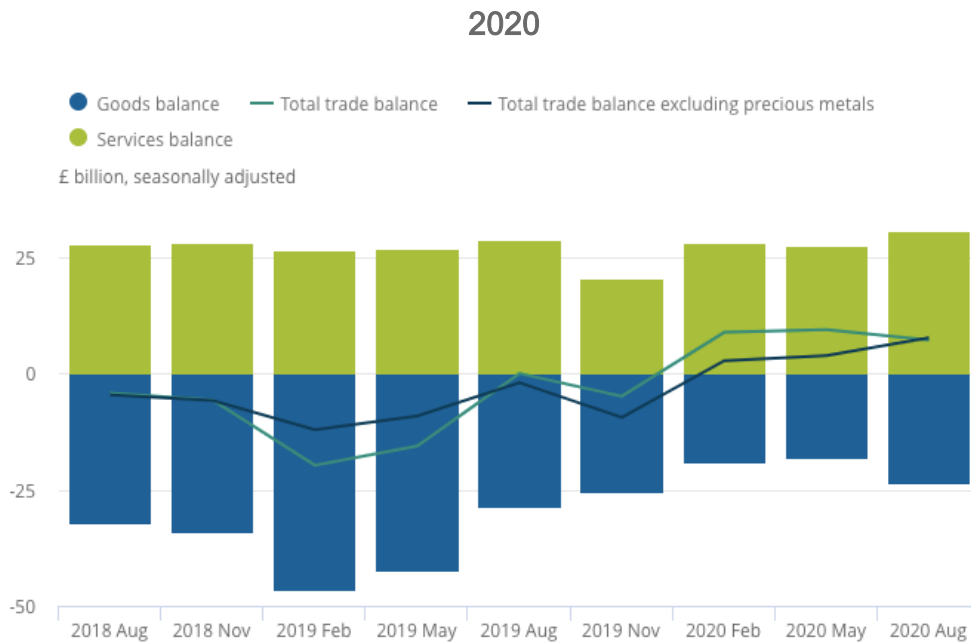
Question 10 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: The following figures show the UK trade balances. Answer the question according to the information in the figures.

Changes in the UK exports, imports, and trade balances

		Exports	Imports	Balance
Month - August 2020 vs July 2020	Value (£bn)	51.8	48.3	3.5
	Change (£bn)	0.8	-0.7	1.5
	% Change	1.5%	-1.4%	
3-Month - 3 months to August 2020 vs 3 months to May 2020	Value (£bn)	151.1	143.4	7.7
	Change (£bn)	21.4	17.5	3.9
	% Change	16.5%	13.9%	
12-Month - 12 months to August 2020 vs 12 months to August 2019	Value (£bn)	618.3	613.4	4.9
	Change (£bn)	-58.0	-91.9	33.9
	% Change	-8.6%	-13.0%	

UK trade balances, three-months on three-months, August 2018 to August



Source: Office for National Statistics – UK trade

10. Which of the following is an INCORRECT description about the figures?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) The total trade surplus increased by £3.9 billion in the three months to August 2020.
- B) The trade surplus in services widened in the three months to August 2020.
- C) The total trade surplus in the twelve months to August 2019 was around £25 billion. ✓
- D) The trade deficit in goods narrowed in the twelve months to August 2020.

原始的选项顺序

- A) The trade deficit in goods narrowed in the twelve months to August 2020.
- B) The trade surplus in services widened in the three months to August 2020.
- C) The total trade surplus increased by £3.9 billion in the three months to August 2020.
- D) The total trade surplus in the twelve months to August 2019 was around £25 billion. ✓

Directions : In Part II, you will read short texts on different subjects. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 55 minutes)

Question 11 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read an example of a logical fallacy and answer the question according to the example.

A student claims that the school is overcharging students for lunch.

The teacher says that she does not believe that is happening. The student asks the teacher to prove that lunch prices are fair.

11. Which of the following logical fallacies does the example typically illustrate?

考试时的选项顺序

A) **Misleading Vividness:** It occurs when someone uses a

small number of dramatic events to claim that something is more prevalent than it actually is based on statistics.

B) **Kafkatrapping:** It occurs when you are accused of a thought crime such as racism. You respond with an honest denial, which is then used as further confirmation of your guilt.

C) **Burden of Proof:** It occurs when someone making a claim does not respect their obligation to provide the needed evidence for it, but instead attempts to shift the burden to their opponent. ✓

D) **Weasel Word:** It is a modifying word that undermines or contradicts the meaning of the word, phrase, or clause it accompanies. More broadly, it may refer to any word that's used with the intention to mislead or misinform.

原始的选项顺序

A) **Weasel Word:** It is a modifying word that undermines or contradicts the meaning of the word, phrase, or clause it accompanies. More broadly, it may refer to any word that's used with the intention to mislead or misinform.

B) **Burden of Proof:** It occurs when someone making a claim does not respect their obligation to provide the needed evidence for it, but instead attempts to shift the burden to their

opponent. ✓

C) **Kafkatrapping:** It occurs when you are accused of a thought crime such as racism. You respond with an honest denial, which is then used as further confirmation of your guilt.

D) **Misleading Vividness:** It occurs when someone uses a small number of dramatic events to claim that something is more prevalent than it actually is based on statistics.

Question 12 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read an example of a logical fallacy and answer the question according to the example.

Some local politicians plan to expand the municipality's cycle network and add several new speed cameras in densely populated areas. Their opponent says, "They want us all to give up driving forever. They're punishing the honest car owners and commuters that help pay these politicians' salaries."

12. Which of the following takes the same logical fallacy as the example?

A) Clogged arteries require surgery to clear them. If this is true for arteries, it must be true for clogged highways which need measures that are as drastic.

B) The temperature has dropped this morning, and I also have a headache. The cold weather must be causing my

headache.

C) Sarah always wears slacks. No real woman would wear slacks. Sarah is not a real woman.

D) Mark said the government should spend more money on the city infrastructure. His brother refuted him, "Oh, so you think all of our tax money should go towards infrastructure? What about education and environmental protection?" ✓

答案 : D

Questions 13-14 Reasoning (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

13.

"Once you eliminate the impossible, whatever remains, no matter how improbable, must be the truth."

—Arthur Conan Doyle

Which of the following is the most suitable criticism of the above quote?

考试时的选项顺序

A) The truth can be probable or improbable.

B) You cannot define the truth as possible or impossible.

C) The truth is definitely probable.

D) Once you eliminate the impossible, what remains is

possible. ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) The truth is definitely probable.
- B) The truth can be probable or improbable.
- C) You cannot define the truth as possible or impossible.
- D) Once you eliminate the impossible, what remains is

possible. ✓

14.

Our school will increase the amount of homework set for students by 50%. The reason for this is that academic standards are dropping, which in turn will lead to students no longer being allowed into university, and having to take low-income jobs for the rest of their lives. This will mean that they will find it hard to support future families, have a healthy lifestyle, and keep together friendships. They will as a result suffer from depression and high-blood pressure, and, because they have little or no medical insurance, will die prematurely and painfully.

Which of the following gives the minimal support to the argument above?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Dropping academic standards will not necessarily have such dire consequences. ✓

B) Failure to be allowed into university means little chance of landing a good job.

C) The increase in workload is an advisable way to improve students' grades.

D) Schools should be responsible for the decline in students' academic performance.

原始的选项顺序

A) Schools should be responsible for the decline in students' academic performance.

B) Dropping academic standards will not necessarily have such dire consequences. ✓

C) The increase in workload is an advisable way to improve students' grades.

D) Failure to be allowed into university means little chance of landing a good job.

Questions 15-16 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.



Stories about conformity are all over the news these days.

Why would several police officers go along with the actions of a fellow officer who was killing a man in broad daylight while bystanders filmed the tragedy? Why do most people in some places wear face masks, while most people in other locations do not?

Conformity is a very subtle form of social influence. Usually, those around us are not giving us orders or making explicit requests that we act a certain way, but their behavior communicates a set of expectations and social norms that we find hard to resist.

In individualistic societies like the United States, conformity is often thought of as a negative thing. As Americans, we compete to stand out in some way and to trumpet our uniqueness to the world, and in novels and movies, the

conformist corporation man in the grey flannel suit is more often portrayed as an object of ridicule or pity than as a heroic figure.

In other words, we aspire to be nonconformists—just like everyone else.

Collectivistic societies, on the other hand, place a higher value on conformity and see it as a virtue rather than as a vice. And indeed, supporting shared social norms and minimizing deviation from them may help coordinate the group's response to external threats, such as natural disasters.

And let's face it: We like predictability in those around us. Erratic individuals who are "*loose cannons*" are usually not our first choice when it comes to business partners, mates, or comrades-in-arms during times of conflict. Being accepted by your group and having a reputation as a good citizen has always been a valuable commodity, and what better way to demonstrate this than by openly embracing and conforming to the norms that the group deems important?

Research has repeatedly and convincingly confirmed that nonconformists are rejected and ostracized by groups in laboratory experiments as well as in everyday life and that this rejection is painful and aversive for the nonconformist.

15. What does the writer mean by *loose cannons* in Paragraph 7?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Persons who are changeable and uncontrollable. ✓

- B) Persons who are big-mouthed and irresponsible.
- C) Persons who have little independence and just follow the crowd.
- D) Persons who may well make a compromise at any moment.

原始的选项顺序

- A) Persons who are big-mouthed and irresponsible.
 - B) Persons who are changeable and uncontrollable. ✓
 - C) Persons who may well make a compromise at any moment.
 - D) Persons who have little independence and just follow the crowd.
-

16. What is the best title for this text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Conformity: Good or Bad? ✓
- B) Conformity in Our Everyday Lives
- C) Conformity in Critical Periods
- D) Conformity: The Power of Social Influence

原始的选项顺序

- A) Conformity: Good or Bad? ✓

B) Conformity: The Power of Social Influence

C) Conformity in Critical Periods

D) Conformity in Our Everyday Lives

Questions 17-19 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

Many times, especially in business settings, people use words that they think they know—but don't. Although they do this in an effort to sound intelligent and sophisticated, it backfires badly, because even one small slip-up can cause an audience to focus on only that, not the speaker's ideas. Sure, saying the wrong word (usually) isn't a game-changer. But if you make that kind of mistake, it sets you up for a question that no one wants clients, coworkers, or employers to begin asking: "Are you really that smart?"

Think it can't happen to you? We've heard horror stories: people laughing behind a prominent CEO's back for his not understanding the correct use of a business term; a corporate lawyer saying "tenant" (a renter) instead of "tenet" (a belief); an employee toasting her supervisor as the "penultimate" leader (which doesn't mean "ultimate" but instead means "next to last").

Here, excerpted from our new book, *That Doesn't Mean What You Think It Means*, are some terms or words that sound smart but when used incorrectly make you sound the opposite, along with real examples of their being misused, drawn from business news reports, research publications, and corporate press releases. (We've omitted attributions to protect the well-meaning writers who

unwittingly committed the errors.)

methodology

“We have... failed to require that the Internal Revenue Service (IRS) utilize only secure and reliable authentication methodologies...”

Methodology is an annoying word that has oozed into a lot of places, especially government documents and annual reports, probably because it sounds important... and pretentious. The word to use instead is “method.” The “-logy” tacked onto the end of method transforms it into the study of methods. (That -logy ending comes from the ancient Greek λογία for “the study of.”) So methodology has its place in English—it’s just that it should stay there and not substitute for method. (One interesting note: The IRS itself, in contrast to the senator speaking about the IRS, almost always uses the word method instead of methodology. Count on tax professionals to use a more economical word.)

moot

“Whether you need to appoint a Data Protection Officer or not is a mute-point.”

Actually, it’s not a mute point at all, because a point isn’t speechless. It should be moot, not mute. But even spelled right, moot is tough to use correctly. The use of moot is, well, moot... and we’re not being cute. What we’re saying is that the meaning of moot is “open to debate”—which is the time-honored definition of moot. But by the mid-1800s, moot also began meaning “something not worth considering.” The idea was that something debatable is of no practical value, so not worth bothering with. So sometimes moot is used to

mean “definitely not debatable” because the point is so immaterial. This change in meaning is primarily North American, and it is one that has stuck, although language purists argue about it. Our advice: Choose another word.

statistically significant

“Facebook is ‘a positive, significant predictor of divorce rate...’ [T]he study’s authors feel they’re noticing something that’s genuinely statistically significant.”

You see it all the time nowadays: A study has shown something worrisome! The findings are statistically significant! Uh-oh! But statistically significant doesn’t necessarily mean that the results were significant in the sense of “Wow!” It just means that they signify that whatever was observed has only a low probability of being due to chance. The problem is, in nonstatistical use, significant means something noteworthy or important. So nonstatistical types see “statistically significant” and think it refers to something big. But actually a study can find something statistically significant that has only a tiny effect. For example, Facebook could increase the risk of divorce by a statistically significant 1%. Big deal.

These words are only the tip of an iceberg. From “a priori” to “untenable,” words can work for you or against you. And that’s our last (not penultimate!) word, at least in this article, on the words that can trip you up.

17. According to the author, what is the most possible consequence of using a wrong word in business situations?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) The tide may turn against the person who misused the word.
- B) The speech will become less appealing to its audience.
- C) Those who made the mistake may become a laughing stock. ✓
- D) It may spell a reputation disaster for an executive officer.

原始的选项顺序

- A) Those who made the mistake may become a laughing stock. ✓
- B) The tide may turn against the person who misused the word.
- C) It may spell a reputation disaster for an executive officer.
- D) The speech will become less appealing to its audience.

18. Which of the following can be inferred from the text about the book, *That Doesn't Mean What You Think It Means*?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) It suggests words that people should use cautiously. ✓
- B) It includes a number of examples with unclear sources.
- C) It points out words that should not be said in public.
- D) It is filled with misused cases of unqualified authors.

原始的选项顺序

- A) It is filled with misused cases of unqualified authors.
 - B) It suggests words that people should use cautiously. ✓
 - C) It includes a number of examples with unclear sources.
 - D) It points out words that should not be said in public.
-

19. Which of the following statements is NOT true according to the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) The sentence “the question is moot” can have different interpretations.
- B) There is no such a term as “a mute-point” for it does not make sense.
- C) “Methodology” and “method” can be used interchangeably in a few contexts. ✓
- D) The word “significant” in statistics is different from its daily usage.

原始的选项顺序

- A) The word “significant” in statistics is different from its daily usage.
- B) There is no such a term as “a mute-point” for it does not make sense.

C) The sentence “the question is moot” can have different interpretations.

D) “Methodology” and “method” can be used interchangeably in a few contexts. ✓

Questions 20-21 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

Doctors often cool down people who have had a cardiac arrest or stroke to reduce brain damage, usually with water-filled blankets. But doing this by circulating cold water in a tube down the throat to the stomach may be preferable.

In a pilot study testing the tube device in people who had a cardiac arrest, most doctors felt it was more convenient than blankets, and patients reached the target temperature within about 2 hours.

The study didn’t directly compare the new approach with the use of water blankets, but 2 hours is relatively fast, says Marvin Wayne at St Joseph Medical Center in Bellingham, Washington state.

It has been known for some time that cooling people by a few degrees can be beneficial in emergency medicine. It was thought that cooling to 32°C was necessary. Then in 2013, a trial showed it was just as beneficial to cool to 36°C. Although this is only about 1°C below normal body temperature, people who have had brain injuries sometimes have a fever, and such cooling avoids this overheating.

The internal device, made by US firm Attune Medical, was used on 52 people in the new study to cool them to 32°C or 36°C depending on their doctor's preference. In 30 people, the target temperature was reached using the device alone. In the rest, their doctors felt that blankets needed to be added as they weren't cooling fast enough.

But if the new approach helps doctors avoid blankets at least sometimes, that is an advantage, says Wayne. "Blankets get in the way and cover people up—a patient becomes somewhat invisible."

John Andrzejowski at Sheffield Teaching Hospitals in the UK says a larger randomised trial is needed to check the device doesn't damage the lining of the oesophagus.

20. What can we learn about the pilot study according to the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) It further supports the long-lasting belief that cooling to 32°C is necessary.
- B) It shows cooling the body temperature to 32°C or 36°C is of similar benefit.
- C) It finds the tube device can cool to the target temperature within about two hours. ✓
- D) It reveals the combination of the tube device and blankets is preferred by doctors.

原始的选项顺序

- A) It further supports the long-lasting belief that cooling to 32°C is necessary.
 - B) It shows cooling the body temperature to 32°C or 36°C is of similar benefit.
 - C) It reveals the combination of the tube device and blankets is preferred by doctors.
 - D) It finds the tube device can cool to the target temperature within about two hours. ✓
-

21. What should be done in the future about the tube device?

考试时的选项顺序

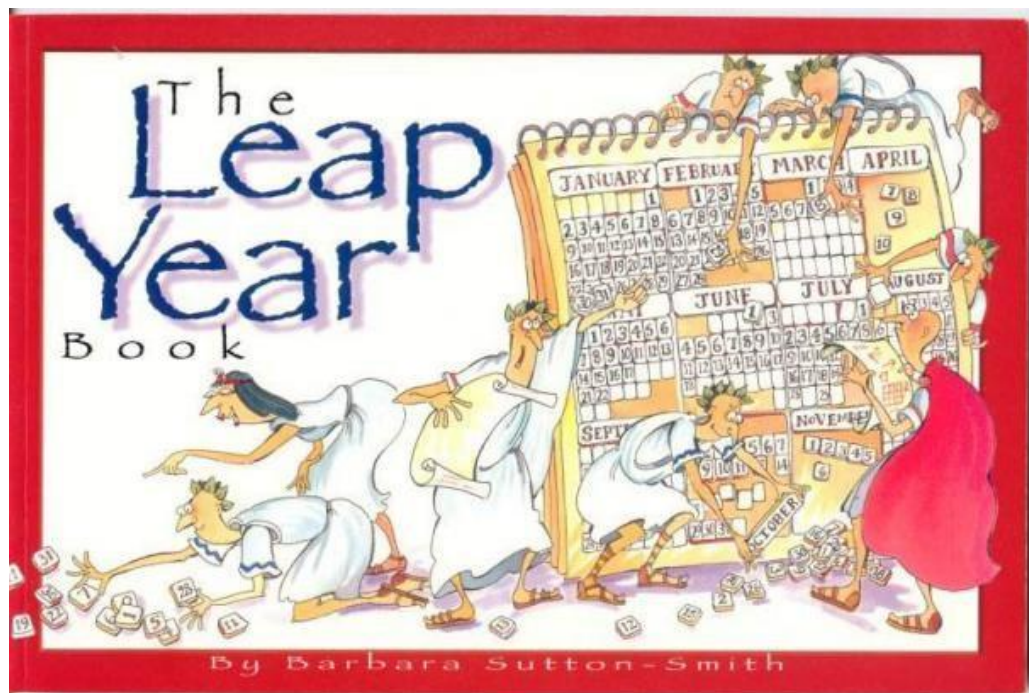
- A) To further speed up the cooling process.
- B) To involve more subjects in the trial.
- C) To make patients more visible during operation.
- D) To conduct a randomised trial on a larger scale. ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) To involve more subjects in the trial.
- B) To further speed up the cooling process.
- C) To make patients more visible during operation.
- D) To conduct a randomised trial on a larger scale. ✓

Questions 22-24 (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.



We owe leap years to Julius Caesar, but also to his successor, the Emperor Augustus.

The Ancient Romans used to follow a calendar that had 355 days a year, but it eventually grew hopelessly out of sync with the seasons, making it difficult to celebrate festivals at the same time each year. So in 45 BC, Julius Caesar decreed that a new, reformed calendar would be adopted that had 365 days a year, with an extra day every “leap year” in order to keep the seasons and calendar properly in sync.

However, the Roman priests who devised the new calendar initially made a mistake. They set the leap year to occur every third year. The priests realized soon enough that this wouldn’t work, and in 8 BC Emperor Augustus officially corrected the calendar so that leap years came every fourth year.

So Caesar can take credit for leap years in general, but the four-year tradition is because of Augustus.

And have you ever wondered why February is shorter than every other month?

That's also because of Augustus. The Roman Senate, to honor him, renamed the month of Sextilis as Augustus (August). But originally August was only 30 days long, and this was a problem because Julius Caesar's month (July) was 31 days long. It wouldn't do for Augustus to have a shorter month than Caesar!

To make August as long as July they borrowed a day from February, reducing it from 30 days during a leap year to only 29, and 28 days every other year. This permanently left February as the odd, shortened month that it is.

In February 1997, John Melo was convicted of home invasion and sentenced to ten years and one day in prison. Seven years later, he filed a motion complaining that the Department of Correction had miscalculated the length of his sentence. Why? Because it had failed to credit him for the additional days he had to serve on account of the February 29's during leap years.

Melo's motion was allowed, but he didn't win the case. In 2006 the Superior Court ruled (Commonwealth vs. John Melo) that not only did his case have no merit, but it had been a mistake to ever allow it to proceed in the first place, noting that he had clearly been sentenced to a term of years, no matter how long each year may be.

Melo may not have had a compelling case. However, it is true that the extra day in February can be somewhat unfair. For instance, if you're a salaried

employee you essentially have to work an extra day for free during a leap year, whereas hourly employees get an extra payday. Similarly, banks often don't include February 29 when they calculate the interest they owe their customers, thereby giving themselves an extra bonus day of profit at everyone else's expense.

22. Which of the following is NOT true about leap years according to the text?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Leap years first appeared because Augustus couldn't accept a shorter month than Caesar. ✓

B) Leap year calculation rules in calendar could be determined by human will.

C) The creation of leap years makes sure festivals can be celebrated at the same time each year.

D) The calendar would be out of step with the seasons if there were no leap years.

原始的选项顺序

A) Leap year calculation rules in calendar could be determined by human will.

B) The calendar would be out of step with the seasons if there were no leap years.

C) Leap years first appeared because Augustus couldn't

accept a shorter month than Caesar. ✓

D) The creation of leap years makes sure festivals can be celebrated at the same time each year.

23. What can be inferred from John Melo's case?

考试时的选项顺序

A) John Melo suffered from unfair treatment while serving his sentence.

B) We are accustomed to taking one year as a whole regardless of how many days it has. ✓

C) There was a loophole in the U.S. judicial system which caused the miscalculation.

D) The additional days of leap years should be taken into consideration in his case.

原始的选项顺序

A) John Melo suffered from unfair treatment while serving his sentence.

B) The additional days of leap years should be taken into consideration in his case.

C) There was a loophole in the U.S. judicial system which caused the miscalculation.

D) We are accustomed to taking one year as a whole
regardless of how many days it has. ✓

24. What does the author indicate in the last paragraph?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Companies and banks are taking advantage of leap
years.

B) Leap years may bring some real problems. ✓

C) The common practice of leap years should be modified.

D) Jobs that are paid on the daily basis are preferred by
employees.

原始的选项顺序

A) Leap years may bring some real problems. ✓

B) The common practice of leap years should be modified.

C) Companies and banks are taking advantage of leap
years.

D) Jobs that are paid on the daily basis are preferred by
employees.

Questions 25-26 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

The New York Open Center offers holistically-based educational programs to
create positive transformation in individuals and the world.

The New York Open Center was founded in 1984 with the intention of creating a forum for a new generation of seekers. Our founders felt there was an abundance of excellent spiritual teachers and practitioners in the New York City area without a physical space or destination in which to practice. With an event on the evening of January 13, 1984, the New York Open Center was born.

The initial focus of the center was on spiritual values but the mission quickly expanded to include how our values and intentions lead us to participate in the wider world. Since then, the New York Open Center has evolved into an urban destination for holistic learning, personal development, professional advancement, and enrichment.

We have crystallized the essence of what makes the Open Center unique by designing for you eight distinct learning paths to travel on your journey. Integrating the wholeness of the individual—emotional, social, physical, artistic, creative, and spiritual—each learning path leads you to personal growth. The Open Center is dedicated to making these educational and enriching opportunities available to anyone anywhere through online learning initiatives.

Today, the New York Open Center presents more than 300 programs of exceptional depth and integrity to audiences totaling more than 10,000 annually.

25-26. Decide whether the following statements are True or False according to the text.

25. The New York Open Center used to provide courses just for the people in the New York City, but now it hopes more people in the world can get access to their resources through the Internet.

A) True ✓ B) False

答案 : A

26. What makes the New York Open Center unique is the number and variety of courses it offers.

A) True B) False ✓

答案 : B

Questions 27-30 (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

The only thing worse than being lied to is not knowing you're being lied to. It's true that plastic pollution is a huge problem, of planetary proportions. And it's true we could all do more to reduce our plastic footprint. The lie is blaming wasteful consumers for the plastic problem and changing our individual habits will fix it.

Recycling plastic is to saving the Earth what hammering a nail is to halting a falling skyscraper. _____27_____. But your effort is wholly inadequate and distracts from the real problem of why the building is

collapsing in the first place. The real problem is that single-use plastic—the very idea of producing plastic items like grocery bags, which we use for an average of 12 minutes but can persist in the environment for half a millennium—is an incredibly reckless abuse of technology. Encouraging individuals to recycle more will never solve the problem of a massive production of single-use plastic that should have been avoided in the first place.

As an ecologist and evolutionary biologist, I have had a disturbing window into the accumulating literature on the hazards of plastic pollution. Scientists have long recognized that plastics biodegrade slowly, if at all, and pose multiple threats to wildlife through entanglement and consumption. More recent reports highlight dangers posed by absorption of toxic chemicals in the water and by plastic odors that mimic some species' natural food.

Plastics also accumulate up the food chain, and studies now show that we are likely ingesting it ourselves in seafood. If we consumers are to blame, how is it possible that we fail to react when a study reports that there will be more plastic than fish in the oceans by 2050? I would argue the simple answer is that it is hard. And the reason why it is hard has an interesting history.

Beginning in the 1950s, big beverage companies like Coca-Cola and Anheuser-Busch, along with Phillip Morris and others, formed a non-profit called Keep America Beautiful. Its mission is/was to educate and encourage environmental stewardship in the public. Joining forces with the Ad Council (the public service announcement geniuses behind Smokey the Bear and

McGruff the Crime Dog, two characters created for the purpose of educating citizens), one of their first and most lasting impacts was bringing “litterbug” into the American lexicon through their marketing campaigns against thoughtless individuals.

Two decades later, their “Crying Indian” PSA (public service advertisement), would become hugely influential for the U.S. environmental movement. In the ad, a Native American man canoes up to a highway, where a motorist tosses a bag of trash. The camera pans up to show a tear rolling down the man’s cheek. By tapping into a shared national guilt for the history of mistreatment of Native Americans and the sins of a throwaway society, the PSA became a powerful symbol to motivate behavioral change. More recently, the Ad Council and Keep America Beautiful teams produced the “I Want to Be Recycled” campaign, which urges consumers to imagine the reincarnation of shampoo bottles and boxes, following the collection and processing of materials to the remolding of the next generation of products.

At face value, these efforts seem benevolent, but they obscure the real problem, which is the role that corporate polluters play in the plastic problem. This clever misdirection has led journalist and author Heather Rogers to describe Keep America Beautiful as the first corporate greenwashing front, as it has helped shift the public focus to consumer recycling behavior and actively thwarted legislation that would increase extended producer responsibility for waste management.

27. Which of the following statements best fits in the blank in the second paragraph?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) It could be because that's not what you were told about the truth.
- B) You struggle to find a place to do it and feel pleased when you succeed. ✓
- C) There is a lot of discussion about how difficult it is to recycle.
- D) What you have done is valuable somehow, and probably worth a try.

原始的选项顺序

- A) What you have done is valuable somehow, and probably worth a try.
 - B) You struggle to find a place to do it and feel pleased when you succeed. ✓
 - C) It could be because that's not what you were told about the truth.
 - D) There is a lot of discussion about how difficult it is to recycle.
-

28. What does the writer think is the most important to solve the plastic problem?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Effective measures should be taken to increase recycling rates of plastic items.

B) People should first stop blaming wasteful consumers.

C) Everyone should be clear about what they can do about plastic before it's too late.

D) The production of disposable plastic should be outlawed.

✓

原始的选项顺序

A) People should first stop blaming wasteful consumers.

B) The production of disposable plastic should be outlawed.

✓

C) Effective measures should be taken to increase recycling rates of plastic items.

D) Everyone should be clear about what they can do about plastic before it's too late.

29. What can we learn about Keep America Beautiful in fighting against plastic pollution?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) It called for legislation that would impose more responsibility on corporate producers.
- B) It's the first organization advocating that corporate polluters greenwash their irresponsibility.
- C) It has distracted people's attention from the responsibility corporate polluters should assume. ✓
- D) It has gradually made environmental protection awareness filter into people's minds.

原始的选项顺序

- A) It has gradually made environmental protection awareness filter into people's minds.
 - B) It's the first organization advocating that corporate polluters greenwash their irresponsibility.
 - C) It has distracted people's attention from the responsibility corporate polluters should assume. ✓
 - D) It called for legislation that would impose more responsibility on corporate producers.
-

30. What is the best title for this text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Why plastic producers should discharge their own

responsibilities

B) Bag bans are not the only way to solve plastic pollution

C) More recycling won't solve plastic pollution ✓

D) How plastic has become a plague

原始的选项顺序

A) How plastic has become a plague

B) More recycling won't solve plastic pollution ✓

C) Bag bans are not the only way to solve plastic pollution

D) Why plastic producers should discharge their own

responsibilities

Directions : In Part III, you will read passages on the same subject. You will be required to identify the writers' positions and evaluate the effectiveness of the writers' arguments. (Time allowed: 35 minutes)

Questions 31-40 (Suggested completion time: 35 minutes)

Directions: Read three passages about studying abroad. Answer the questions according to the passages.

Passage A

Former international students are doing quite well in Canada's job market compared to internationally educated immigrants but still fall behind their Canadian-born-and-educated counterparts. This finding comes from a new

study from the C.D. Howe Institute.

In *Comparing Outcomes: The Relative Job-Market Performance of Former International Students*, authors Mikal Skuterud and Zongjia Chen compared the performance of former international students (who studied within the first decade of the 2000s) in today's job market with that of foreign-born-and-educated graduates as well as Canadian-born and educated people, combining data from Canada's National Graduate Survey and Labour Force Survey.

The results indicate that former international students clearly outperform their foreign-educated counterparts by substantial margins, and they are not too far behind those born and educated in Canada.

"Former international student gaps we identify relative to the Canadian-born-and-educated comparison group are modest," says Skuterud.

"We find essentially no shortfall in the average earnings of male former international students and Canadian-born-and-educated post-secondary graduates and only small gaps for women when we exclude education level and field of study."

However, comparisons of foreign-born-and-educated graduates from similar academic programs show that the gaps become larger and tend to be largest for women with college diplomas in fields outside of math and computer science and for Chinese men and South Asian women.

The study also noted some indication of more recent deterioration in the labour-market performance of former international students as post-secondary institutions and governments have reached deeper into foreign student pools to meet their student and immigration demands. They argue that this deterioration is most consistent with a trade-off that has occurred, as the quality and supply of international students have not kept pace with the growth in demand.

“The critical question for policymakers is to what extent these gaps reflect pre-market differences in labour-market productivity, such as English/French language disparities, as opposed to market challenges due to weaker job-search networks or employer discrimination,” Skuterud says. “Although the driving factors have very different implications for policy, identifying their relative importance is extremely difficult.”

According to the authors, giving preference to Canadian-educated applicants in the Express Entry immigration system over foreign-educated applicants is preferable, leading to better immigrant integration.

Passage B

A recent report says that there has been a 30%-40% drop in Indian students going to the US and UK for higher studies. The major reason being cited is that

it is now very difficult to find a job in these countries after graduation due to visa restrictions and an overall shortage of jobs. Considering the high cost of foreign education, many students now feel that the return on their investment will not be sufficient due to this dire job situation. Some students are applying to universities in countries like Canada and Australia which make it easier for them to find a job after their studies are over. However, the economies of these countries are not growing fast enough to generate enough jobs for all immigrants. Additionally, they primarily offer jobs to foreign students who have done their master's degrees in specialized areas like data analytics or medicine, where there is a shortage of local talent. Foreign students who do an undergraduate or postgraduate degree in general areas like business, media or liberal arts do not have many job openings available to them. India, being the fastest growing large economy in the world, would seem to offer the best job opportunities for Indian graduates.

Considering that many new quality private universities and colleges offering a wide range of courses have sprung up in India, the question arises if there is any real benefit for an Indian student to study abroad.

A major advantage of studying abroad is the great exposure to international environments and people this offers to the Indian student. There are many global insights and best practices which can only be learned through experiencing them first hand in a foreign country. Hence, studying abroad makes sense for a student who comes from a well-off family that can afford to

pay the high fees and is not too dependent on the salary from a foreign job to recover this cost. It could also be useful for a student who has gained admission into a top ranked university in a highly specialized discipline where there is a huge demand from local companies. Indian students outside these two categories may not benefit as much from a foreign education.

One aspect that should be highlighted is that Indian recruiters tend to prefer students who possess foreign degrees, the reason being that these students have the benefit of international education which is useful in many job roles in India. Surveys show that although fresh graduates with foreign degrees do not command much higher salaries than their counterparts with Indian degrees at the entry level, they are able to get 30%-40% higher salaries with faster promotions as their careers progress.

So, how can an Indian student benefit from the advantages of international education while studying in India?

An increasing number of Indian colleges have partnered with top universities in the UK, US and Australia to offer pathway or twinning programs. In these courses, the Indian student studies the first 2-3 years in the Indian college and completes the final 1-2 years on the campus of the foreign university with the degree being granted by the foreign university. Some MBA programs offer the full two years of study in India with the final course modules being completed online with a foreign university. The advantage of these programs is that the Indian student gets the benefit of international pedagogy with the prestige of a

foreign degree with fees which are half or one third less than what they would pay for taking the full course abroad. The reduced cost of these pathway programs along with the higher long-term salary the graduate can get in India makes this a viable option for students who dream of getting a foreign degree.

For the average student, it is worth exploring the many options of high-quality education in India before choosing to bear the huge expense of studying abroad.

Passage C

As I write this, I am in Seoul, Korea with my wife visiting our daughter at the end of her study abroad semester. In college, we didn't participate in study abroad. It wasn't that we weren't interested in life outside of the US; it just wasn't popular at the time. But as parents, we've made it a core family value. As a Fulbright Scholar teaching in Estonia, I brought our two young children along. And we take an international trip every few years. Our son studied abroad in Turkey while in college, then joined the Peace Corps.

Of course, study abroad may not be easily available to everyone. It can be expensive—on top of already high tuition costs. If you are not a college student, then the opportunity to learn overseas in a structured environment might not be readily available. But today, even community college students can engage in shorter periods of study abroad. My wife, who teaches nursing at a

community college, recently accompanied students to the Dominican Republic for a week.

Seeing how others live can provide important lessons. Levels of tolerance and acceptance of peoples' differences are increased. As Mark Twain wrote in 1869 in *The Innocents Abroad*: "Travel is fatal to prejudice, bigotry, and narrow-mindedness, and many of our people need it sorely on these accounts. Broad, wholesome, charitable views of men and things cannot be acquired by vegetating in one little corner of the earth all one's lifetime." Travel guru Rick Steves argues that: "Globetrotting destroys ethnocentricity. It helps you understand and appreciate different cultures. Travel changes people. It broadens perspectives and teaches new ways to measure quality of life." No one can argue that we are in an era when these benefits aren't valuable.

If travel and, by extension, study abroad can make you a better person, could it also make you a more desirable employee? In 2017, the Institute of International Education, known as IIE, reported that study abroad can have a significant overall impact on the development of 21st-century skills and the ability to secure employment. One finding was that: "Longer periods of study abroad have a high impact on subsequent job offers and the development of most skills. Short-term programs are most effective at developing teamwork skills."

So regardless of whether it is a short-term community college experience over a week or a semester experience, as is more typical in four-year

institutions, the benefits are clear. Study abroad contributes to improvement in intercultural skills, confidence building, self-awareness and problem-solving.

While there are many ways to learn, it is learning by experience that allows for the deepest and most life-altering personal change. Trying to order in a restaurant or needing directions when you are unfamiliar with the language, though an uncomfortable spot to be in, can provide you with the chance to build confidence and develop communication skills. *Navigating cultural idiosyncrasies* can provide new perspectives and tear down preconceived notions of how others live. All travel provides valuable opportunities, though I would argue that foreign travel, particularly in situations where comfort is not assured, provides the best learning.

We continue to become more interconnected across the globe because of the Internet and social media. But virtual means of experience, though important, cannot replicate the powerful experience one gets by traveling and studying abroad.

Our future will be shaped by the values of today's youth. To ensure a workforce that can collaborate and cooperate with those from different cultures and backgrounds, we should encourage study abroad. The result will be a global workforce that can be the catalyst for advancing opportunity and peace.

31. According to Passage A, which of the following is true about the study of Canada's job-market performance?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Canadian-born-and-educated students outperform the other two kinds of graduates in popularity and in income. ✓

B) South Asian male and female graduates are the least preferred employees in the Canadian job market.

C) There is a huge income gap between former international students and foreign-born-and-educated students.

D) Former international students and Canadian-born-and-educated students are equally popular in the Canadian job market.

原始的选项顺序

A) Former international students and Canadian-born-and-educated students are equally popular in the Canadian job market.

B) Canadian-born-and-educated students outperform the other two kinds of graduates in popularity and in income. ✓

C) There is a huge income gap between former international students and foreign-born-and-educated students.

D) South Asian male and female graduates are the least preferred employees in the Canadian job market.

32. What can be learned about international students according to Passage A?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Former international students perform best in the Canadian job market in general terms.
- B) The performance of former international students in the Canadian job market is declining. ✓
- C) The supply of former international students can't meet the demand of job market.
- D) Former international students refer to those Canadians who studied abroad.

原始的选项顺序

- A) Former international students refer to those Canadians who studied abroad.
- B) The supply of former international students can't meet the demand of job market.
- C) Former international students perform best in the Canadian job market in general terms.
- D) The performance of former international students in the Canadian job market is declining. ✓
-

33. What can be inferred from Passage B?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Foreign students in India with master's degrees in science

have more job opportunities.

B) Indian students regard overseas study as an investment
for better jobs. ✓

C) The US and UK job markets are influenced by the
economic recession.

D) Canada and Australia are becoming hot destinations for
Indian students.

原始的选项顺序

A) The US and UK job markets are influenced by the
economic recession.

B) Canada and Australia are becoming hot destinations for
Indian students.

C) Indian students regard overseas study as an investment
for better jobs. ✓

D) Foreign students in India with master's degrees in science
have more job opportunities.

34. According to Passage B, who might not be suitable to study abroad?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Students who have been admitted to world-famous
universities.

B) Students whose majors are much-needed by local businesses.

C) Students who want to develop their vision and get faster promotion.

D) Students who need a foreign job to pursue their study. ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) Students who need a foreign job to pursue their study. ✓

B) Students whose majors are much-needed by local businesses.

C) Students who have been admitted to world-famous universities.

D) Students who want to develop their vision and get faster promotion.

35. What do the pathway programs mentioned in Passage B have in common?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Students can get degrees from top universities without going abroad.

B) The programs are sensible options for average students in India. ✓

C) Students can experience international education in local

universities.

D) The programs are most suitable for those who long for foreign education.

原始的选项顺序

A) The programs are most suitable for those who long for foreign education.

B) Students can get degrees from top universities without going abroad.

C) Students can experience international education in local universities.

D) The programs are sensible options for average students in India. ✓

36. In Passage C, what does the example of the author's wife show?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Studying abroad for shorter periods is becoming common.

B) There are more opportunities available to study abroad. ✓

C) More and more American students choose to study abroad.

D) Studying abroad is getting easier for college students.

原始的选项顺序

- A) Studying abroad is getting easier for college students.
 - B) Studying abroad for shorter periods is becoming common.
 - C) There are more opportunities available to study abroad. ✓
 - D) More and more American students choose to study abroad.
-

37. What is the main purpose of the quotes from Mark Twain and Rick Steves in Passage C?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) To illustrate what can be learned from travelling abroad. ✓
- B) To clarify how the differences between people are increased.
- C) To prove that travelling abroad offers more than schools.
- D) To explain why schools require students to study abroad.

原始的选项顺序

- A) To clarify how the differences between people are increased.
 - B) To explain why schools require students to study abroad.
 - C) To illustrate what can be learned from travelling abroad. ✓
 - D) To prove that travelling abroad offers more than schools.
-

38. What does the expression *navigating cultural idiosyncrasies* refer to according to Passage C?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Conducting contrastive studies of different cultures.
- B) Adapting to new cultural environments.
- C) Experiencing different cultural characteristics. ✓
- D) Figuring out one's own way of studying abroad.

原始的选项顺序

- A) Adapting to new cultural environments.
 - B) Experiencing different cultural characteristics. ✓
 - C) Figuring out one's own way of studying abroad.
 - D) Conducting contrastive studies of different cultures.
-

39. Which of the following is mentioned in both Passage B and Passage C?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Studying abroad promotes graduates' competitiveness in domestic job market. ✓
- B) The firsthand experience of foreign culture helps students build self-confidence.
- C) The benefits of studying abroad may not be as satisfying as people think.

D) Studying abroad provides important lessons about sustainable improvement.

原始的选项顺序

A) Studying abroad promotes graduates' competitiveness in domestic job market. ✓

B) The benefits of studying abroad may not be as satisfying as people think.

C) Studying abroad provides important lessons about sustainable improvement.

D) The firsthand experience of foreign culture helps students build self-confidence.

40. Which of the following is INCORRECT about the three passages?

考试时的选项顺序

A) All the three passages mention industries suitable for students studying abroad. ✓

B) Passage A is probably selected from the "immigration" section of a website.

C) Passage B aims to offer better alternatives to students who want to study abroad.

D) Passage C focuses on what students can gain from

studying abroad.

原始的选项顺序

A) Passage A is probably selected from the “immigration” section of a website.

B) Passage B aims to offer better alternatives to students who want to study abroad.

C) Passage C focuses on what students can gain from studying abroad.

D) All the three passages mention industries suitable for students studying abroad. ✓

Directions : In Part IV, you will read a passage and then write a short essay according to it. You should write with clarity and logic. (Time allowed: 40 minutes)

41.

Question 41 (Suggested completion time: 40 minutes)

Directions: Read an excerpt adapted from the scripts of the open Yale course, *Introduction to Psychology*, lectured by Paul Bloom. Write a short essay according to the excerpt.

Now, this is about IQ tests. We could now ask about their reliability and their validity. What do they mean? This has turned out to be a matter of extreme debate. A lot of the debate was spawned by the book by Herrnstein and

Murray called *The Bell Curve*. And in *The Bell Curve* these authors made the argument that IQ matters immensely for everyday life and that people's status in society—how rich they are and how successful they are—follows from their IQ as measured in standard IQ tests.

One response... was by the American Psychological Association, which put together a group of fifty leading researchers in intelligence to write a report on what they thought about intelligence—"Does IQ matter? How does IQ relate to intelligence? Why are people different in intelligence? Why do different human groups differ in intelligence?" And so on. At the same time, there was also another group of IQ researchers, not quite the same as the first group, got together and wrote another report.

The conclusions were slightly different but here's the broad consensus by the experts regarding the importance of IQ tests. And the claim is IQ is strongly related more so than any other single measurable human trait to many important educational, occupational, economic, and social outcomes. In some cases, the correlation is very strong such as success in school and success in military training. In other cases, it's moderate but robust such as "social competence". And in other cases it's smaller but consistent, "law abidingness", and they conclude whatever IQ test measure it is of great practical and social importance. So, IQ matters. More particularly, IQ matters for "social achievement," for "prestigious positions," and for "on the job performance" and other work-related variables. If I know your IQ score, I know something about

you that matters.

On the other hand, there's a lot of controversy about why this connection exists. So, to some extent, people have worried that the effectiveness of IQ is a self-fulfilling prophecy. And here is why. If society takes IQ tests important—seriously, they become important. So, it's true that your IQ is very related to your success in getting into a good school like Yale. But the reason for this, in large extent, is because to get to Yale they give you an IQ test, the SAT. So, the same for graduate school. There is the GRE, which is yet another IQ test. So, to some extent, it's a self-fulfilling prophecy. Society could choose to make how tall you are extremely important for educational success. They could say nobody under six feet tall gets into Yale. And then some psych professor would stand up and say, "Of course, height is profoundly related to educational accomplishment," and it would be because people made it so.

So, to some extent, the society that draws highly on IQ tests regarding promotion and educational achievement and military status and so on—it's just going to follow that IQ then becomes important. At the same time, however, the role of IQ is pretty clearly not entirely a social construction. There is some evidence that your IQ score relates to intelligence in an interesting sense including domains like mental speed and memory span. So, your score on an IQ test, for instance, is to some extent related to how fast you could think and your memory abilities.

41. Write a short essay of about 300 words based on your understanding of the excerpt. Remember to write in your OWN words. Your essay should respond to the following questions:

- (1) What argument of *The Bell Curve* is discussed here?
- (2) What did scholars agree and disagree regarding the importance of IQ?
- (3) In what way is intelligence a social construction, and in what way is it a non-social construction according to the excerpt?
- (4) Do you believe IQ tests as described in the excerpt indicate one's intelligence? Explain why.

2020 阅读大赛复赛第二场 (2020 年 10 月 31 日)

Directions : In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Questions 1-3 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following quotes. Match the quotes with the people.

Please note there are two extra options you do not need.

- A. Francis Bacon
- B. Thomas Henry Huxley
- C. Charles Dickens
- D. Bertrand Russell
- E. Ernest Hemingway

1.

Three passions, simple but overwhelmingly strong, have governed my life: the longing for love, the search for knowledge, and unbearable pity for the suffering of mankind. These passions, like great winds, have blown me hither and thither, in a wayward course, over a deep ocean of anguish, reaching to the very verge of despair. D

答案 : D

2.

The chess-board is the world; the pieces are the phenomena of the universe; the rules of the game are what we call the laws of nature. The player on the other side is hidden from us. We know that his play is always fair, just and patient. But also we know, to our cost, that he never overlooks a mistake, or makes the smallest allowance for ignorance. B

答案 : B

3.

The world breaks everyone, and afterward, many are strong at the broken places. E

答案 : E

Question 4 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Every year, millions of people find ways to transition out of poverty—by adopting new farming technologies, investing in new business opportunities, or finding new jobs. We know women and girls have a unique power to reshape societies. When you invest in a woman’s health and empowerment, it has a ripple effect, helping families, communities, and countries achieve long-lasting benefits.

4. Where is the piece of text most probably taken from?

考试时的选项顺序

A) A news report concerning poverty.

- B) An introduction to an organization.
- C) An advertisement about investment.
- D) A promotional material for charity. ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) A promotional material for charity. ✓
- B) A news report concerning poverty.
- C) An introduction to an organization.
- D) An advertisement about investment.

Question 5 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Many human languages have words for emotions such as “anger” and “fear,” yet it is not clear whether these emotions have similar meanings across languages, or why their meanings might vary. We estimate emotion semantics across a sample of 2,474 spoken languages using “colexification”—a phenomenon in which languages name semantically related concepts with the same word. Analyses show significant variation in networks of emotion concept colexification, which is predicted by the geographic proximity of language families. We also find evidence of universal structure in emotion colexification networks, with all families differentiating emotions primarily on the basis of hedonic valence and physiological activation. Our findings

contribute to debates about universality and diversity in how humans understand and experience emotion.

5. What is the best title for this text?

考试时的选项顺序

A) The reasons why people in different places experience similar emotions

B) Cultural variation and universal structure shown in emotion semantics ✓

C) The commonness and individuality of different languages

D) Comparison of cultural connotations of emotional words

原始的选项顺序

A) Comparison of cultural connotations of emotional words

B) The commonness and individuality of different languages

C) Cultural variation and universal structure shown in emotion semantics ✓

D) The reasons why people in different places experience similar emotions

Question 6 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

The Lipstick Effect is the theory that when facing an economic crisis or the economy is in a recession, _____. For _____

example, instead of buying expensive fur coats, women will purchase expensive lipstick or luxury cologne.

The underlying implication is that consumers will buy luxury goods even if there is a crisis. When consumer confidence in the economy is low, people will buy goods that fulfill luxury indulgences without breaking the bank. Outside the cosmetics market, consumers could buy expensive beer or pick an Audi over a Ferrari.

Think of it this way: It is much easier on the wallet to go for a nice dinner and movie than fly off to Europe for a summer holiday.

6. Which of the following statements best fits in the blank in the text?

考试时的选项顺序

A) consumers tend to purchase more luxury goods of lower cost

B) consumers will be more likely to think twice before buying luxury goods

C) consumers tend to avoid consuming expensive luxury goods

D) consumers will be more willing to buy less costly luxury goods ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) consumers tend to avoid consuming expensive luxury goods
- B) consumers tend to purchase more luxury goods of lower cost
- C) consumers will be more willing to buy less costly luxury goods ✓
- D) consumers will be more likely to think twice before buying luxury goods

Question 7 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

When a friend is having a hard time, it can be difficult to know how to provide support. Should you try to cheer your friend up, convincing him or her that everything will be OK? Positive people do tend to be more likeable in general—but when it comes to providing social support, positivity can come across as _____. A recent study in my lab asked people what they find most helpful and most unhelpful when they are awaiting important news. Although some people said they appreciate when friends or loved ones encourage them to be optimistic, it was far more common for people to find this kind of interaction downright annoying. In the words of one of our participants, “People telling me not to worry annoyed me. They shouldn’t tell me how to feel.”

7. The missing words may be _____.

考试时的选项顺序

- A) beneficial but irritating B) dismissive or insensitive ✓
C) prompt but implicit D) important or momentous

原始的选项顺序

- A) prompt but implicit B) beneficial but irritating
C) dismissive or insensitive ✓ D) important or momentous

Question 8 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Once your hospice benefit starts, Original Medicare will cover everything you need related to your terminal illness. Original Medicare will cover these services even if you choose to remain in a Medicare Advantage Plan or other Medicare health plan. If you were in a Medicare Advantage Plan before starting hospice care, you can stay in that plan, as long as you pay your plan's premiums.

If you stay in your Medicare Advantage Plan, you can choose to get services not related to your terminal illness from either providers in your plan's network or other Medicare providers.

If you choose to leave hospice care, your Medicare Advantage Plan won't start again until the first of the following month.

8. What is the most probable type of the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) A government policy. ✓
- B) An insurance commercial.
- C) A confidentiality contract.
- D) A security certificate.

原始的选项顺序

- A) A confidentiality contract.
- B) A security certificate.
- C) A government policy. ✓
- D) An insurance commercial.

Question 9 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Speed demon!

In this masterclass Jennifer looks at stamina-building exercises, improving your phrasing and adding attitude to your rock lead lines...

As a seasoned player and clinician, Jennifer has delivered masterclasses worldwide, helping players get the very best out of their practice time. Here, she looks at spicing up your technique by focusing on fundamentals such as vibrato, phrasing and bringing character into your playing. She also addresses the age old subject of developing speed and fluency on the  with a simple series of scale exercises – the very same regimen she used to temper her own technique early on

in her career. The key here is to dedicate some of your practice to a daily workout, noting your progress on a chart. It takes patience and persistence, but you're guaranteed to see results. Finally, Jennifer addresses some of the common pitfalls with picking-hand technique and the importance of trusting your instinct, watching other players at work and finding your own path. It all adds up to some invaluable advice from a top player, so fasten your seatbelts and enjoy the ride!

9. The key word in this text is stained. Which of the following is most likely to be the missing word?

考试时的选项顺序

A) baseball B) vehicle C) diving **D) guitar ✓**

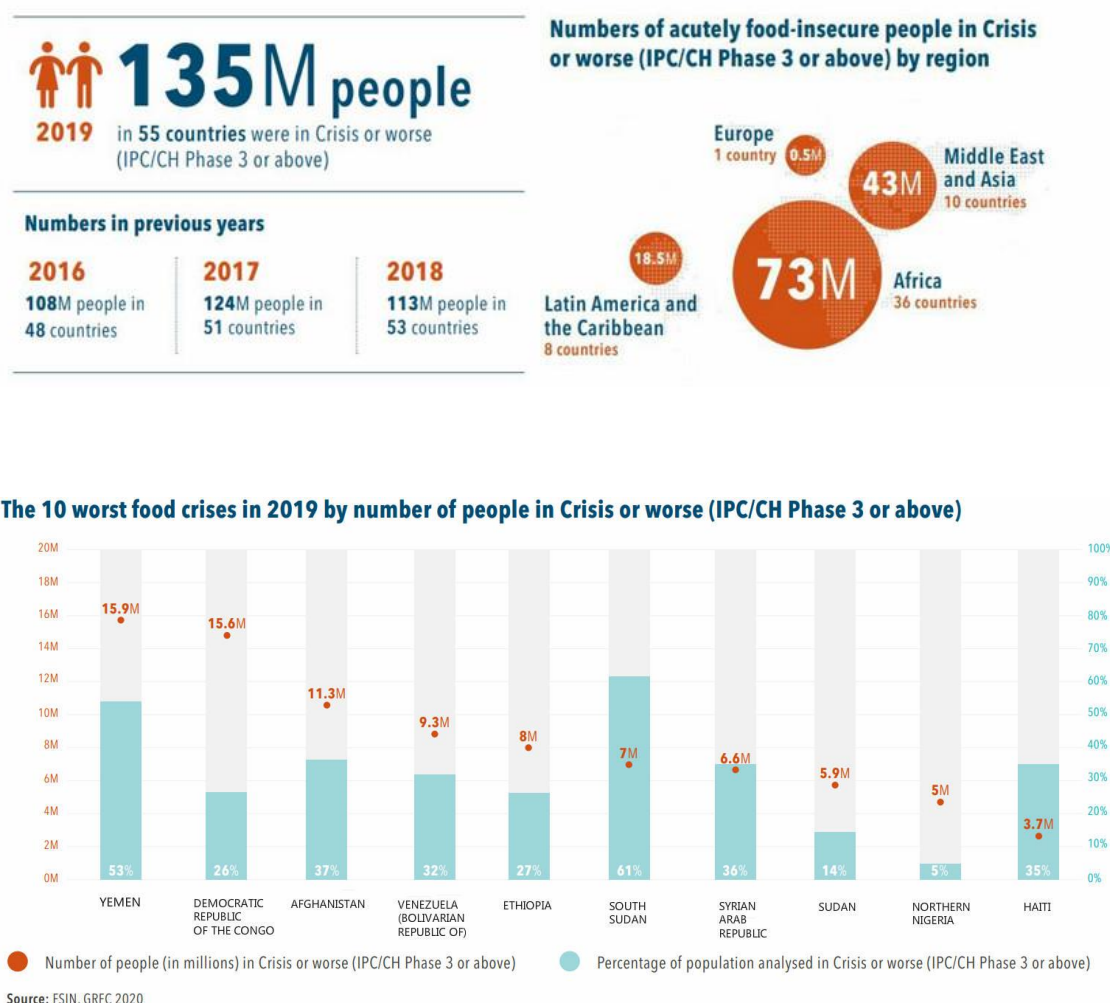
原始的选项顺序

A) baseball **B) guitar ✓** C) diving D) vehicle

Question 10 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: In the countries where the government and food security stakeholders have adopted the IPC/CH as the protocols for classifying the magnitude of acute food insecurity, the number of people in Crisis or worse

(IPC/CH Phase 3 or above) corresponds to the highest estimates registered for the calendar year, independent of seasonality. The following charts demonstrate the population in Crisis or worse from 2016 to 2019, the population in Crisis or worse by region and the 10 worst food crises in 2019. Answer the question according to the information in the charts.



10. Which of the following is correct according to the charts?

考试时的选项顺序

A) With more countries taking the IPC/CH as the protocols,

the number of people in Crisis or worse keeps increasing as well.

B) With 15.9 million of the population analysed in Crisis or worse, Yemen had the highest prevalence of acute food insecurity.

C) Africa remained as the continent most affected by food crises, accounting for half of the global number of people in Crisis or worse.

D) Ten countries constituted the worst food crises and accounted for nearly two thirds of the total population in Crisis or worse. ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) With more countries taking the IPC/CH as the protocols, the number of people in Crisis or worse keeps increasing as well.

B) Africa remained as the continent most affected by food crises, accounting for half of the global number of people in Crisis or worse.

C) Ten countries constituted the worst food crises and accounted for nearly two thirds of the total population in Crisis or worse. ✓

D) With 15.9 million of the population analysed in Crisis or worse, Yemen had the highest prevalence of acute food insecurity.

Directions : In Part II, you will read short texts on different subjects. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 55 minutes)

Question 11 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the example of a logical fallacy and answer the question according to the example.

Child: "Can we get a dog?"

Parent: "No."

Child: "It would protect us."

Parent: "Still, no."

Child: "Why do you want to leave us and our house unprotected?"

11. Which of the following logical fallacies does the example typically illustrate?

考试时的选项顺序

A) **Burden of Proof:** This fallacy occurs when someone who is making a claim puts the burden of proof on another party to disprove what they are claiming.

B) **Ad Hominem:** This fallacy occurs when, instead of addressing the opponent's argument, someone irrelevantly

attacks the opponent or some aspect of the opponent.

C) **Straw Man:** This fallacy occurs when an argument is based on misrepresentation of an opponent's position. To "set up a straw man" or "set up a straw man argument" is to create a position that is easy to refute, then attribute that position to the opponent. ✓

D) **Division:** This fallacy occurs when someone argues that something that is true for the whole is also true for the parts of the whole.

原始的选项顺序

A) **Straw Man:** This fallacy occurs when an argument is based on misrepresentation of an opponent's position. To "set up a straw man" or "set up a straw man argument" is to create a position that is easy to refute, then attribute that position to the opponent. ✓

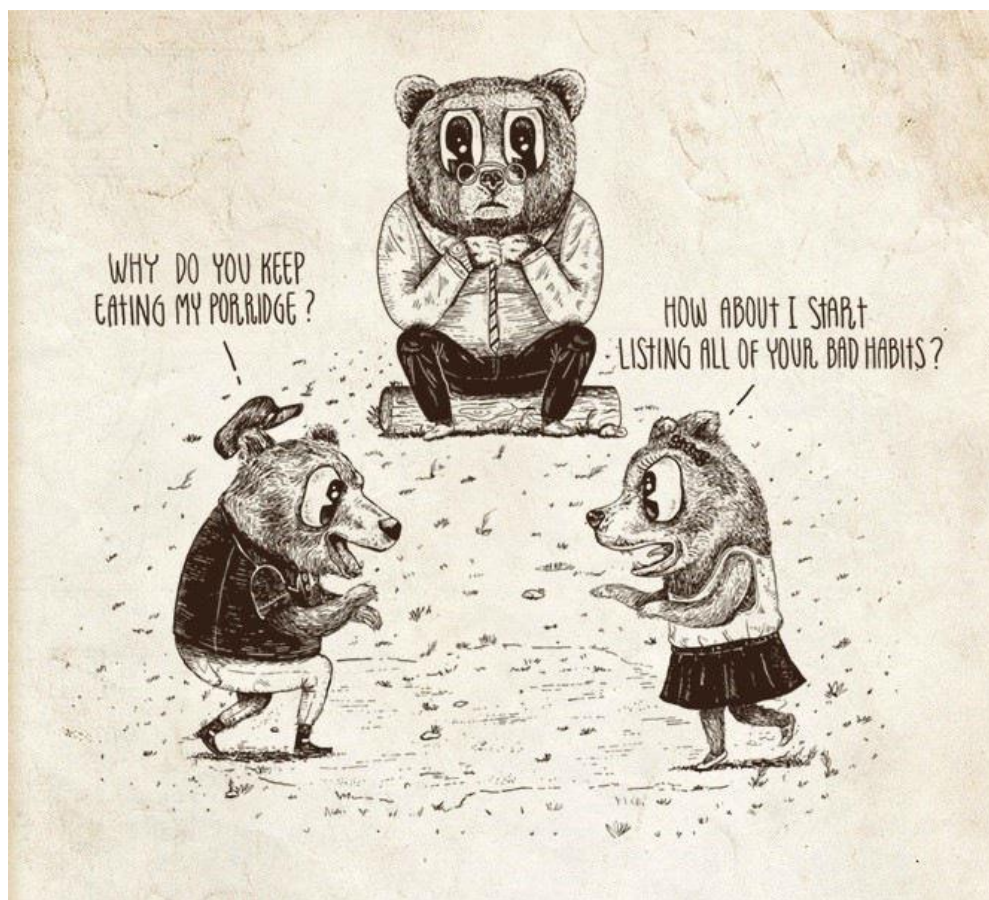
B) **Division:** This fallacy occurs when someone argues that something that is true for the whole is also true for the parts of the whole.

C) **Burden of Proof:** This fallacy occurs when someone who is making a claim puts the burden of proof on another party to disprove what they are claiming.

D) **Ad Hominem:** This fallacy occurs when, instead of addressing the opponent's argument, someone irrelevantly attacks the opponent or some aspect of the opponent.

Question 12 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Look at the cartoon of a logical fallacy and answer the question according to the cartoon.



12. Which of the following logical fallacies does the cartoon typically illustrate?

考试时的选项顺序

A) **Appeal to Ignorance:** This fallacy assumes a proposition to be true simply because there is no evidence proving that it

is not.

B) Appeal to Hypocrisy: This fallacy involves countering a charge with a charge, rather than addressing the issue being raised, with the intention of diverting attention away from the original argument. ✓

C) Guilt by Association: This fallacy discredits an argument for proposing an idea that is shared by some socially demonized individual or group.

D) No True Scotsman: This fallacy argues that all people belonging to a certain group have the same trait, and those in that group who do not share that trait are not really part of that group.

原始的选项顺序

A) Appeal to Ignorance: This fallacy assumes a proposition to be true simply because there is no evidence proving that it is not.

B) Guilt by Association: This fallacy discredits an argument for proposing an idea that is shared by some socially demonized individual or group.

C) Appeal to Hypocrisy: This fallacy involves countering a charge with a charge, rather than addressing the issue being

raised, with the intention of diverting attention away from the original argument. ✓

D) **No True Scotsman:** This fallacy argues that all people belonging to a certain group have the same trait, and those in that group who do not share that trait are not really part of that group.

Questions 13-14 Reasoning (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

13.

Biting one's fingernails makes a person nervous and edgy. I know a dozen people who bite their fingernails, and they're all high-strung. If you want to be a more relaxed person, stop biting your fingernails.

Which of the following indicates the logical flaw in the argument above?

考试时的选项顺序

A) It draws an analogy between two unrelated conditions.

B) It supports a conclusion other than the one it is meant to support.

C) It reverses the cause and effect relationship. ✓

D) It creates a general rule based on a single case.

原始的选项顺序

- A) It reverses the cause and effect relationship. ✓
- B) It creates a general rule based on a single case.
- C) It draws an analogy between two unrelated conditions.
- D) It supports a conclusion other than the one it is meant to support.
-

14.

Tech in the classroom not only leads to worse educational outcomes for kids, which I will explain shortly, it can also clinically hurt them. I've worked with over a thousand teens in the past 15 years and have observed that students who have been raised on a high-tech diet not only appear to struggle more with attention and focus, but also seem to suffer from an adolescent malaise that appears to be a direct byproduct of their digital immersion. Indeed, over two hundred peer-reviewed studies point to screen time correlating to increased ADHD (Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder), screen addiction, increased aggression, depression, anxiety and even psychosis.

Which of the following most seriously weakens the argument above?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Despite all the drawbacks it may have, educational technology boasts numerous advantages.

B) There is no causal relationship between the use of

technology and students' physical and mental health. ✓

C) Research suggests that students concentrate on texts on screens more easily than on printed materials.

D) Technology in the classroom can enhance learning experience and information dissemination.

原始的选项顺序

A) Technology in the classroom can enhance learning experience and information dissemination.

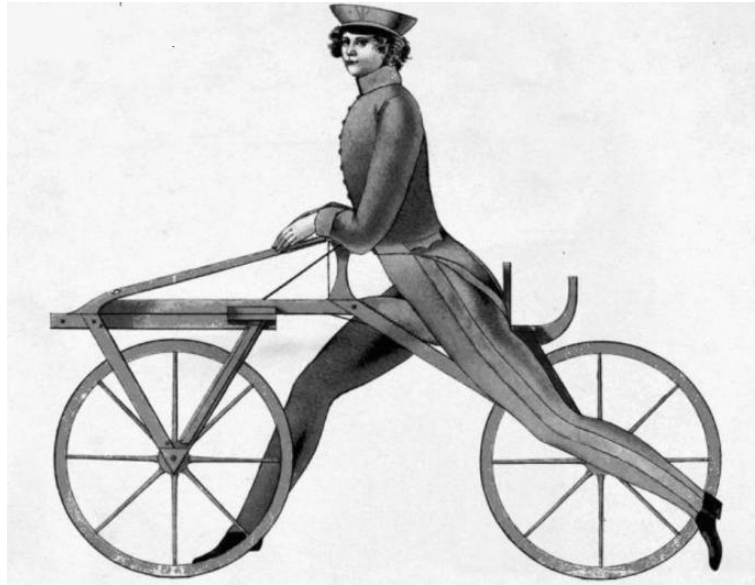
B) Despite all the drawbacks it may have, educational technology boasts numerous advantages.

C) There is no causal relationship between the use of technology and students' physical and mental health. ✓

D) Research suggests that students concentrate on texts on screens more easily than on printed materials.

Questions 15-16 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.



The eruption in April 1815 of Mount Tambora, a volcano in what is now Indonesia, was one of the largest in recorded history. A vast plume of dust and ash spread around the world, blocking out the sun and reducing global temperatures. In China the cold weather killed trees, crops and water buffalo. In North America a “dry fog” reddened the sun and there was summer snowfall in New York. Riots and looting broke out in Europe as harvests failed. Food prices soared and tens of thousands of people died from famine and disease. Horses starved or were slaughtered, as the high price of oats forced people to choose whether to feed their animals or themselves.

This last predicament prompted Karl von Drais, a German inventor, to devise a personal-transport machine to replace the horse: a two-wheeled wooden contraption which he called the *Laufmaschine* (literally, “running machine”). Sitting on a saddle, Drais propelled it by planting his feet on the ground and pushing every few metres, while steering it using a tiller. A demonstration ride,

in which he travelled 40 miles in four hours, showed that it was as fast as a trotting horse, and could be powered by its rider without much effort. The tricky part was keeping it balanced while gliding along, which took some practice.

Drais' invention didn't replace the horse: The weather returned to normal, leading to a bumper harvest in 1817. Even so, enthusiasts continued to improve on his design. The crucial addition of pedals occurred in France in the 1860s. Other refinements included better brakes, a steel frame, lightweight metal wheels and a chain to drive them. By the late 1880s these elements had been combined into a recognisably modern design: the bicycle.

An invention prompted by the challenges of a long-forgotten global crisis thus ended up spreading around the world and becoming part of everyday life. Who would have guessed, after all, that a volcano would give rise to the bicycle?

15. What difficulty did people have in riding Drais' bicycle?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) How to propel it using feet.
- B) How to drive it faster.
- C) How to steer it using a tiller.
- D) How to keep it in balance. ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) How to steer it using a tiller.
- B) How to propel it using feet.

C) How to keep it in balance. ✓

D) How to drive it faster.

16. What is the best title for this text?

A) How bicycles got refined step by step

B) Why global crises are the mother of invention ✓

C) The real value behind the invention of bicycles

D) The unexpected consequence of a volcano eruption

答案：B

Questions 17-19 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.



Here's a quiz. Take the following five names: Leesa, Purple, Nectar, Casper and Tuft & Needle. Can you spot what they have in common? (Hint: You may need to sleep on it.)

Answer: They're all online mattress retailers. Only Tuft & Needle gives the slightest suggestion of the product. The rest could be hawking anything from single-origin espresso to electric scooters.

The earliest brand names typically followed the surnames of their founders. When an English candlemaker, William Procter, teamed up with an Irish soapmaker, James Gamble, in 19th-century America, he created a brand styling that makes up in longevity what it lacks in imagination. Today's brand names tend to be more _____17_____. The founders of Warby Parker, an online eyewear company, sifted through thousands of iterations before settling on a mashup of two characters from Jack Kerouac's *On the Road*.

Some names are reached by playing around with words. The messaging company Slack, for example, made an acronym out of "Searchable Log of All Conversation and Knowledge". The name also neatly conjures up the productivity problems its technology is there to solve.

Startups want short names like Slack that stand out, yet are somehow familiar (psychologists call this sweet spot in human preference "optimal distinctiveness"). Many companies try to achieve this by using first names of the sort we might give our children. Casper, an online mattress seller, was

named for an old college friend of the founders. “We realised that having something that makes it feel like it could be a person actually kind of lets your guard down a little bit and lets you have that deeper connection,” explained Neil Parikh, one of its founders. With nearly 200 other firms in the online mattress market, consumers might also not have noticed another company with “sleep” or “rest” in its name.

We assign meanings to the aural quality of words as well as their semantic associations: Casper sounds soothing, a soft echo of “whisper”. One study has found that participants assumed an ice cream called “Frosh” would be smoother and creamier than one named “Frish”. Casper also has the combination of familiarity and novelty that makes for a fashionable baby name.

Both parents and brand creators need to be sure that the name they give their baby passes the grocery-store test—how does it sound when you call it aloud in a public place? In both cases, it should be a name they can grow into, and age gracefully with. After all, brands want us to forge with them what we have with our kids: a lifelong bond.

17. Which of the following expressions best fits in the blank in the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) **painstakingly contrived** ✓ B) imposingly fashionable
C) emotionally appealing D) strikingly unconventional

原始的选项顺序

- A) imposingly fashionable B) emotionally appealing
C) painstakingly contrived ✓ D) strikingly unconventional
-

18. Which of the following is true according to the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Brand creators should allow for future development of the company when naming a brand. ✓
- B) The name Slack reminds people of the productivity problems the company itself was facing.
- C) Many companies use the names of the founders' kids to achieve optimal distinctiveness.
- D) Both the pronunciation and the meaning of Casper give people a natural feeling of calmness.

原始的选项顺序

- A) Many companies use the names of the founders' kids to achieve optimal distinctiveness.
- B) Brand creators should allow for future development of the company when naming a brand. ✓
- C) The name Slack reminds people of the productivity problems the company itself was facing.
- D) Both the pronunciation and the meaning of Casper give

people a natural feeling of calmness.

19. What is the best title for this text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) The significance of good brand names
- B) The history of brands and branding
- C) The secret to a perfect brand name ✓
- D) Should brands use individual names?

原始的选项顺序

- A) The secret to a perfect brand name ✓
- B) The significance of good brand names
- C) The history of brands and branding
- D) Should brands use individual names?

Questions 20-22 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

My first experience with “visible mending” was when I dropped off a bag of my children’s worn-out jeans to a local seamstress and she returned them with brightly colored, patterned patches on all the knees, their lives miraculously extended by several more years. Both my kids and I loved those pants, so unique and impossible to buy, thanks to their handmade upgrades.

Visible mending (VM) is different from traditional mending in that it makes the repair a focal point, rather than blending it into the original garment. There are

many reasons for this, from drawing attention to the fact that a garment's lifespan has been prolonged and challenging the notion that secondhand clothes are only worn by the poor, to making a statement about fast fashion's reputation for disintegration or simply adding a personalized touch.

Kate Sekules is a well-known advocate for visible mending. The British-born, Brooklyn-based writer, clothes historian, and mending instructor has a new book called *MEND! A Refashioning Manual and Manifesto* (Penguin Random House, 2020). It is a call to action for clothes lovers of all skill levels to take needle and thread to their beloved garments. She reassures readers that anyone can do it:

"The skills are easy to acquire: Visible mending is for everyone, including the nonvisual and the all-thumbs and the sewing novice. It's experimental stitchery, mending improv, fun with thread, arty and exuberant and colorful and silly. The only way to go wrong is to say, 'I can't.' It's a craft, but of a modern cast, more art than Etsy (a global online marketplace, where people come together to make, sell, buy, and collect unique items). There are infinite ways to execute a VM, and there will never be another one like yours. And though you will never sew two mends the same, you will evolve a style of your own."

Sekules spends the first several chapters explaining why practicing visible mending matters so much. She writes at length about the current fashion industry, and how notoriously destructive it is, from the vast quantities of textile and plastic waste and toxic runoff poisoning rivers around the world, to the

horrific conditions in which garment workers work. She has little time or patience for corporate social responsibility (CSR) departments claiming they're taking action for human rights and the climate:

“Any CSR is infinitely better than no CSR, but significant change coming from something beginning with c—for corporate—is impossible. This is elementary mathematics. No massive fashion company can make both clothes and profit at scale. So of course they talk in *doublespeak*, offering, as LVMH (Louis Vuitton Moët Hennessy) did, ‘solutions that could enable economic growth while tackling the challenges of global warming.’ Translation: ‘Increasing profits while pondering the weird weather.’”

So, rather than wait around for the Big Guys to clean up their acts, we individuals can effect tiny yet meaningful changes by picking up our needles and thread and wearing our clothes for longer.

Sekules' book offers step-by-step instructions for assembling a mending kit and learning basic stitches, as well as techniques for dealing with various garment-related problems. She explains how to make an underpatch, a sort of reverse appliqué; how to ring a hole with eyelet stitch or a looser porthole; how to cover a hole or stain with a pocket; how to add descriptive words or “statemends” to a garment, drawing attention to its flaws; and how to add decorative “embellishmends”. Perhaps most amusing is the Greasytee fix, in which Sekules stitches circles around grease stains on her T-shirts. Similar is Paintypants, when she covers tiny splotches of paint with colored thread, using

a rainbow effect.

As someone who does not know how to sew at all, I tend to shy away from any mending projects (hence the seamstress to whom I deliver damaged items for repair). But Sekules' book does a remarkable job at making me think I actually could do this myself—and even want to try. A needle is less daunting than a sewing machine, and the diagrams in the book are so clear and simple that I am inspired to tackle my next holey T-shirt.

20. What can we infer about the author from the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) She is very familiar with fast fashion industry.
- B) She was too poor to buy new clothes for her kids.
- C) She has never done any visible mending by herself. ✓
- D) She learned how to sew from Kate Sekules.

原始的选项顺序

- A) She is very familiar with fast fashion industry.
 - B) She learned how to sew from Kate Sekules.
 - C) She was too poor to buy new clothes for her kids.
 - D) She has never done any visible mending by herself. ✓
-

21. Which of the following may NOT be the author's opinion on Sekules' book?

考试时的选项顺序

A) It is professional and classical. ✓

B) It is interesting and informative.

C) It is inspiring and readable.

D) It is persuasive and instructive.

原始的选项顺序

A) It is inspiring and readable.

B) It is persuasive and instructive.

C) It is interesting and informative.

D) It is professional and classical. ✓

22. Which of the following means the opposite to the word *doublespeak* in the sixth paragraph?

考试时的选项顺序

A) rhetoric B) assertion C) directness D) absurdity
✓

原始的选项顺序

A) assertion B) absurdity C) directness D) rhetoric
✓

Questions 23-24 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read an excerpt from *Impressions of America* by Oscar Wilde and answer the questions according to the excerpt.

I fear I cannot picture America as altogether an Elysium—perhaps, from the ordinary standpoint I know but little about the country. I cannot give its latitude or longitude; I cannot compute the value of its dry goods, and I have no very close acquaintance with its politics. These are matters which may not interest you, and they certainly are not interesting to me.

The first thing that struck me on landing in America was that if the Americans are not the most well-dressed people in the world, they are the most comfortably dressed. Men are seen there with the dreadful chimney-pot hat, but there are very few hatless men; men wear the shocking swallow-tail coat, but few are to be seen with no coat at all. There is an air of comfort in the appearance of the people which is a marked contrast to that seen in this country, where, too often, people are seen in close contact with rags.

The next thing particularly noticeable is that _____²³_____. This is a state of things which is not favourable to poetry or romance. Had Romeo or Juliet been in a constant state of anxiety about trains, or had their minds been agitated by the question of return-tickets, Shakespeare could not have given us those lovely balcony scenes which are so full of poetry and pathos.

America is the noisiest country that ever existed. One is waked up in the morning, not by the singing of the nightingale, but by the steam whistle. It is surprising that the sound practical sense of the Americans does not reduce this intolerable noise. All Art depends upon exquisite and delicate sensibility,

and such continual turmoil must ultimately be destructive of the musical faculty. There is not so much beauty to be found in American cities as in Oxford, Cambridge, Salisbury or Winchester, where are lovely relics of a beautiful age; but still there is a good deal of beauty to be seen in them now and then, but only where the American has not attempted to create it. Where the Americans have attempted to produce beauty they have signally failed. A remarkable characteristic of the Americans is the manner in which they have applied science to modern life.

23. Which of the following statements best fits in the blank?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) it is very difficult to get a train ticket
- B) everybody seems in a hurry to catch a train ✓
- C) literature is not appreciated in America
- D) people seldom read Shakespeare

原始的选项顺序

- A) people seldom read Shakespeare
 - B) it is very difficult to get a train ticket
 - C) literature is not appreciated in America
 - D) everybody seems in a hurry to catch a train ✓
-

24. Which of the following words best describes the writer's overall impression of America?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Negative. B) Mixed. ✓ C) Vague. D) Funny.

原始的选项顺序

A) Funny. B) Vague. C) Mixed. ✓ D) Negative.

Questions 25-27 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

Power is an important social lens through which we interact with others and society. The powerful have more influence on others and greater access to valuable resources such as food, education, jobs, and potential mates. The powerless have less access to these resources and are often dependent on the powerful. Ordinary people can get intoxicated by power or powerful roles. Just temporarily wearing a power-symbolizing uniform can re-code brain processes to create a new mindset.

An infamous 1971 Stanford University experiment showed

_____25_____. Philip Zimbardo and colleagues built a mock prison in the basement of Stanford University's psychology department. Each participant was randomly assigned to play a "guard" or "prisoner". Guards dressed like guards and were given whistles, whereas prisoners dressed like prisoners with identification numbers stamped on their smocks. The initial plan was to observe students for two weeks, but the study had to terminate in six

days. The guards became aggressive, insulting, and humiliating, whereas the prisoners became passive, helpless and emotionally disturbed.

The brains of powerful individuals react differently to social cues in ways that resemble psychopaths or patients with frontal brain damage. Psychopaths and some patients with brain damage lack empathy and the ability to take others' perspectives. Research has shown that power can deform the brain to act in the same ways. For example, people with high status have been shown to be less accurate in judging the emotions of people with low status.

In a clever paradigm, researchers explored the relationship between empathy-related brain area and power status. They compared the extent of mirroring (indirectly related to processes underlying empathy) in people who were primed with high or low power scenarios using transcranial magnetic stimulation (TMS). Priming was done by having participants at baseline write an essay on a specific incident in which they had more power over another person or write an essay in which someone had power over them. Then, participants in both groups (high and low power) watched videos of another person's actions.

Our human brain has mirror neural networks so that similar brain areas are activated when observing the actions of others. If you have ever experienced secondhand driving, you get the point! For example, if you are a piano player, and you observe another person playing the piano, the motor areas in your brain light up too!

Astonishingly, this “mirroring” _____²⁷_____. Just priming the participant with power (writing about an incident in which you had power) decreased mirroring of others’ actions. This creates an asymmetry in relationships between the powerful and powerless. In other words, the powerless are more attentive to the uniqueness of the powerful, and the powerful perceive the powerless in accordance with general stereotypes. Some researchers called this the default effect of power resulting in “reduced interpersonal sensitivity”. A myriad of research has shown that powerful people are more likely to rely on stereotypes.

25. Which of the following statements best fits in the blank in Paragraph 2?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) the powerless gradually become dependent on the powerful
- B) even a virtual environment could change people’s mindsets
- C) the mental impairment may be posed by role playing
- D) the extent of behavior changes when in uniform ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) the mental impairment may be posed by role playing
- B) the extent of behavior changes when in uniform ✓
- C) even a virtual environment could change people’s

mindsets

D) the powerless gradually become dependent on the powerful

26. Which of the following scenarios best illustrates the ideas in Paragraph 3?

考试时的选项顺序

A) A teacher assigns the same homework to all students regardless of their level.

B) The boss tells his clerk to return to work as soon as possible after his father's funeral. ✓

C) A manager asks his employee to work extra hours during the peak season.

D) Parents keep their children grounded during summer because they have skipped school.

原始的选项顺序

A) A manager asks his employee to work extra hours during the peak season.

B) A teacher assigns the same homework to all students regardless of their level.

C) The boss tells his clerk to return to work as soon as possible after his father's funeral. ✓

D) Parents keep their children grounded during summer because they have skipped school.

27. Which of the following statements best fits in the blank in the last paragraph?

考试时的选项顺序

A) vanishes in people under the influence of power ✓

B) clearly illustrates how power changes people's response to others

C) helps break down negative stereotypes of the powerless

D) further undermines the relationship between the powerful and powerless

原始的选项顺序

A) vanishes in people under the influence of power ✓

B) helps break down negative stereotypes of the powerless

C) clearly illustrates how power changes people's response to others

D) further undermines the relationship between the powerful and powerless

Questions 28-30 (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

Sometimes math really is a matter of life and death, particularly when it comes to the outbreak of a deadly disease and the strategies to control it. As well as helping us to understand the unusual features of different disease landscapes, mathematical models of epidemics allow us to peer into the future of disease progression and to take proactive preventive measures, rather than always playing reactive games of catch-up.

Mathematical epidemiology helps us answer a number of perplexing questions that surround childhood diseases such as mumps and rubella.

The idea that a large population of immune individuals can slow or even halt the spread of a disease, as with the dormant periods between outbreaks of childhood diseases, is a mathematical concept known as herd immunity. Surprisingly, this community effect does not require everyone to be immune to the disease for the whole population to be protected.

By reducing the effective reproduction number—the average number of secondary cases produced by a typical case—to less than one, the chain of transmission can be broken and the disease stopped in its tracks. Crucially, herd immunity means that those with immune systems too weak to tolerate vaccination—including the elderly, newborns, pregnant women and people with HIV—can still benefit from the protection of vaccinations.

Vaccinating only 80 percent of the susceptible population against smallpox was enough, in 1977, to complete one of the greatest accomplishments of our species—to wipe a human disease clean off the face of the Earth. The feat has

never been repeated. The debilitating and dangerous implications of smallpox infection alone made it a suitable target for eradication. Its low critical immunization threshold—the minimum proportion of the population that must be immunized in order for the infection to die out—also made it a relatively easy target.

Many diseases are harder to protect against because they spread more easily. Chicken pox would require 90 percent of the population to be immune before the rest would be effectively protected and the disease wiped out. Measles, by far the most infectious human-to-human disease on Earth would require between 92 percent and 95 percent of the population to be vaccinated. A study that modeled the spread of a 2015 Disneyland measles outbreak suggested vaccination rates among those exposed to the disease may have been as low as 50 percent, way below the threshold required for herd immunity.

28. What should people do to achieve herd immunity according to the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Wipe out the secondary cases produced by a typical case.
- B) Vaccinate vulnerable groups with immune system defects first.
- C) Make a large percentage of the population catch a

disease.

D) Limit the spread of disease by making most people

immune to it. ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) Wipe out the secondary cases produced by a typical

case.

B) Make a large percentage of the population catch a

disease.

C) Vaccinate vulnerable groups with immune system defects

first.

D) Limit the spread of disease by making most people

immune to it. ✓

29. Which one is NOT true about smallpox according to the text?

考试时的选项顺序

A) The devastation of smallpox made it an easier target for

elimination. ✓

B) Smallpox's low critical immunization threshold mattered a

lot in its eradication.

C) About four fifths of the population were vaccinated to

eradicate smallpox.

D) Eradicating smallpox was the first successful case of herd immunity in human history.

原始的选项顺序

A) The devastation of smallpox made it an easier target for elimination. ✓

B) About four fifths of the population were vaccinated to eradicate smallpox.

C) Smallpox's low critical immunization threshold mattered a lot in its eradication.

D) Eradicating smallpox was the first successful case of herd immunity in human history.

30. What is this text mainly about?

考试时的选项顺序

A) The new insights into the herd immunization threshold.

B) The medical benefits of herd immunity.

C) The application of math in preventing fatal diseases. ✓

D) The development of mathematical epidemiology.

原始的选项顺序

A) The medical benefits of herd immunity.

B) The development of mathematical epidemiology.

C) The application of math in preventing fatal diseases. ✓

D) The new insights into the herd immunization threshold.

Directions : In Part III, you will read passages on the same subject. You will be required to identify the writer’s position and evaluate the effectiveness of the writer’s arguments. (Time allowed: 35 minutes)

Questions 31-40 (Suggested completion time: 35 minutes)

Directions: Read three passages about digital textbooks. Answer the questions according to the passages.

Passage A

Pearson, like many publishers in higher education, has long signaled its intent to move from print textbooks to digital courseware.

But today the company went farther than anyone else—announcing that all of its 1,500 U.S. titles will become “digital first.”

From now on, instead of publishing new editions of print textbooks every few years, the publisher will focus its energy on its digital course materials.

These digital materials will be updated on an ongoing basis—reflecting new research developments, technology breakthroughs and the latest pedagogical trends. Print versions of the materials will still be widely available to rent, but students will be discouraged from buying them with relatively high pricing and limited availability.

Instead of the digital product being adapted from the print textbook, the process will be the other way around, said John Fallon, CEO of Pearson, in an interview. There is no fixed schedule for how frequently print versions will be created from the digital materials.

Print revisions were a costly and time-consuming process, he said. The company is now in a position to “break that cycle.”

Over half of all students now use at least one ebook as part of their studies, signaling increased acceptance of digital materials, said Fallon. He said that Pearson now has the technology to pull off the transition. The company’s Global Learning Platform, which has been in development for several years, will play a central role in enabling staff to update content in real time. “It’s been a huge investment, a big restructuring,” he said.

Of Pearson’s 1,500 active U.S. titles, 500 are currently digital first, said Fallon. He did not share how long he anticipates the transition to fully digital first will take, but he said the company is working to make it happen “as quickly as we possibly can.”

“We want students to have the best and most up-to-date content for the best price,” said Fallon. Pearson plans to lower its prices so that fewer students are tempted to buy secondhand books. It will also push its rental program so that fewer books ever enter the secondhand market.

With inclusive-access deals, where whole classes are signed up for a product and charged for access by their institution, the prices will be 30 to 40 percent

lower than those above. Over 700 universities now have inclusive-access deals with the publisher, accounting for about 9 percent of its sales, said Fallon.

Pearson is not the first publisher to announce its intention to make the transition from analog to digital. Brian Kibby, former president of McGraw-Hill Higher Education, predicted in 2012 that colleges and universities would be done with textbooks within the next three years. It didn't happen. But if other publishers follow Pearson's lead, a digital-first future seems inevitable.

For textbook authors, the change will be significant. As publishers invest more heavily in digital courseware with built-in assessments and learner analytics, they have started to sign fewer textbook authors.

Lisa Urry, professor of biology at Mills College, in California, has worked with Pearson as a co-author on the Campbell Biology textbook series since 2000. She said the shift to digital has been "a long time coming."

"We've been incorporating more and more digital assets into the books for some time," said Urry. "We recognized pedagogically that the way we were teaching needed to change. Students need to be more actively engaged."

Instead of revising textbooks every three years on a chapter-by-chapter basis, updates will now be done as and when authors think they are necessary. Urry said she is constantly thinking about how the books might be improved, so she doesn't think this will be a burden. "It's never been the case that I only thought about the books every three years or something like that," she said.

There are still lots of details to be worked out, such as how to update materials without disrupting teaching, but Urry is hopeful the shift will result in a better experience for students—one that is more interactive, engaging and informed by the latest pedagogical research.

Passage B

Use of free course materials among college students is up, with 22 percent downloading at least one such resource during the spring 2019 semester, according to research by the National Association of College Stores (NACS).

That's an all-time high, and a big increase since the fall of 2015, when only 3 percent of students reported downloading free course materials. The percent of students who reported downloading free materials has increased each semester since. That figure includes texts procured legally, like open educational resources (known as OER), and illegally, such as pirated files shared through torrent websites. The most recent data NACS has on the latter behavior is from the fall of 2017, when 4 percent of respondents reported obtaining materials through illegal downloads.

The practice of using pirated resources may be more prevalent in reality, however, since students can share such files in multiple ways, said Richard Hershman, vice president of government relations for the college-store association in an email interview: "Certainly publishers feel this is a major problem."

The survey includes responses from nearly 20,000 college students at 41 four-year and two-year institutions across 20 U.S. states and two Canadian provinces.

Its findings are of special interest in light of recent shifts in the textbook industry. For example, in mid-July 2019, publishing giant Pearson announced it will adopt a “digital first” strategy for updating college course materials. And earlier in 2019, two of the world’s largest publishers of textbooks, Cengage and McGraw-Hill, announced plans to merge, and plan to offer a subscription-based service that combines their digital libraries in one package.

Despite the reported increased use of free resources, most students still spend money on college course materials, either through purchasing texts outright or renting them from bookstores or online marketplaces.

However, the average amount spent in the 2018-2019 school year, \$415, fell from \$484 in the previous term, according to the report. The decrease follows a trend of near-steady spending decline going back at least 10 years to 2007-2008, when students reported spending an average of \$701 on course materials.

In a press briefing, Hershman cited several possible factors influencing falling spending. One is that college textbook price growth has dipped below general inflation rates in recent years, according to the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics Consumer Price Index. Another is the continued popularity of renting textbooks and relying on used, instead of new, materials.

A third may be the growth of so-called _____³⁶_____ programs. In these deals, colleges order published materials in bulk, then charge students a per-course fee that grants them access to all of the required texts and tools. This approach typically offers students lower prices than they can get at retail stores on new books, but some students complain that it stops them from finding lower prices on their own.

Colleges may be interested in inclusive access deals in part to address another notable finding from the NACS study: More students are relying on their own judgment about whether assigned materials are truly necessary.

More than a third of students reported showing up for the first day of class without any of their assigned materials. The top reason why? 64 percent said they wanted to wait to “see if I really needed materials” before acquiring them.

The high price of books was the top reason given by students who decided not to obtain the required texts, but 38 percent said they didn’t want them or didn’t think they’d need them.

This finding is echoed in research conducted by Barnes & Noble College, which runs more than 1,400 physical and virtual campus book stores in the U.S.

“Students want to wait to see if the professor is really going to use it and if it’s really going to be necessary for class,” says Lisa Malat, COO of Barnes & Noble College.

Passage C

Virginia Clinton prefers to read on a screen. Her love affair with digital texts began when she was a new mother, juggling the workload of a young academic with diapers and feedings. “I have warm, fuzzy memories of rocking my babies to sleep and reading one-handed on my phone,” Clinton said.

As an assistant professor of education at the University of North Dakota, Clinton had encouraged her students to save money on textbooks and buy cheaper digital versions or use free materials online. Her research specialty was reading comprehension. According to theories she learned in graduate school, she recalled, there should be no difference between reading on paper and reading on a screen.

But many of her education students told her they preferred paper, she said. Clinton decided to delve into all the studies published since 2008 about reading on screens. She compiled results from 33 high-quality studies that tested students’ comprehension after they were randomly assigned to read on a screen or on paper and found that her students might be right.

The studies showed that students of all ages, from elementary school to college, tend to absorb more when they’re reading on paper than on screens, particularly when it comes to nonfiction material. “Sometimes you should print it out, especially if it’s long,” said Clinton.

Clinton now tells her students to order the book if they prefer reading paper. “It’s enough of a benefit that it’s worth the paper and ink and the cost of the book,” she said.

The benefit for reading on paper was rather small, after averaging the studies together, Clinton said. But 29 of the 33 laboratory studies found that readers learned more from text on paper.

Clinton’s analysis, published earlier in 2019, is now at least the third study to synthesize reputable research on reading comprehension in the digital age and find that paper is better. It was preceded by a 2017 review by scholars at the University of Maryland and a 2018 meta-analysis by scholars in Spain and Israel. The international analysis arrived at nearly the same numerical conclusion as Clinton’s study. Paper beat screens by more than a fifth of a standard deviation. (Scholars argue over how to interpret these statistical units. For controlled laboratory studies like these, it’s a small advantage.)

The mounting research evidence against screens is important because it clashes with textbook publishers’ long-term plans to emphasize digital texts. Pearson, the largest textbook publisher in North America, announced in July 2019 that it was moving to a “digital first” strategy. Books will still be available to rent but students will be discouraged from buying them by higher prices, fewer updates and limited availability.

This reading research also runs counter to well-intended advice for students to save money. A July 2019 report from the National Association of College

Stores shows a record high 22 percent of college students are using free online course materials, up from 3 percent in 2015. Thanks to free online texts, overall spending on materials has decreased.

For proponents of digital texts, there is plenty to *quibble* about in the current research. The studies that Clinton included in her analysis didn't allow students to take advantage of the extra bells and whistles that digital texts can potentially offer. Some argue that these add-ons—such as pop-up quizzes in the middle of a reading passage to check for comprehension or instant definitions of unfamiliar words—are what give digital text an edge. In Clinton's underlying studies, students could only interact with a digital text as they do on paper. That pretty much restricted students to highlighting and note taking.

"My findings weren't fair to screens because the screens couldn't offer everything they could," Clinton said. "They were really just a shiny piece of paper."

Still, there isn't yet convincing proof that the digital add-ons improve reading comprehension or even match the reading comprehension that students can achieve with text on paper. Well-designed studies to test this don't exist. Clinton is planning to study reading comprehension with digital add-ons in her laboratory to see if digital texts will get better results.

31. According to Passage A, what can we learn about Pearson's "digital first" strategy?

A) Pearson is the first publisher to propose and implement it.

B) Pearson has put a large amount of capital into the project.

✓

C) Pearson will have no printed version for “digital first” books.

D) Pearson has adapted a third of textbooks from print to digital.

答案 : B

32. According to Passage A, which of the following is NOT mentioned by John Fallon, CEO of Pearson, as a reason for the launch of “digital first” at the moment?

A) The traditional publication is inefficient and expensive.

B) Both manpower and capital are ready for the change. ✓

C) The technology for it has been evolved to the point.

D) User acceptance of digital textbooks is rising.

答案 : B

33. According to Passage A, what does Lisa Urry, a co-author working with Pearson, think of “digital first”?

A) She expects more editorial work to do with it.

B) She has been looking forward to it for a long time.

C) She thinks it will bring about a revolution in textbooks.

D) She believes it will make students more involved in study.

34-35. Decide whether the statements are True or False

according to Passage B. ✓

答案 : D

34. The NACS's research finds that downloading has been the leading way for college students to obtain textbooks.

A) True B) False ✓

答案 : B

35. According to the NACS's research, the factor that affects most students' decision on whether to purchase course materials is not the price, but the professor and the class.

A) True B) False ✓

答案 : B

36. Which of the following terms best fits in the numbered space in Passage B?

A) secondhand books B) inclusive-access ✓

C) textbook rental D) digital-first

答案 : B

37. Which of the following is NOT true about Virginia Clinton's research according to Passage C?

A) Clinton drew her conclusions by conducting literature reviews and controlled experiments. ✓

B) Her findings were backed up by many other relevant studies, meanwhile questioned by some.

C) Clinton found the results were the opposite of what she had been taught as a college student.

D) Clinton is likely to carry out her future study in the laboratory by involving more variables.

答案 : A

38. The word *quibble* in Passage C means closest to _____.

A) complain

B) negotiate C) condemn D) deliberate

✓

答案 : A

39. Which of the following CANNOT be inferred from Passage C?

A) Publishers such as Pearson may not favour the result of Clinton's research.

B) Clinton's research has some fundamental defects to reach the conclusion.

C) There's scant evidence that the digital add-ons benefit reading comprehension.

D) Clinton is not so willing to accept her finding that screens lost to paper reading. ✓

答案 : D

40. Which of the following is INCORRECT according to the three passages?

A) All the three passages mention Pearson's "digital first" strategy and its feasibility in days to come.

B) All the three passages involve studies on students and their feedback on the use of paper and screen. ✓

C) There is still much research to be done on students' acceptance and better use of digital textbooks.

D) Statistics are offered on the textbook price or the proportion of students who use online course materials.

答案 : B

Directions : In Part IV, you will read a passage and then write a short essay according to it. You should write with clarity and logic. (Time allowed: 40 minutes)

Question 41 (Suggested completion time: 40 minutes)

Directions: Read an excerpt taken from *Walden*, a collection of Henry David Thoreau's writings. Write a short essay according to the excerpt.

However mean your life is, meet it and live it; do not shun it and call it hard names. It is not so bad as you are. It looks poorest when you are richest. The fault-finder will find faults even in paradise. Love your life, poor as it is. You may perhaps have some pleasant, thrilling, glorious hours, even in a poor-house. The setting sun is reflected from the windows of the almshouse* as brightly as from the rich man's abode; the snow melts before its door as early in the spring. I do not see but a quiet mind may live as contentedly there, and have as cheering thoughts, as in a palace. The town's poor seem to me often to live the most independent lives of any. Maybe they are simply great enough to receive without misgiving. Most think that they are above being supported by the town; but it oftener happens that they are not above supporting themselves by dishonest means, which should be more disreputable.

Cultivate poverty like a garden herb, like sage. Do not trouble yourself much to get new things, whether clothes or friends. Turn the old; return to them. Things do not change; we change. Sell your clothes and keep your thoughts. If I were confined to a corner of a garret all my days, like a spider, the world would be just as large to me while I had my thoughts about me. The philosopher said: "From an army of three divisions one can take away its general, and put it in disorder; from the man the most abject and vulgar one cannot take away his thought." Do not seek so anxiously to be developed, to subject yourself to many influences to be played on; it is all dissipation.

Humility like darkness reveals the heavenly lights. The shadows of poverty and meanness gather around us, “and lo! creation widens to our view.” We are often reminded that if there were bestowed on us the wealth of Croesus*, our aims must still be the same, and our means essentially the same.

Moreover, if you are restricted in your range by poverty, if you cannot buy books and newspapers, for instance, you are but confined to the most significant and vital experiences; you are compelled to deal with the material which yields the most sugar and the most starch. It is life near the bone where it is sweetest. You are defended from being a trifler. No man loses ever on a lower level by magnanimity on a higher. Superfluous wealth can buy superfluities only. Money is not required to buy one necessary of the soul.

*almshouse: a house built originally by a charitable person or organization for poor people to live in

*Croesus: the last king of Lydia renowned for his great wealth; a very wealthy person

41. Write a short essay of about 300 words based on your understanding of the excerpt. Remember to write in your OWN words. Your essay should complete the following tasks with examples in the excerpt.

(1) Summarize the text by answering two questions: How does Thoreau understand poor life in the excerpt? How should we treat poverty according to Thoreau? (No less than 200 words)

(2) Make comments on Thoreau’s idea about lifestyle.

2020 阅读大赛复赛第一场 (2020 年 10 月 24 日)

Directions : In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Questions 1-3 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following introductions. Match the introductions with the people. Please note there are two extra options you do not need.

A. Arthur Conan Doyle

B. Edgar Allan Poe

C. Herman Melville

D. F. Scott Fitzgerald

E. William Faulkner

1. B Known as an American author and poet of the Romantic Movement, he rose to critical acclaim for his poetry and short stories by the early 1800's. His work also ventured in the genres of the macabre and mystery.

答案 : B

2. D His most famous novel was published in 1925. Set during the Roaring 20s, the book tells the story of a group of wealthy, often hedonistic residents of the fictional New York towns of West Egg and East Egg. The novel critiques the idea of the American Dream, suggesting that the concept has been corrupted by the careless pursuit of decadence. Though the novel was poorly received in

his lifetime, it is now considered a cornerstone of American literature.

答案 : D

3. E More than simply a renowned Mississippi writer, the Nobel Prize-winning novelist and short story writer is acclaimed as one of the twentieth century's greatest writers. He never graduated from high school, living in a small town in the poorest state in the nation, but wrote a series of novels all set in the same small Southern county during the Great Depression.

答案 : E

Question 4 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

About the size of its owner's clenched fist, the organ sits in the middle of the chest, behind the breastbone and between the lungs, in a moistened chamber that is protected all round by the rib cage. It's made up of a special kind of muscle (cardiac muscle) that works involuntarily, so we don't have to think about it.

4. What is the most probable type of the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) A science article. ✓ B) An operation guide.
C) A science fiction. D) An installing instruction.

原始的选项顺序

- A) A science fiction. B) A science article. ✓

- C) An operation guide. D) An installing instruction.

Question 5 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

While traditional pricing strategies appeal to all segments of the market, price skimming tends to aid in capturing early adopters. These buyers are willing to pay a higher rate in exchange for being one of the first people to own a product.

Not only do early adopters contribute to your bottom line, they also act as brand ambassadors, encouraging others to try out your goods and services.

Once early adopters have spread the word about your products to other audiences, the firm can lower prices to capture these buyers. The goal is to drop your prices before a copycat company comes in and attempts to undersell you.

Early adopters could also be advantageous because they allow you to change your product before reaching the rest of your consumers.

Early adopters make up a small segment of the market, as there aren't many people who are willing to pay a premium for a brand new product.

5. Which of the following statements CANNOT be inferred from the text?

考试时的选项顺序

A) The product launched with a price skimming strategy is ahead of the competition.

B) It is necessary to have an established well-known brand

in order to use price skimming. ✓

C) Early adopters bring significant benefits to the promotion of a product with price skimming.

D) The price skimming strategy is particularly fit for the introduction phase of a product.

原始的选项顺序

A) The product launched with a price skimming strategy is ahead of the competition.

B) The price skimming strategy is particularly fit for the introduction phase of a product.

C) It is necessary to have an established well-known brand in order to use price skimming. ✓

D) Early adopters bring significant benefits to the promotion of a product with price skimming.

Question 6 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

The Irish Potato Famine, also known as the Great Hunger, began in 1845 when a fungus-like organism called *Phytophthora infestans* (or *P. infestans*) spread rapidly throughout Ireland. ①The infestation ruined up to one-half of the potato crop that year, and about three-quarters of the crop over the next seven years. ②Before it ended in 1852, the Potato Famine resulted in the

death of roughly one million Irish from starvation and related causes, with at least another million forced to leave their homeland as refugees. ③Because the tenant farmers of Ireland—then ruled as a colony of Great Britain—relied heavily on the potato as a source of food, the infestation had a catastrophic impact on Ireland and its population.

6. What is the right order of the numbered sentences?

考试时的选项顺序

A) ① ③ ② ✓ B) ② ③ ① C) ① ② ③ D) ② ① ③

原始的选项顺序

A) ② ③ ① B) ② ① ③ C) ① ② ③ D) ① ③ ② ✓

Question 7 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

In principle weight loss is easy: if you consistently burn more calories than you ingest, you will lose weight. In practice, though, losing weight is very difficult and not many people succeed. Some people think that the obesity crisis is caused by our *obesogenic* environment, a world where food is ever-present and we are continuously encouraged and stimulated to eat more low quality and energy-dense products.

7. What is the meaning of the word *obesogenic*?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Encouraging unrestrained consumption.
- B) Being so excessive as to be offensive.
- C) Promoting excessive weight gain. ✓
- D) Allowing you to eat whatever you want.

原始的选项顺序

- A) Being so excessive as to be offensive.
- B) Promoting excessive weight gain. ✓
- C) Allowing you to eat whatever you want.
- D) Encouraging unrestrained consumption.

Question 8 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Wherever you purchase gifts, there are social influences on what you buy.

There's an interesting economic phenomenon called value attribution, where we imbue objects or people with qualities based on our perceived values rather than on objective data.

For example, people enjoy a play more if the tickets cost more, and will return to see more shows than people given a discount. If something costs less, we judge it as inferior.

A great example of this is when *The Washington Post* dressed up one of the most famous violinists of all time as a street musician and watched people

stroll by without noticing. Because they hadn't paid for the performance, those walking by didn't value the incredible music they were hearing.

8. Which of the following is true according to this text?

考试时的选项顺序

A) We tend to attribute the value of something to the thing itself instead of its context.

B) A high price of a product may induce perceived qualities not seen in the lower price. ✓

C) The passers-by attributed the violinist's performance quality to his facial appearance.

D) An attractive appearance may lead to a perception that a product works better.

原始的选项顺序

A) An attractive appearance may lead to a perception that a product works better.

B) A high price of a product may induce perceived qualities not seen in the lower price. ✓

C) We tend to attribute the value of something to the thing itself instead of its context.

D) The passers-by attributed the violinist's performance quality to his facial appearance.

Question 9 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Midway through grad school, a friend asked me to volunteer as a barback—bartender’s assistant—at the opening gala for a film festival. I was hesitant at first, having never worked behind a bar. But I said yes, lured by the offer of free tickets to the festival. I spent an evening running around like a chicken with its head cut off: slicing fruit, replacing liquor bottles, and doing other menial tasks. By the end of the night, I was tired and sweaty and I’d dropped an expensive bottle of vodka. But I felt incredible—in awe of how much fun I had—and I went home and slept better than I had in years. The event forced me to reflect on _____. It was a turning point in my grad school experience.

9. Which of the following best fits in the blank in the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) what I should do to embrace my life to the fullest
- B) how to refresh myself when feeling lost and hesitated
- C) what brings me happiness and a clear state of mind ✓
- D) how to get out of annoyance and find real peace

原始的选项顺序

- A) how to get out of annoyance and find real peace
- B) what brings me happiness and a clear state of mind ✓

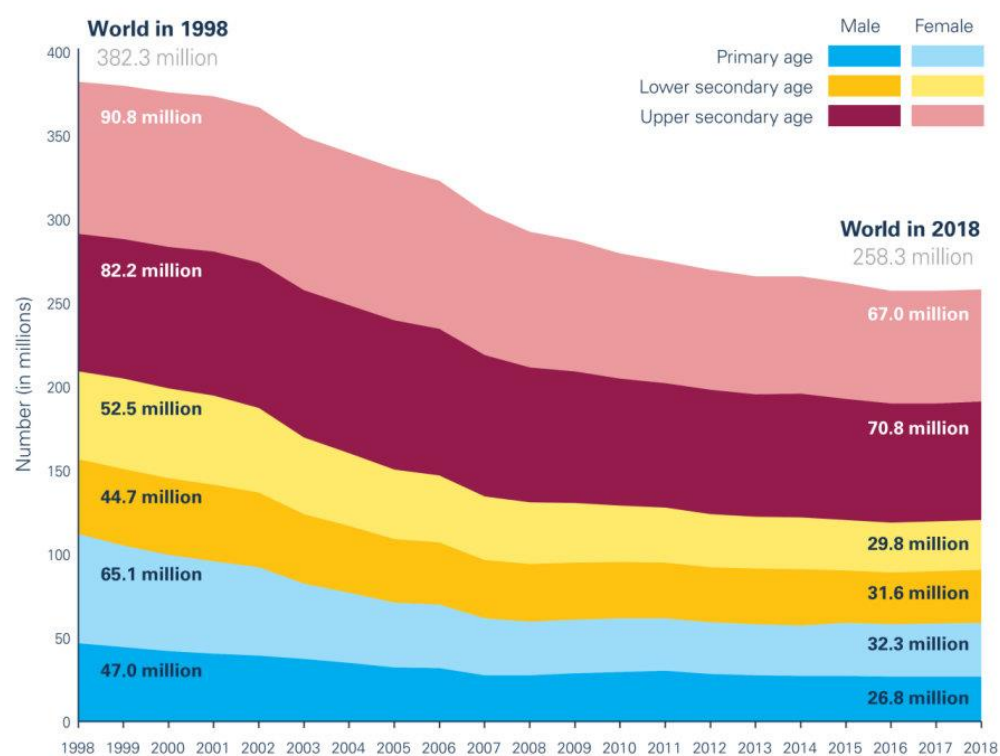
C) how to refresh myself when feeling lost and hesitated

D) what I should do to embrace my life to the fullest

Question 10 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

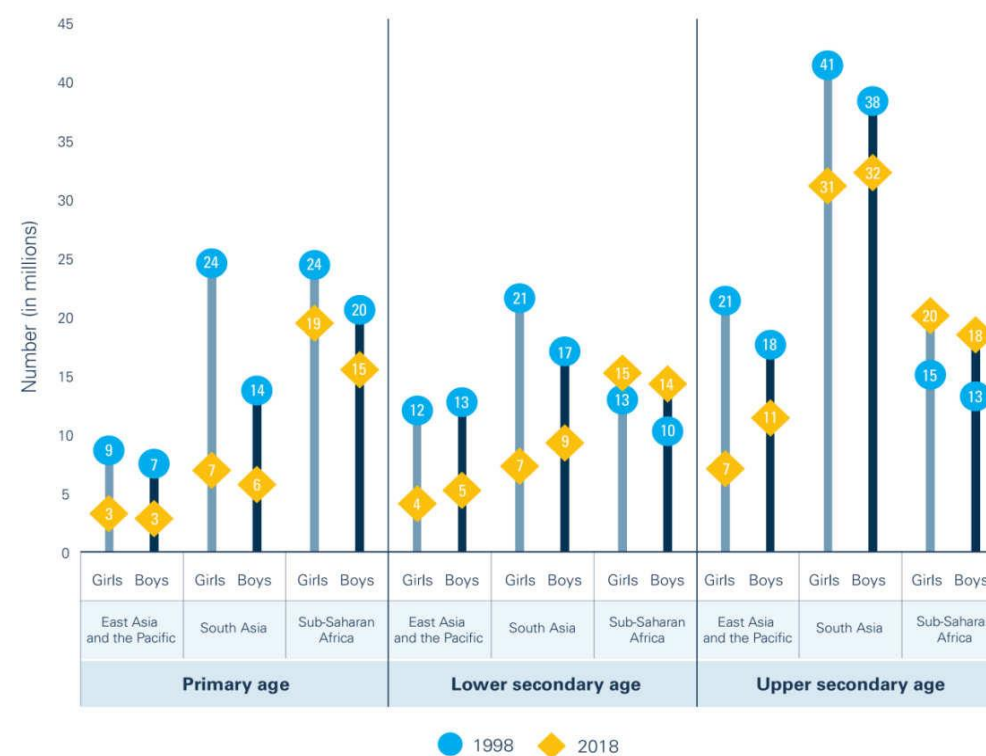
Directions: Study the following two figures and answer the question according to the information in the figures.

Figure 1. Number of out-of-school children, by level of education and sex, 1998–2018



Source: UNESCO Institute for Statistics (UIS), September 2019.

Figure 2. Number of out-of-school children, by sex, level of education, select regions, 1998* and 2018



Source: UNESCO Institute for Statistics (UIS), September 2019.

Note: *For South Asia, the first data point for lower secondary age and upper secondary age is 1999.

10. Which of the following is INCORRECT according to the figures?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Globally, in 1998, there were more girls of secondary school age out of school than boys, and today the gap becomes larger. ✓

B) The number of girls out of school worldwide dropped by about 79 million between 1998 and 2018, with the number at the primary level falling by over half.

C) Regionally, fewer girls are out of school today in East Asia and the Pacific, and in South Asia, while the reverse is true in Sub-Saharan Africa.

D) The number of out-of-school children at the primary level has dropped substantially over the past two decades in the three select regions.

原始的选项顺序

A) The number of girls out of school worldwide dropped by about 79 million between 1998 and 2018, with the number at the primary level falling by over half.

B) Regionally, fewer girls are out of school today in East Asia and the Pacific, and in South Asia, while the reverse is true in Sub-Saharan Africa.

C) The number of out-of-school children at the primary level has dropped substantially over the past two decades in the three select regions.

D) Globally, in 1998, there were more girls of secondary school age out of school than boys, and today the gap becomes larger. ✓

Directions : In Part II, you will read short texts on different subjects. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions based on logical inference and reasoning. (Time allowed: 55 minutes)

Question 11 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Look at the picture and answer the question according to the picture.



11. Which of the following logical fallacies does the picture illustrate?

考试时的选项顺序

A) **Equivocation**: It is a fallacy by which a specific word or phrase in an argument is used with more than one meaning.

B) **Hasty Generalization**: It is a general statement made out of a rush to have a conclusion, leading the arguer to commit some sort of illicit assumption, stereotyping, unwarranted conclusion, overstatement, or exaggeration. ✓

C) **Appeal to ignorance**: It is a logical fallacy in which someone typically argues that a certain conclusion is true because there is no evidence against it.

D) **Non Sequitur**: It is a fallacy wherein someone asserts a conclusion that does not follow from the propositions.

原始的选项顺序

A) **Hasty Generalization**: It is a general statement made out of a rush to have a conclusion, leading the arguer to commit some sort of illicit assumption, stereotyping, unwarranted conclusion, overstatement, or exaggeration. ✓

B) **Appeal to ignorance**: It is a logical fallacy in which someone typically argues that a certain conclusion is true because there is no evidence against it.

C) **Equivocation**: It is a fallacy by which a specific word or phrase in an argument is used with more than one meaning.

D) **Non Sequitur**: It is a fallacy wherein someone asserts a conclusion that does not follow from the propositions.

Question 12 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following argument and answer the question according to the argument.

Your brain is made of molecules, and molecules are not conscious, so your brain must not be the source of consciousness.

12. Which of the following most closely parallels the reasoning used in the above argument?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Leather jackets and baggy pants are the favorite attire of gangsters. So, if you wear them it will prove that you are a gangster.

B) No one in this family has ever been divorced; therefore, you need to work out your marital problems. We don't get divorced!

C) Because cars create less pollution than buses, cars must be less of a pollution problem than buses. ✓

D) If the animals are herbivore then they will eat plants. My dog eats grass. Therefore my dog is herbivore.

原始的选项顺序

A) If the animals are herbivore then they will eat plants. My dog eats grass. Therefore my dog is herbivore.

B) Because cars create less pollution than buses, cars must be less of a pollution problem than buses. ✓

C) No one in this family has ever been divorced; therefore, you need to work out your marital problems. We don't get divorced!

D) Leather jackets and baggy pants are the favorite attire of gangsters. So, if you wear them it will prove that you are a gangster.

Questions 13-14 Reasoning (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

13.

Cell phone usage has increased exponentially in the last 20 years. Researchers discovered that the incidences of brain cancer have also increased in that time. Therefore, cell phone usage must cause brain cancer.

13. Which of the following indicates the fallacy in the argument above?

考试时的选项顺序

A) It jumps to a conclusion based on inadequate studies on the subject.

B) It tries to strengthen the argument by referring to

authority.

C) It tries to convince readers by telling them someone else believes that.

D) It projects a causal relationship on consecutive but independent events. ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) It tries to strengthen the argument by referring to authority.

B) It jumps to a conclusion based on inadequate studies on the subject.

C) It tries to convince readers by telling them someone else believes that.

D) It projects a causal relationship on consecutive but independent events. ✓

14.

On average, generic drugs cost about 80% to 85% less than brand name drugs. That means if a brand name drug costs \$100, its generic equivalent may only cost \$15 to \$20. What are generic drugs? When the drug's 20-year patent term ends, the FDA (U.S. Food and Drug Administration) approves a generic drug. It is a copy of the brand in

the ways that matter—dosage, safety, strength, quality, purity, the way it works, and the way you take it. So, the current 20 years of protection for new drugs should be extended, considering its long discovery time and complicated clinical studies.

14. Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the argument?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Branded generics are showing growth in low- and middle-income countries, and this can complicate markets in terms of product and price differentiation.

B) From start to finish, the entire drug development process usually spans about 10 to 15 years. ✓

C) Branded generics, like generics, provide alternatives to branded drugs, and often release savings.

D) When a new use is discovered for a drug, it can earn an additional 3 years of protection under FDA rules.

原始的选项顺序

A) From start to finish, the entire drug development process usually spans about 10 to 15 years. ✓

B) Branded generics are showing growth in low- and middle-income countries, and this can complicate markets in terms of product and price differentiation.

C) When a new use is discovered for a drug, it can earn an additional 3 years of protection under FDA rules.

D) Branded generics, like generics, provide alternatives to branded drugs, and often release savings.

Questions 15-16 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

Everyone has had that coworker, the one who never asks for help even when fully out of their depth, unaware of their own incompetence. But what happens when your colleague isn't a human suffering from *Dunning-Kruger* but artificial intelligence (AI)?

That's a question Vishal Chatrath has had to consider as the CEO and co-founder of Prowler.io, an AI platform for generalised decision making for businesses that aims to augment human work with machine learning.

Prowler.io's customers include fund managers—the system decides what to buy and sell—as well as managing logistics and supporting education, with one client using the platform to develop an AI tutor. "The decision-making process can be quite similar [across different businesses], if abstracted at a low-enough level," he says. "In some cases, the decisions are fully automated; in some cases, there's a human in the loop."

Keeping a human as part of the process is partially because of a lack of trust in machine-based decision making, but it's also an admission by Chatrath that we remain in the early years of AI. Such systems aren't perfect, and likely

never will be, and one failing of AI is it doesn't inherently understand its own competency. If a human worker needs help, they can ask for it—but how do you build an understanding of personal limitations into code? Chatrath points to the two deadly 737 Max crashes. "In both crashes, the commonality was that the autopilot did not understand its own incompetence," Chatrath says.

Prowler.io built an awareness of incompetence into its system, teaching its AI to not only understand its limitations but to forecast when it's going to reach a situation where it has no experience or background. "Then it gently taps the human on the shoulder, so to speak, for the human to take control," he says. The system can learn from those interactions, and after enough training may eventually be able to stop asking for help.

15. According to the text, *Dunning-Kruger* in Paragraph 1 is described as a type of cognitive bias in which _____.

考试时的选项顺序

A) people tend to be too confident to collaborate with their colleagues

B) people blame others for their incompetence without noticing their own inability

C) people believe that they are smarter and more capable than they really are ✓

D) people focus on their ignorance too much and so fail to

seek valuable information

原始的选项顺序

A) people tend to be too confident to collaborate with their colleagues

B) people believe that they are smarter and more capable than they really are ✓

C) people blame others for their incompetence without noticing their own inability

D) people focus on their ignorance too much and so fail to seek valuable information

16. What is the unique feature of Prowler.io's decision-making system according to the text?

考试时的选项顺序

A) It makes decisions fully automatically without turning to a human for help.

B) It understands its own limitations and then solves problems on its own.

C) It knows when it is the time to stop and ask a human to take control. ✓

D) It helps people make fast, accurate and commercially

effective decisions.

原始的选项顺序

A) It knows when it is the time to stop and ask a human to take control. ✓

B) It understands its own limitations and then solves problems on its own.

C) It helps people make fast, accurate and commercially effective decisions.

D) It makes decisions fully automatically without turning to a human for help.

Questions 17-19 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.



There is an origin story about Yellowstone National Park that involves weary explorers sitting around a campfire, extolling the beauty of the land they've just seen and vowing to ensure it becomes a public park for all to enjoy. It's a vision of altruism and environmentalism that suits the founding of the world's first

national park—only it's not entirely true.

The members of the 1870 Washburn-Doane Expedition did likely gather for campfires as they explored the region's geysers and rivers and waterfalls, and they did likely discuss the best use of the land they were exploring. But, as with so much of American history, there were significant corporate interests at play. Yellowstone might never have become the public parkland it is today if not for the Northern Pacific Railroad Company.

Before the explorers set out on their expedition, Northern Pacific was strategizing to expand across the Montana Territory. An influx of tourism in the region would be a boon to business, so a railroad financier, Jay Cooke, began lobbying for an expedition. To drum up excitement back East, one member of the expedition, a politician named Nathaniel P. Langford, toured the country giving lectures about the beauty of Yellowstone. Meanwhile, Northern Pacific subsidized an artist to sketch images of the park for display in Washington, D.C.

In March of 1872, less than two years after the expedition, Congress enacted the Yellowstone Park Act, ensuring that the land would remain under the purview of the Department of the Interior rather than being divvied up among private individuals—an arrangement that would attract visitors to the area, which would be sure to benefit big business like the railroad company.

More than 70 years into the park's existence, The LIFE Picture Collection dispatched Alfred Eisenstaedt to photograph its geographic features, during a

summer that was shaping up to be Yellowstone's biggest yet for tourism. In that record year, 1946, the park had more than 800,000 visitors. In 2018, it had 4.1 million visitors. Though the idea might seem incongruous, all of the many millions of people who over the decades have encountered Yellowstone's bison and watched Old Faithful blow have corporate interests to thank for one of America's greatest natural wonders.

17. What is the most likely reason for the founding of Yellowstone National Park?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Environmental protection.
- B) The development of tourism.
- C) Social and economic interests. ✓
- D) Geographical exploration.

原始的选项顺序

- A) Environmental protection.
 - B) Geographical exploration.
 - C) The development of tourism.
 - D) Social and economic interests. ✓
-

18. What can be inferred about the Northern Pacific Railroad Company from the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) It shaped the landscape of Yellowstone.
- B) It financed the 1870 Washburn-Doane Expedition.
- C) It helped explorers discover Yellowstone National Park.
- D) It helped make Yellowstone known to the general public.

✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) It helped make Yellowstone known to the general public.

✓

- B) It helped explorers discover Yellowstone National Park.
- C) It financed the 1870 Washburn-Doane Expedition.
- D) It shaped the landscape of Yellowstone.

19. Which of the following is true according to the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) The LIFE Picture Collection was working for the profits of Yellowstone National Park.
- B) Yellowstone Park Act was enacted for the sake of big business in that area.
- C) Yellowstone National Park is well-known for its natural resources and geographic features. ✓

D) Yellowstone National Park broke the record of visitors in 1946 and 2018.

原始的选项顺序

A) Yellowstone National Park broke the record of visitors in 1946 and 2018.

B) Yellowstone Park Act was enacted for the sake of big business in that area.

C) The LIFE Picture Collection was working for the profits of Yellowstone National Park.

D) Yellowstone National Park is well-known for its natural resources and geographic features. ✓

Questions 20-21 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

Switching to renewable energy sources is key for lessening our dependence on fossil fuels and protecting the environment, but there's a *catch* with deploying greener solutions at scale. When the wind drops or the sun sets for the night, we need a way to store energy as part of the electrical grid so it's available for use.

Most renewable energy researchers are focusing on a type of battery called a flow battery for storing energy, in which electricity is stored in a tank of liquid electrolyte. However, making this technology cost-effective on the scale

required for the power grid has proven challenging.

Researchers at Berkeley are helping with this problem through the development of an affordable battery membrane, which is the part of the battery that separates the cathode and the anode. Traditional fuel cells use a fluorinated membrane, but these membranes are expensive and aren't designed for a flow battery. The researchers have created a new type of membrane specifically for flow batteries made from polymers called AquaPIMs, or aqueous-compatible polymers of intrinsic microporosity.

AquaPIM membranes work with different battery chemistries, from metals and inorganics to organics and polymers, and they help create stable cells which last for longer without degrading. They are also considerably cheaper than the fluorinated polymer membranes which can make up to 15 to 20 percent of the cost of a battery.

The new membranes pave the way for cheaper and more reliable flow batteries for the electric grid, which could eventually power homes across the country with renewable energy from wind and solar.

20. What does the word *catch* in the first paragraph probably mean?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Enormous advantage. B) Imminent jeopardy.
C) Hidden difficulty. ✓ D) Rare opportunity.

原始的选项顺序

- A) Rare opportunity.
 - B) Enormous advantage.
 - C) Hidden difficulty. ✓
 - D) Imminent jeopardy.
-

21. What can we learn about the battery membrane developed by researchers at Berkeley?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) It incorporates the strong elements of the fluorinated membrane.
- B) It will save one fifth of the cost of a battery.
- C) It can help promote the lifetime and cost-effectiveness of a battery. ✓
- D) It is only compatible with a flow battery.

原始的选项顺序

- A) It is only compatible with a flow battery.
- B) It will save one fifth of the cost of a battery.
- C) It incorporates the strong elements of the fluorinated membrane.
- D) It can help promote the lifetime and cost-effectiveness of a battery. ✓

Questions 22-24 (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

Baked Alaska. London broil. Singapore noodles. When a food is named after a city or country, you'd think this would indicate that the dish was either connected to or concocted in that place.

But the reality is often lost in translation somewhere between an actual origin story (Nashville hot chicken, a spicy fried bird with roots in Tennessee's African-American community) and a marketing campaign (Baked Alaska, an ice-cream cake a New York City chef whipped up in 1867 to salute the U.S. purchasing the territory from Russia).

For the most part, _____. "You want something that resonates with your consumers' values, and you want to stand out from your competitors," says food historian Ken Albala of the University of the Pacific. "Association with place is a strong marker of identity—even if you make it up." Albala, author of culinary history books such as *Eating Right in the Renaissance* and *Nuts: A Global History*, also thinks some food names come from sheer ignorance. "For example, people initially thought turkey came from Turkey," he says.

One perfect example is chicken Kiev. The basic recipe: a breaded, deep-fried chicken cutlet stuffed with seasoned butter. It's pretty decadent and can be dangerous—watch for splattering hot butter when you slice into it. But, it's not

from Ukraine.

Bonnie Morales, chef and co-owner of Portland, Oregon Russian restaurant Kachka, first tasted the dish when her parents served her a TV dinner version in the 1990s. They'd never heard of it in their native Belarus. "People don't make chicken Kiev at home," says Morales.

Years later, chicken Kiev became a strong seller on the Kachka menu. "We were worried people wouldn't be down with Russian cuisine, so we *honed in on* dishes average American diners wouldn't be freaked out by," she says. "After all, it's just fried chicken with butter at the center. Who doesn't like that?"

Though it didn't start in Ukraine, chicken Kiev seems to have first appeared on Russian menus in the late 19th century, possibly dreamed up by the French chefs czarist aristocrats loved to employ. It was probably initially made with ground meat—most often pork, but sometimes veal or chicken—and panfried, resulting in what looked like an oval, breaded hamburger.

The chicken recipe gained popularity in early 20th-century Russia. And by the 1960s, with a westernized name (chicken Kiev), the dish usually used flattened, rolled-up chicken breasts. And it turned into a fancy British and American dinner-party headliner.

Back in Kyiv*, the recipe wasn't on chefs' radars until the 1970s, when tourists began requesting it at restaurants. To meet the demand, Kyiv embraced Kiev cutlets.

* Note: **Kyiv**, Ukrainian name for **Kiev**

22. Which of the statements below best fits in the blank?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) explanations are needed for food names of various kinds
- B) food names usually remind diners of their origins
- C) foods have interesting stories behind their fancy names
- D) food names are meant to win diners and influence eaters

✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) food names usually remind diners of their origins
- B) foods have interesting stories behind their fancy names
- C) explanations are needed for food names of various kinds
- D) food names are meant to win diners and influence eaters

✓

23. What does the expression *honed in on* in Paragraph 6 probably mean?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Invented or produced.
- B) Beat the drum for.
- C) Introduced or brought in.
- D) Gave all attention to. ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) Beat the drum for.
- B) Gave all attention to. ✓
- C) Invented or produced.
- D) Introduced or brought in.

24. What can we learn about chicken Kiev?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) It was first made by Bonnie Morales in America.
- B) It is the most popular food in Britain and America.
- C) It seems unhealthy but enjoys great popularity. ✓
- D) It originated in Ukraine in the late 19th century.

原始的选项顺序

- A) It seems unhealthy but enjoys great popularity. ✓
- B) It originated in Ukraine in the late 19th century.
- C) It was first made by Bonnie Morales in America.
- D) It is the most popular food in Britain and America.

Questions 25-26 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.



Everyone knows that inventions can revolutionize and improve our lives in immeasurable ways. Trains, cars, and airplanes have transformed the way we travel, while the printing press, telephones, and computers have expanded the ways we communicate.

On the other end of the spectrum are wildly successful ideas that don't do much of anything except make us wonder, "Heck, why didn't I think of that?" So while it's often said that necessity is the mother of invention, these exceptions have demonstrated that with some clever marketing and a little bit of luck, "necessity" is far from necessary for an idea to be successful.

In a way, fidget spinners are emblematic of a generation searching relentlessly for a good distraction. Though there are a plethora of high-tech gadgets that can easily feed this need for constant stimulation, these simple plastic toys have become surprisingly widespread.

The design consists of a ball bearing center with flat, spindly lobes attached. With a simple flick, it can be spun around the axis, providing instant stress relief. Some sellers are even marketing them as a way to ease anxiety and help calm those experiencing neurological disorders like ADHD (Attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder) and autism.

Fidget spinners experienced their first wave of popularity in April of 2017 and have since become ubiquitous among school children. Several schools have moved to ban the toys, citing them as overly-distracting to students. According to a survey of the 200 largest American high schools, nearly a third have

banned fidget spinners.

Who invented this seemingly innocuous yet controversial toy? The answer isn't quite clear. Credible news reports have credited a chemical engineer named Catherine Hettinger. Records show that Hettinger filed for and received a patent application for a "spinning toy" in 1993. However, Hettinger wasn't able to find a manufacturer and the patent lapsed in 2005. Hettinger has claimed credit for the invention, telling CNN that she thought of the idea after watching children throw rocks at police officers during a trip to the Middle East.

NPR (National Public Radio) reported that an IT worker named Scott McCoskery, who fashioned and sold an early version online called the Torqbar in 2014, may have inspired a barrage of copy cats found on the market today. Another popular "fidget" toy on the market is the Fidget Cube, which features a different form of sensory distraction on each of its six sides.

It's not hard to find people who believe they have a big idea or two that can make them millionaires. But the reality is that it's hard to know what would really catch on. Sometimes even the best and most well-intentioned ideas fail, while the most unlikely and silliest ones turn out to be huge winners. So the takeaway here is you will never know until you try.

25. What is the probable purpose of inventing fidget spinners?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) To help treat patients with ADHD and autism.
- B) To provide a certain amount of distraction. ✓
- C) To apply for a patent and make profits.
- D) To revolutionize the ways we entertain ourselves.

原始的选项顺序

- A) To revolutionize the ways we entertain ourselves.
 - B) To help treat patients with ADHD and autism.
 - C) To provide a certain amount of distraction. ✓
 - D) To apply for a patent and make profits.
-

26. Which of the following can be inferred from the last paragraph?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Try your ideas as much as possible until they become successful.
- B) It's easy to find that big ideas usually make people millionaires.
- C) Brilliant ideas may not be converted into great inventions. ✓
- D) It is hard to come up with forethoughtful and successful ideas.

原始的选项顺序

A) Brilliant ideas may not be converted into great inventions.

✓

B) It is hard to come up with forethoughtful and successful ideas.

C) It's easy to find that big ideas usually make people millionaires.

D) Try your ideas as much as possible until they become successful.

Questions 27-30 (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

Ancient Egyptian art is filled with images of reverent revelers with pointy cones on their heads. Men and women are shown with head cones in artistic depictions on everything from papyrus scrolls to coffins, donning the pointed objects as they take part in royal feasts and divine rituals. Women who wear the cones are sometimes also portrayed in childbirth, an activity associated with certain gods.

But while the head cones were relatively common in Egyptian art for more than a thousand years, their purpose and existence have remained a mystery. No archaeologist had ever excavated one of the enigmatic objects, leading some scholars to think of Egyptian head cones as merely symbolic representations—the equivalent of the halos that appear on saints and angels in Christian iconography.

Now it appears that an international team of archaeologists have indeed found the first physical evidence for the elusive head accessories, according to a new paper published in the journal *Antiquity*.

The discovery comes from the cemeteries of Amarna, an ancient Egyptian city whose temples were erected by Akhenaten, a pharaoh thought to be King Tutankhamun's father. Hastily built in the 14th century B.C. and significant for just about 15 years, the city was home to roughly 30,000 people. Only about ten percent were wealthy elite who were buried in opulent tombs; the rest were ordinary folks who were interred in modest burials. It was in these burials, which generally don't contain much of value, where members of the Amarna Project, a University of Cambridge-led project with funding from the National Geographic Society and other institutions, initially found the remains of head cones back in 2009.

While it's been a decade since the excavations, Anna Stevens, an archaeologist at Monash University who is assistant director of the Amarna Project and co-director of ongoing research at the city's non-elite cemeteries, remembers the day the first cone was found. "I think I've got one of those head cones!" a coworker, Mary Shepperson, called out. When Stevens went to investigate, she saw a telltale point above the skull of a female skeleton.

"It was obviously very, very different, not something we'd seen in any burials before," Stevens says. But the pointy object was very similar to the odd head decoration in Egyptian art that some scholars had dismissed as a piece of

artistic folly. Another adult burial, which couldn't be identified as male or female, turned up an additional head cone.

It took scholars nearly a decade to secure funding and complete a substantial examination of the head cones, giving them a chance to test another popular theory about the unusual objects: The head cones were actually solid lumps of perfumed fat that melted over the heads of their wearers and acted as a sort of ancient, fragranced hair gel.

The findings from Amarna seem to negate the ancient styling product theory. The cones weren't solid—they were hollow shells folded around brown-black organic matter the team thinks may be fabric. Both head cones had chemical signatures of decayed wax; the team concluded they were made of beeswax, the only biological wax known to be used by ancient Egyptians. Furthermore, no traces of wax were found in the hair of the most well-preserved skeleton.

27. What can be learned about the head cones from the first two paragraphs?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Ancient Egyptians wore head cones in a symbolic sense.
- B) The head cones are associated with something religious.
- C) This kind of art reached its peak more than 1,000 years ago.

D) Why ancient Egyptians wore head cones is still unclear. ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) Why ancient Egyptians wore head cones is still unclear. ✓
- B) Ancient Egyptians wore head cones in a symbolic sense.
- C) The head cones are associated with something religious.
- D) This kind of art reached its peak more than 1,000 years ago.
-

28. What can be learned from the fourth paragraph?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) The head cones discovered were made in the 14th century B.C.
- B) Akhenaten succeeded to the throne after King Tutankhamun.
- C) Akhenaten was on the throne for just about 15 years.
- D) The physical head cones were found in the modest burials. ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) Akhenaten was on the throne for just about 15 years.
- B) The physical head cones were found in the modest burials. ✓
- C) Akhenaten succeeded to the throne after King Tutankhamun.

D) The head cones discovered were made in the 14th century B.C.

29. Which of the following is one reason that made researchers of the Amarna Project take nearly ten years to study the head cones?

考试时的选项顺序

A) There were few historical documents on the head cones.

B) They waited for a chance to test a popular theory about the head cones.

C) They had to raise enough money to continue the study. ✓

D) There were no well-established theories to account for their study.

原始的选项顺序

A) They had to raise enough money to continue the study. ✓

B) There were few historical documents on the head cones.

C) There were no well-established theories to account for their study.

D) They waited for a chance to test a popular theory about the head cones.

30. What do we learn about the ancient styling product theory?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) The head cones were made of perfumed fat. ✓
- B) The head cones were of no value to preserve hair health.
- C) The head cones were made with the help of beeswax.
- D) The head cones were actually hollow fabric.

原始的选项顺序

- A) The head cones were actually hollow fabric.
- B) The head cones were made of perfumed fat. ✓
- C) The head cones were made with the help of beeswax.
- D) The head cones were of no value to preserve hair health.

Directions : In Part III, you will read passages on the same subject. You will be required to identify the writer's position and evaluate the effectiveness of the writer's arguments. (Time allowed: 35 minutes)

Questions 31-40 (Suggested completion time: 35 minutes)

Directions: Read three passages about screen time. Answer the questions according to the passages.

Passage A

There has never been more anxiety about the effects of our love of screens—which now bombard us with social media updates, news (real and fake), advertising and blue-spectrum light that could disrupt our sleep.

Concerns are growing about impacts on mental and physical health, education, relationships, even on politics and democracy. Just last year, the World Health Organization issued new guidelines about limiting children's screen time; the US Congress investigated the influence of social media on political bias and voting; and California introduced a law (Assembly Bill 272) that allows schools to restrict pupils' use of smartphones.

All the concerns expressed and actions taken, including by scientists, legislators, medical and public-health professionals and advocacy groups, are based on the assumption that digital media—in particular, social media—31. Yet so far, it has been a challenge for researchers to demonstrate empirically what seems obvious experientially. Conversely, it has also been hard for them to demonstrate that such concerns are misplaced.

A major limitation of the thousands of studies, carried out over the past decade or so, of the effects of digital media is that they do not analyse the types of data that could reveal exactly what people are seeing and doing on their screens—especially in relation to the problems that doctors, legislators and parents worry most about. Most use self-reports of “screen time”. These are people's own estimates of the time they spend engaging with screens or with platforms that are categorized as “smartphone”, “television”, “social media”, “political news” or “entertainment media”. Yet today's media experiences defy such simplistic characterization: the range of content has

become too broad, patterns of consumption too fragmented, too idiosyncratic, experiences too interactive and devices too mobile.

Policies and advice must be informed by accurate assessments of media use. These should involve moment-by-moment capture of what people are doing and when, and machine analysis of the content on their screens and the order in which it appears.

Technology now allows researchers to record digital life in exquisite detail. And thanks to shifting norms around data sharing, and the accumulation of experience and tools in fields such as genomics, it is becoming easier to collect data while meeting expectations and legal requirements around data security and personal privacy.

Passage B

For many years the American Academy of Pediatrics (AAP) recommended zero screens at all for kids under the age of two. That included everything from iPads to Skype sessions with Grandma. People felt that was a little unreasonable considering the prevalence of screens. Parents felt the pressure, from other parents and the well-meaning peanut gallery, to raise screen-free toddlers. It caused heated debate on both sides, with heaps of guilt laid down by everyone.

Finally, in 2016 the AAP changed the rule and approved some digital media for toddlers 18 months and older. Video chats no longer counted as negative screen time for babies and toddlers under 18 months.

Similarly, parents are frequently told that screen time can cause ADHD (Attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder). Dr. Melmed suggests instead that children who have ADHD are more likely uniquely positioned to be “vulnerable and more susceptible to excessive and problematic screen time use.” Melmed says, “Children with ADHD can overfocus on highly stimulating tasks, making disengagement and transitioning to a more mundane task much more difficult.” This difficulty with transitions can result in the tantrums and meltdowns that are frequently, if errantly, associated with behavior issues caused by digital media, but which are actually a hallmark of ADHD.

It turns out, like almost everything, it’s the quality that’s important. Hours of *Peppa Pig* or toy videos on YouTube are to development as what fast food meals are to health: suboptimal. It’s important that parents are active participants in their young children’s media consumption and choose quality programs and games for their kids. But tired, frazzled, overwrought parents can rest assured that 15 to 20 minutes of *Octonauts* or even *Mickey Mouse Clubhouse* is not going to ruin your child’s brain.

Modern parents have enough to worry about without adding guilt over reasonable screen time. Using common sense and making quality choices are the most important factors. Any parent who’s actively concerned with the effect

of screen time on their kid's development isn't the kind of parent that's going to let their 2-year-old veg out for hours or their teen drift into loneliness and depression at the hands of a smartphone and social media accounts. An engaged parent is the first step in moderating tech overuse.

So, stop worrying so much about screen time, folks, and use that extra time to pack lunches, find missing shoes, answer ten thousand questions, and clean the pee off the floor around the toilet.

Passage C

Despite common warnings that screen time and social media are bad for children, the effects are likely to be nuanced, according to a new report from the Child Mind Institute.

The report, which is a deep dive into the effects of social media and gaming on child mental health, is intended to take a topic popular in the media and important to parents and “provide the best *distillation*” on up-to-date science, David Anderson, PhD, a reviewer of the report, told *Medscape Medical News*.

Written for a general audience, it's an easily digestible resource that clinicians can use and pass on to parents.

Potential parent concerns, such as screen addictiveness, sleep deprivation, exacerbation of eating disorders, and harm to mental health, are addressed in the report. An accompanying handout summarizes the major findings and

parent tips. “Have those at the ready,” recommends Anderson, senior director of national programs and outreach at the Child Mind Institute. “If at the end of a visit when you only have 15 minutes, the high-level summaries could work as talking points and to give as handouts.”

Although research for the report shows clear links between technology use and exacerbation of mental health problems, it also shows that screen time has benefits. Some online time improves the child’s or teen’s connectedness and confidence. The data show sort of “a *Goldilocks effect*,” Anderson said. “There’s a ‘just right’ dose.” An hour a day can be beneficial, but several hours a day can become problematic, exacerbating sleep and mental health problems.

The report is also useful in aiding healthcare providers to help parents reframe how they think about their child’s screen time and technology, says Bradley Grant, a child and adolescent psychiatrist at the Kennedy Krieger Institute.

“There’s a misconception that parents are gatekeepers of technology,” he told Medscape Medical News. But “navigating online is an essential skill for teens to go out into the world today.” The goal is to work with children and teens so that they develop the skills to use social media and technology in a safe way that enriches their lives, he said.

The report provides guidance on engaging kids regarding their technology and screen time, rather than just limiting their access.

Some children, though, may have a lower threshold for problematic gaming and social media use, according to the report. For instance, children with ADHD (Attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder) and learning disorders are twice as likely to experience cyberbullying. And patients with anxiety, spectrum disorder, or ADHD are more likely to overuse social media and experience mood variation.

The report may serve as a valuable resource for physicians to identify and address more vulnerable patients who may need more parent involvement.

“Children and teen communication strategies are changing,” Anderson said. “Screens are here to stay.” Hopefully, the report equips clinicians to counsel parents on the risks and the benefits of the technology so integral to their children’s lives.

31. Which of the following best fits in the blank in Passage A?

考试时的选项顺序

A) should be given special attention due to the anxiety it brings about

B) causes both mental and physical damages to human beings

C) has powerful and invariably negative effects on human behavior ✓

D) might be the fundamental cause of people’s love of

screens

原始的选项顺序

- A) causes both mental and physical damages to human beings
 - B) might be the fundamental cause of people's love of screens
 - C) has powerful and invariably negative effects on human behavior ✓
 - D) should be given special attention due to the anxiety it brings about
-

32. Why are the concerns misplaced according to the researchers mentioned in Passage A?

- A) Because the most concerned problems haven't been solved.
- B) Because quite a lot of former studies are not accurate enough. ✓
- C) Because there are many different definitions about screen time.
- D) Because the concerns are just based on people's life experiences.

答案：B

33. What is the main purpose of Passage A?

考试时的选项顺序

A) To stress the importance and necessity of limiting people's screen time.

B) To call for more detailed studies about the usage of digital media. ✓

C) To clear up people's misunderstandings of the impact of digital media.

D) To point out current problems in studying and assessing media use.

原始的选项顺序

A) To call for more detailed studies about the usage of digital media. ✓

B) To point out current problems in studying and assessing media use.

C) To clear up people's misunderstandings of the impact of digital media.

D) To stress the importance and necessity of limiting people's screen time.

34. What can be learned from Dr. Melmed's words in Passage B?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) It is difficult for children with ADHD to focus on complicated tasks.
- B) Children with ADHD are more easily affected by immoderate screen time. ✓
- C) Wrong use of screen time brings about children's behavior issues.
- D) It is actually common for children with ADHD to lose their patience.

原始的选项顺序

- A) Wrong use of screen time brings about children's behavior issues.
 - B) It is difficult for children with ADHD to focus on complicated tasks.
 - C) It is actually common for children with ADHD to lose their patience.
 - D) Children with ADHD are more easily affected by immoderate screen time. ✓
-

35. It can be inferred from Passage B that_____.

考试时的选项顺序

A) long screen time may lead to young children's anxiety and

depression

B) doing housework helps relieve parents' worries about

children's tech overuse

C) it's better to pay attention to effective companionship

instead of screen time

D) parents' guidance is essential for children to use digital

media ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) parents' guidance is essential for children to use digital

media ✓

B) long screen time may lead to young children's anxiety and

depression

C) it's better to pay attention to effective companionship

instead of screen time

D) doing housework helps relieve parents' worries about

children's tech overuse

36. The word *distillation* in Paragraph 2 of Passage C is closest in meaning to_____.

考试时的选项顺序

A) excerpt B) abstract ✓ C) analysis D) evidence

原始的选项顺序

A) analysis B) abstract ✓ C) evidence D) excerpt

37. Which of the following might best explain the *Goldilocks effect* in

Paragraph 5 of Passage C?

考试时的选项顺序

A) It states that one should always make good preparations

and hope for the best.

B) It is a state of mind that is easily swayed by consideration

of gain and loss.

C) It means things must fall within certain margins rather

than reaching extremes. ✓

D) It refers to the behaviors of people who think they always

make right decisions.

原始的选项顺序

A) It refers to the behaviors of people who think they always

make right decisions.

B) It is a state of mind that is easily swayed by consideration

of gain and loss.

C) It states that one should always make good preparations

and hope for the best.

D) It means things must fall within certain margins rather than reaching extremes. ✓

38. What is the main purpose of the report mentioned in Passage C?

考试时的选项顺序

A) To persuade parents not to limit their children's screen time.

B) To give out reasonable guidance to doctors and parents.

✓

C) To help parents deal with their worries about media use.

D) To provide physicians with practical resources to help the patients.

原始的选项顺序

A) To give out reasonable guidance to doctors and parents.

✓

B) To help parents deal with their worries about media use.

C) To persuade parents not to limit their children's screen time.

D) To provide physicians with practical resources to help the patients.

39. Concerning ADHD, Passage B and Passage C share the similar view that_____.

考试时的选项顺序

- A) children with ADHD are more prone to mood swings ✓
- B) the overuse of digital media may cause ADHD
- C) parents' involvement is crucial for the treatment of ADHD
- D) too much screen time may trigger behavior issues

原始的选项顺序

- A) the overuse of digital media may cause ADHD
 - B) too much screen time may trigger behavior issues
 - C) children with ADHD are more prone to mood swings ✓
 - D) parents' involvement is crucial for the treatment of ADHD
-

40. Which of the following is NOT true concerning the three passages?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) None of the three passages suggest the prohibition of children's access to digital media.
- B) The author of Passage B is open-minded about children's screen time.
- C) The author of Passage A is skeptical of the guidelines mentioned in Paragraph 1.

D) All three passages agree that digital media is inevitable in children's development. ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) The author of Passage B is open-minded about children's screen time.

B) The author of Passage A is skeptical of the guidelines mentioned in Paragraph 1.

C) All three passages agree that digital media is inevitable in children's development. ✓

D) None of the three passages suggest the prohibition of children's access to digital media.

Directions : In Part IV, you will read a passage and then write a short essay according to it. You should write with clarity and logic. (Time allowed: 40 minutes)

41. Question 41 (Suggested completion time: 40 minutes)

Directions: Read an excerpt taken from *Education for Life*, a collection of Tao Xingzhi's writings. Write a short essay according to the excerpt.

China has been in the process of modernizing her education during the last two decades, but no greater progress has ever been made in any time of the period than in the last five or six years. Prior to 1919, roughly speaking, education in China was on a crossroads of foreign examples. At one time, she

had to model after the Japanese system; at another, the German system; and at still another, the American system. The imported systems of education from foreign countries, however fruitful they might be on their own soils, could not blossom well when thus transplanted. It was not until very recently that an awakened realization began to set in in the minds of educators and people in general that they must thoroughly study and examine their own needs and problems before they can adequately work out a system of education which will be truly Chinese and of real service to China. But in order to understand fully the effects of this realization and of its subsequent deliberations and solutions as set down in the following pages, it will be well here to indicate the forces that have brought about this great change.

Perhaps the most profound influence is undoubtedly the so-called Chinese Renaissance. The Renaissance began in 1917 as a "Literary Evolution" when Dr. Hu Suh and his followers declared that the old classical language had outlived its usefulness and that Pai-hua, or the spoken language, should be its legitimate heir. The "Literary Revolution" met with astonishing success. In spite of strong opposition on the part of the conservative scholars, the younger generation received it with overwhelming enthusiasm. This rediscovery of a living language for the Chinese has enabled China to produce new literature fitted for the new age, has revolutionized elementary school reading materials as well as methods of teaching them, and has made it possible for the mass education movement to go on with its program of eliminating illiteracy

in the country.

But the influence of the Renaissance is more than this. It is a movement through which all the traditional values, including the educational, are judged from a new standpoint and with a new standard. Tradition is often thrown overboard, authority is cast aside, and old beliefs are being undermined. In the words of Dr. Hu, this "systematization of the national heritage is a revival or rebirth of that spirit of criticism and research which animated the works of the Han Hsueh scholars (汉学家) of the last three centuries." As has been said before, China in the former years followed her neighbors rather blindly. At first, she sacrificed everything old for the new. But now and only gradually, she has begun to realize that the old is not necessarily bad and the new is not necessarily good. Her reaction to new theories and practices is no longer imitative adoption, but question, examination, experimentation, and selection. This undoubtedly is a wholesome attitude, and the logical outcome of this attitude in the field of education is the creation of a new system which is best fitted for the need of New China by assimilating what is best in the old as well as in the new, in itself and from outside.

41. Write a short essay of about 300 words based on your understanding of the excerpt. Remember to write in your OWN words. Your essay should respond to the following questions:

(1) What is the main topic of this excerpt?

(2) How does the author elaborate this topic from the perspective of Chinese Renaissance and its impact?

(3) How do you understand the author's opinion about how to deal with old Chinese traditions and foreign systems of education? Do you agree with it? Please explain.

2020 阅读大赛初赛 (2020 年 10 月 17 日)

Directions : In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Questions 1-3 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following quotes. Match the quotes with the people.

Please note there are two extra options you do not need.

- A. Isaac Newton
- B. Napoleon Bonaparte
- C. Johann Wolfgang von Goethe
- D. Alexander the Great
- E. Abraham Lincoln

1. Knowing is not enough; we must apply. Willing is not enough; we must do. C

答案 : C

2. Plato is my friend; Aristotle is my friend, but my greatest friend is truth. A

答案 : A

3. I am not afraid of an army of lions led by a sheep; I am afraid of an army of sheep led by a lion. D

答案 : D

Question 4 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Centipedes do not generally get on well together. ①This, though, is the conclusion of research published in *Biotropica* by Farnon Ellwood and Josie Phillips of the University of the West of England, in Bristol. ②So it is a surprise to find mother centipedes sharing nests and a double surprise to find that those co-residents are sometimes not even conspecifics. ③Even members of the same species may attack one another when they meet.

4. What is the right order of the numbered sentences?

考试时的选项顺序

A) ② ① ③ B) ② ③ ① C) ③ ① ② D) ③ ② ① ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) ② ① ③ B) ③ ① ② C) ② ③ ① D) ③ ② ① ✓

Question 5 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

When an infectious disease starts to spread, experts can use several terms to describe this. An *outbreak* is an unexpected number of cases. It can be limited to a single community. It might even be just one case. Or it can spread across countries. It can last just a few days or persist for years.

In March 2014, the World Health Organization reported an outbreak of Ebola in West Africa. Then the disease spread to several countries. Now it was as an *epidemic*. Epidemic diseases spread rapidly and infect many people.

Some diseases spread to infect many people in countries over several continents. These are known as *pandemics*. Ebola never reached pandemic status because it was confined to one region of Africa. And pandemics of new diseases are rare. But those rare cases can be devastating since no one is immune to an illness that has never before infected people.

5. Which of the following statements is true according to this text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) There is no cut-and-dried classification system for outbreaks, epidemics and pandemics.
- B) A pandemic occurs over a wide geographic area and affects a large number of people. ✓
- C) An epidemic is an outbreak of disease, typically confined to a specific group of people.
- D) Outbreaks, epidemics and pandemics are three necessary stages of infectious diseases spread.

原始的选项顺序

- A) There is no cut-and-dried classification system for outbreaks, epidemics and pandemics.

B) Outbreaks, epidemics and pandemics are three necessary stages of infectious diseases spread.

C) An epidemic is an outbreak of disease, typically confined to a specific group of people.

D) A pandemic occurs over a wide geographic area and affects a large number of people. ✓

Question 6 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

_____. For example, the pesticide DDT protected people from malaria but caused neurological damage in people who were exposed to it. DDT is now illegal, but opinions are still divided on whether it did more harm than good. When a product carries both risks and benefits, a business owner may be tempted to believe the interpretation that will allow him to continue to make a profit from the product. To avoid the risk of making a bad decision with future consequences for the success of the business, business owners must seek objective and neutral scientific advice and then be rigorously honest in how they present the information.

6. Which of the following best fills in the blank?

考试时的选项顺序

A) It's hard to know the real function of a product unless considering all the possible aspects of it

B) How to better value a product is closely related to its particular historical background

C) Whether a product is harmful or beneficial can be a matter of interpretation in some cases ✓

D) It matters to weigh a product's pros and cons and choose the most rational explanation

原始的选项顺序

A) How to better value a product is closely related to its particular historical background

B) Whether a product is harmful or beneficial can be a matter of interpretation in some cases ✓

C) It's hard to know the real function of a product unless considering all the possible aspects of it

D) It matters to weigh a product's pros and cons and choose the most rational explanation

Question 7 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the lecture notice and answer the question.

Congress Hall, London

TBC

PLEASE NOTE: Due to government advice, we have decided to

postpone this event.

We are rescheduling this event to a later date and will publish the new date as soon as possible.

Humans may not be Earth's most intelligent beings for much longer: the world champions of chess, Go, and Jeopardy! are now all **AI**s. Given the rapid pace of progress in AI, many predict that it could advance to human-level intelligence within the next several decades. From there, it could quickly outpace human intelligence. What do these developments mean for the future?

Join leading **Artificial Intelligence** researchers **Susan Schneider**, and **Beth Singler**, for an evening exploring how AI will affect human intelligence and what we might learn from intelligent machines.

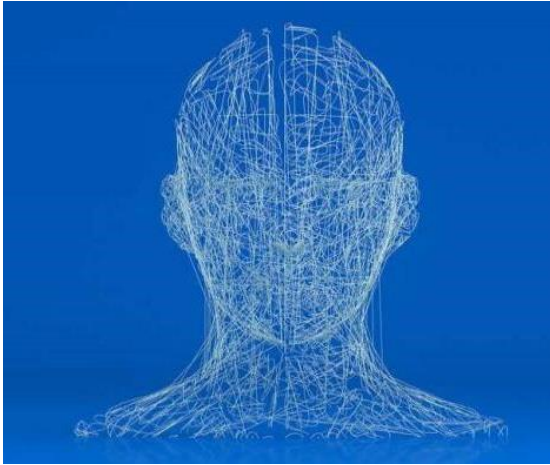
7. Which of the following pictures best matches the topic of the lecture?

考试时的选项顺序

A)



B)



C)



✓

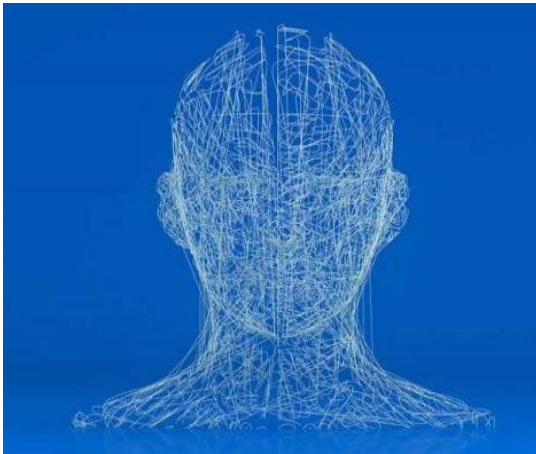
D)



原始的选项顺序



A)



B)



C)



D)



Question 8 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

My four-year-old daughter was doing impersonations of us all recently. Her impersonation of me—her mother, her only parent—was wildly blowing kisses and singing out, “Bye, darlings, bye! Bye! I’m late! Gotta go! Love you! BYEEEEEE!”

Did you hear my heart crack as I wrote that? She’ll reminisce about me when she’s grown and I’m gone; she’ll say to her partner or perhaps her own children, “Ah! I love watching people dashing out of doors in a fluster, dragging a suitcase while patting their pockets to check they’ve got their phone and muttering ‘I’m LATE!’ under their breath—it reminds me of my old mum.”

8. What is the writer’s purpose?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) To show her daughter’s consideration.
- B) To express her satisfaction with the current situation.
- C) To express that she is not happy to be a working single mum. ✓
- D) To imagine what she looks like in her daughter’s eyes.

原始的选项顺序

- A) To show her daughter’s consideration.
- B) To imagine what she looks like in her daughter’s eyes.

C) To express her satisfaction with the current situation.

D) To express that she is not happy to be a working single

mum. ✓

Question 9 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Gerwig skillfully navigates the line between respecting the story's old-fashioned bones while illuminating the modernity of its proto-feminist perspective, only occasionally leaning into speechy advocacy of a woman's right to self-actualization beyond marriage. Her cast may be slightly bound by their canonical character types.

9. Where is the text most probably taken from?

考试时的选项顺序

A) An author introduction. B) A preface of a book.

C) An excerpt from a novel. D) A film review. ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) A film review. ✓ B) A preface of a book.

C) An author introduction. D) An excerpt from a novel.

Question 10 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Study the following table and figure, and answer the question according to the information.

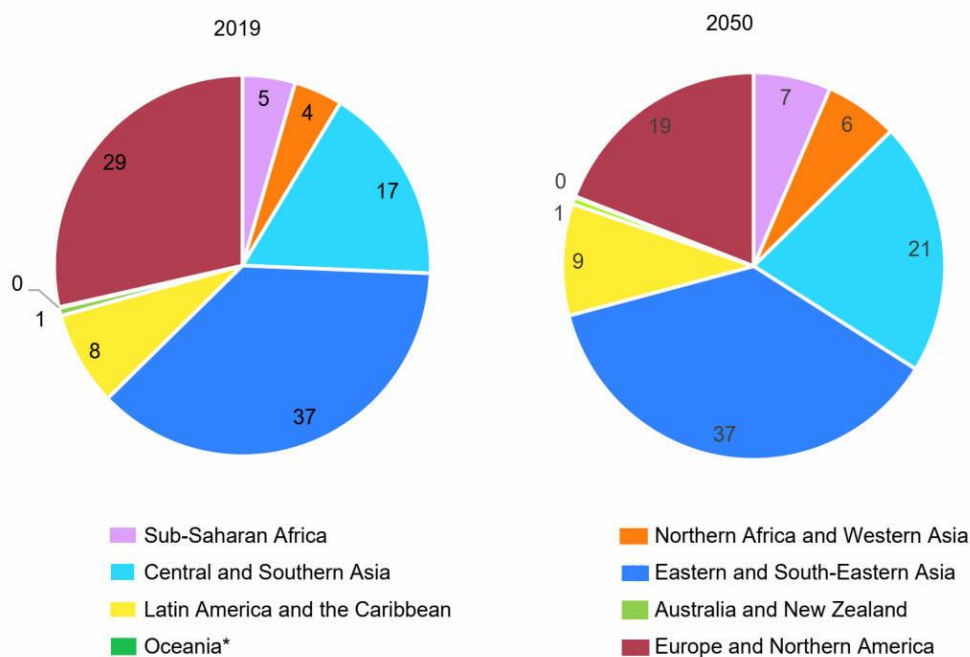
Table 1.
Number of persons aged 65 years or over by geographic region, 2019 and 2050

Region	Number of persons aged 65 or over in 2019 (millions)	Number of persons aged 65 or over in 2050 (millions)	Percentage change between 2019 and 2050
World	702.9	1548.9	120
Sub-Saharan Africa	31.9	101.4	218
Northern Africa and Western Asia	29.4	95.8	226
Central and Southern Asia	119.0	328.1	176
Eastern and South-Eastern Asia	260.6	572.5	120
Latin America and the Caribbean	56.4	144.6	156
Australia and New Zealand	4.8	8.8	84
Oceania, excluding Australia and New Zealand	0.5	1.5	190
Europe and Northern America	200.4	296.2	48

Source: United Nations, Department of Economic and Social Affairs, Population Division (2019). *World Population Prospects 2019*.

*Excluding Australia and New Zealand.

Figure 1.
Distribution of population aged 65 years or over by region, 2019 and 2050 (percentage)



Source: United Nations, Department of Economic and Social Affairs, Population Division (2019). *World Population Prospects 2019*.

*Excluding Australia and New Zealand.

10. Which of the following is INCORRECT according to the table and figure?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Central and Southern Asia hosted one-sixth of the global

population aged 65 and above in 2019, a figure that is

foreseen to increase to one fifth in 2050.

B) The 65-and-older population is expected to grow fastest in Northern Africa and Western Asia from 29.4 million in 2019 to nearly 96 million in 2050.

C) The second largest share of persons aged 65 and above lived in Europe and Northern America in 2019, which is expected to shrink by 19% in 2050. ✓

D) Over the next three decades, the global number of persons aged 65 and above is projected to more than double, reaching over 1.5 billion in 2050.

原始的选项顺序

A) Over the next three decades, the global number of persons aged 65 and above is projected to more than double, reaching over 1.5 billion in 2050.

B) The 65-and-older population is expected to grow fastest in Northern Africa and Western Asia from 29.4 million in 2019 to nearly 96 million in 2050.

C) Central and Southern Asia hosted one-sixth of the global population aged 65 and above in 2019, a figure that is foreseen to increase to one fifth in 2050.

D) The second largest share of persons aged 65 and above

lived in Europe and Northern America in 2019, which is
expected to shrink by 19% in 2050. ✓

Directions : In Part II, you will read short texts on different subjects. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 55 minutes)

Question 11 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following definition of a logical fallacy. Answer the question according to the definition.

Dicto Simpliciter

Dicto Simpliciter is a fallacy in which a general rule or observation is treated as universally true regardless of the circumstances or the individuals concerned.

11. Which of the following provides a typical example of *Dicto Simpliciter*?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Brad is a nobody, but since nobody is perfect, Brad must be perfect, too.

B) I think the employees favor my style of management. After all, in more than a decade managing this branch, I've never heard a single complaint.

C) "Women have rights," said the Bullfighters Association president. "But women shouldn't fight bulls because a bullfighter is and should be a man."

D) A large body of evidence shows exercise is beneficial to health. Therefore everyone should take exercise. ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) Brad is a nobody, but since nobody is perfect, Brad must be perfect, too.

B) "Women have rights," said the Bullfighters Association president. "But women shouldn't fight bulls because a bullfighter is and should be a man."

C) A large body of evidence shows exercise is beneficial to health. Therefore everyone should take exercise. ✓

D) I think the employees favor my style of management. After all, in more than a decade managing this branch, I've never heard a single complaint.

Question 12 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following example of a logical fallacy. Answer the question according to the example.



12. Which of the following makes the same logical fallacy as the given example?

考试时的选项顺序

A) “We should abolish the death penalty. Many respected people, such as actor Guy Handsome, have publicly stated their opposition to it.”

B) A watch is a complex and precise device that is designed by an intelligent watchmaker. Similarly, the universe is an extremely complex system, and thus must be the product of intelligent design. ✓

C) “I know the exam is graded based on performance, but you should give me an A. My cat has been sick, my car broke down, and I’ve had a cold, so it was really hard for me to study!”

D) “If I fail the English test, I won’t be able to graduate. If I don’t graduate, I probably won’t be able to get a good job, and I may very well end up doing temp work or flipping burgers for the next year.”

原始的选项顺序

A) A watch is a complex and precise device that is designed by an intelligent watchmaker. Similarly, the universe is an

extremely complex system, and thus must be the product of intelligent design. ✓

B) “We should abolish the death penalty. Many respected people, such as actor Guy Handsome, have publicly stated their opposition to it.”

C) “I know the exam is graded based on performance, but you should give me an A. My cat has been sick, my car broke down, and I’ve had a cold, so it was really hard for me to study!”

D) “If I fail the English test, I won’t be able to graduate. If I don’t graduate, I probably won’t be able to get a good job, and I may very well end up doing temp work or flipping burgers for the next year.”

Questions 13-14 Reasoning (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

13.

“I know that our TV advertisements are more effective than radio. The numbers show that we hit twice the audience with TV, and our focus groups remember the TV commercial 38 percent more than the radio slot.”

Which of the following does NOT present a major logical flaw in the above argument?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) It fails to mention whether the 38 percent increase in retention has translated into the rise in sales.
- B) It fails to mention what percentage of the radio versus the TV audiences actually bought the product.
- C) It fails to mention whether potential consumers found TV advertisements more effective and entertaining. ✓
- D) It fails to mention the cost of and the return from the investment on the TV versus radio commercials.

原始的选项顺序

- A) It fails to mention the cost of and the return from the investment on the TV versus radio commercials.
- B) It fails to mention whether the 38 percent increase in retention has translated into the rise in sales.
- C) It fails to mention what percentage of the radio versus the TV audiences actually bought the product.
- D) It fails to mention whether potential consumers found TV advertisements more effective and entertaining. ✓

14.

Biting one's fingernails makes a person nervous and edgy. I know a dozen people who bite their fingernails, and they're all high-strung. If you want to be a more relaxed person, stop biting your fingernails.

Which of the following indicates the logical flaw in the argument above?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) It reverses the cause-and-effect relationship. ✓
- B) It supports a conclusion it did not mean to support.
- C) It creates a general rule based on a single case.
- D) It draws an analogy between two unrelated conditions.

原始的选项顺序

- A) It reverses the cause-and-effect relationship. ✓
- B) It creates a general rule based on a single case.
- C) It draws an analogy between two unrelated conditions.
- D) It supports a conclusion it did not mean to support.

Questions 15-16 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

Lexically speaking, love is love. Except when it's not. In some languages, the word for love comes tinged with pity.

① By analyzing the meanings of words used to describe emotions in over 2,000 languages, researchers found some universal truths. But the

analysis, described in the Dec. 20 *Science*, also revealed cultural *quirks*. That includes “hanisi,” which, in the Rotuman language spoken just north of Fiji, refers to both love and pity.

② Figuring out how people label their emotions with words may give clues about how different cultures experience the world.

Along with colleagues, psychologists Joshua Conrad Jackson and Kristen Lindquist of the University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill studied emotion words from 2,474 languages spanning 20 major language families. The researchers looked for words that were used to describe similar concepts (“water” and “sea,” for instance, but not “water” and “sun”).

③ Generally, words used to communicate good and bad feelings were distinct from each other, and so were words for feelings that rev up the body. “People around the world may all feel bad when they lose a loved one, and people around the world may feel their heart begin to beat faster in the face of danger,” Jackson says.

④ But against this backdrop, researchers found differences. In some Indo-European languages, for instance, “anxiety” and “anger” overlap. But “anxiety” is more closely tied to “grief” and “regret” among Austroasiatic languages, the large language family of mainland Southeast Asia. “Surprise” goes with “fear” in some languages, but not in others, the researchers found. The results suggest that the meanings of words that describe emotions—and

perhaps even the underlying feelings—vary across cultures, no matter what a translation dictionary might say.

15. What does the word *quirks* in the second paragraph probably mean?

- A) Unusual things. ✓ B) Valuable old objects.
C) Serious disagreements. D) Expected behavior patterns

答案 : A

16. Where would the sentence “Among emotion words, an overall structure emerged.” best fit?

- A) ① B) ② C) ③ ✓ D) ④

答案 : C

Questions 17-19 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

Truthfulness is the first requirement for any socially responsible advertising.

_____17_____. Factual information can be presented in such a way as to deceive the viewer, while an image can be manipulated yet still create an accurate final impression. For example, if an advertisement says a certain product is inexpensive without revealing that it will wear out very quickly, then the information is factually accurate yet deceptive. Any customer buying the product would be likely to end up spending more money rather than saving, because it would have to be

replaced so soon. Another ad might use camera tricks to create the visual impression of a juicy steak, because the unmanipulated image of the steak would look dry and unappealing. If the steaks being advertised are actually juicy, the ad is not deceptive even though the image is manipulated.

Socially responsible advertising should not promote or contribute to anything damaging to society. If an advertisement makes use of stereotypes, shows irresponsible practices, encourages irresponsible behaviors, or attempts to emotionally manipulate a(n) ____18____ audience such as children, then many would consider it to be socially irresponsible. Of course, most of these standards are a matter of opinion. Any advertising message could be considered emotionally manipulative depending on how you look at it, so in practice it comes down to a subjective assessment of what is appropriate and what is not. There is always a risk that your ad campaign could unintentionally offend customers.

Corporate social responsibility marketing is the practice of combining a company's charitable activities with its marketing campaigns. Instead of just writing a check to a selected charity, the company would tie the amount of the donation directly to sales, and would make the fundraising campaign the focus of its advertising. Corporate social responsibility can benefit the company in more than one way. It can improve the public perception of the company, increase sales and improve employee morale.

While donating money to charity is a positive activity for its own sake, corporate social responsibility marketing can backfire on a company if it is perceived as cynical by the public. For instance, if overuse of your product is associated with higher cancer rates and you run an ad campaign for cancer awareness, then some people might see the campaign as deceptive and unethical. The same thing can happen if your ad campaign raises money for environmental causes by selling a product with high carbon emissions or excessive packaging. Before you make social responsibility the theme of your advertising, you should first make sure there is no contradiction between your message and your business practices.

17. Which of the following statements best fits in the numbered space in the text?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Of course, there's nothing wrong with trying to emphasize the strengths of your products.

B) Though a little preposterous, it is possible to effectively advertise your products without having to tell any lies.

C) Otherwise, you might make the public very angry, which will affect your bottom line.

D) However, this requirement is not as straightforward as it may appear. ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) However, this requirement is not as straightforward as it may appear. ✓
- B) Otherwise, you might make the public very angry, which will affect your bottom line.
- C) Of course, there's nothing wrong with trying to emphasize the strengths of your products.
- D) Though a little preposterous, it is possible to effectively advertise your products without having to tell any lies.
-

18. Which of the following words best fits in the numbered space in the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) potential B) vulnerable ✓
- C) valued D) underprivileged

原始的选项顺序

- A) valued B) potential
- C) vulnerable ✓ D) underprivileged
-

19. What can we learn from the last two paragraphs?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Companies with social responsibility should look outside their businesses, find an important social cause, and

contribute to it.

B) Corporate social responsibility implies that businesses should give top priority to creating value and impact for their own businesses.

C) The theme of the corporate advertising is a decisive factor for people to decide whether a company is socially responsible.

D) Social responsibility marketing is a way for a company to give back to both the society and themselves. ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) The theme of the corporate advertising is a decisive factor for people to decide whether a company is socially responsible.

B) Corporate social responsibility implies that businesses should give top priority to creating value and impact for their own businesses.

C) Companies with social responsibility should look outside their businesses, find an important social cause, and contribute to it.

D) Social responsibility marketing is a way for a company to give back to both the society and themselves. ✓

Questions 20-22 (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and decide whether the following statements are

True, False, or Not Given.

Job loss is hard for everyone, of course. But recovering from it tends to be harder and to take longer for members of disadvantaged groups. Women and minorities typically spend more time looking for new jobs, and the jobs they find generally pay less than the ones they left. So if you lay off women and minorities disproportionately, you don't just hurt them; you also slow the overall economic recovery. Moreover, recent research has shown that companies that remained inclusive during the Great Recession (in terms of diverse workers' experience and representation in different ranks) did better financially during and after it.

So how can you avoid turning the economic recession into a diversity recession?

Keep track of your lists. Events are happening fast, and managers are often unaware of the diversity implications of their layoff lists. Go over your lists to ensure that your decisions do not disproportionately hurt women, minorities, or any other group that just happens to be concentrated in the targeted jobs. Follow this expert recommendation: Spread reductions evenly across the board. In its 2011 layoffs, Nokia formed selection committees to make its layoff lists so that it could avoid acting on the basis of local managers' favoritism and blind spots. In my research, I have found that the executives who keep track of

the numbers managers submit retain managerial diversity amid layoffs.

Think about what people can contribute, not just what jobs they hold. Take stock of more than position and tenure. Look at performance evaluations, which may reveal that you're about to let some high performers go. Companies that factor performance into their decision-making, I've found, end up keeping their best performers, regardless of gender and race. And in doing so, they better maintain their diversity.

Redeploy talent to areas that need strengthening. During the Great Recession, Southwest Airlines did not need job recruiters—a female-dominated position. But to avoid getting rid of employees with good interpersonal skills, it redeployed recruiters to frontline customer-service jobs. As the economy recovered, those workers transitioned back to their original jobs, ever more loyal to the company for keeping them on.

Cross-train and upskill workers. The question of how to maintain diversity in the face of job cuts is not new to retailers. A recent Walmart-funded report by FSG (a consulting firm) and PolicyLink (a national research and action institute) explains that reskilling frontline workers instead of laying them off minimizes the costs and productivity losses associated with hiring new employees. Many retailers already cross-train so that workers can more flexibly fill different functions and prepare for changing environments. Including women and minorities in these efforts during the recession will help you keep your best performers and your diversity.

20. Diversity and inclusion are not only at the heart of corporate culture, they also become the ultimate goal of successful businesses.

- A) True B) False C) Not Given ✓

答案 : C

21. The writer does not think companies should lay off their employees at the cost of diversity.

- A) True ✓ B) False C) Not Given

答案 : A

22. Companies should redeploy women recruiters to areas that need their talents during recessions to boost employee loyalty.

- A) True B) False ✓ C) Not Given

答案 : B

Questions 23-25 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

“The most important thing in the Olympic Games is not winning but taking part.”

Like many celebrated quotes, the words themselves have become considerably more famous than the person who uttered them—in this case, a French aristocrat, Baron Pierre de Coubertin. By profession an educational theorist, Coubertin is better known today as the father of the modern Olympics.

Coubertin's passionate belief in the moral example of the ancient tournament eventually led to the first modern Summer Olympics, held in Athens, Greece, in 1896. A far cry from today's slick and heavily marketed events, the games were steeped in Coubertin's deep knowledge of, and passion for, classical culture, and his conviction that "the essential thing in life is not conquering but fighting well."

In the run-up to the 1896 Athens games, heated debates in the International Olympic Committee centered on "professionalism" versus "amateurism" in sport. The committee finally decided that only "non-professional" athletes could compete in the Olympic Games, and that there would be no cash prizes. Led by Coubertin, it outlined its vision of an event that promoted peace, understanding, and friendship between peoples.

On the surface such notions seem praiseworthy. All too often the "amateur spirit," however, was a screen for class prejudice. Athletes of humble origins who had benefited financially from sport, found themselves penalized or even barred from the Olympics. The most famous example is American athlete Jim Thorpe, who was stripped of his medals following the 1912 games for having previously played semiprofessional baseball.

This bias stayed on the rule books for almost a century. Following the 1988 games the Olympic organizers bowed to mounting pressure, and agreed to allow professional athletes to compete in most categories. To some this was a regrettable departure from the "purity" of the games so lauded by Coubertin.

The notion of the gentleman amateur gained in strength in the early part of the 20th century, in part inspired by the work of the British historian E. Norman Gardiner (1864–1930). Gardiner reconstructed the history of Greek sport as a process of rise and fall, beginning with the “spontaneous, aristocratic sport” of Homeric heroes and culminating in the “golden age” of Greek sport in 500–440 B.C.

Greek sport then fell into a long period of decadence, which Gardiner attributed to the introduction of professionalism. This had brought about an unhealthy increase in the honors and financial rewards athletes could win. The outcome was that professional athletes from the lower classes and less “civilized” parts of the Greek world gradually gained a physical advantage. Aristocrats had to stop taking part in sporting competitions or rather had to stick solely to equestrian events, entry into which required considerable financial investment. But it was not the rider or charioteer who was declared the victor but rather the owner of the chariot and horses.

Gardiner maintained that there were two emphatically different stages in the history of Greek sport: a pure initial period in which noblemen clashed solely to prove their worth on the one hand, and a decadent, corrupt period in which members of the lower classes competed for money and privileges, on the other. A 2016 research, based largely on studies by the Dutch historian Henri W. Pleket, has challenged this view. Ancient Greek sport, researchers have

found, did involve large sums of money and was, in fact, unashamedly bound up with social and political influences from a surprisingly early stage.

23. Which of the following statements about Coubertin CANNOT be inferred from the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) He was named the father of the modern Olympics for reviving the ancient event.
- B) He objected to the commercialization of the Olympic Games.
- C) He thought amateurism was a good way to eliminate class prejudice. ✓
- D) He valued the social responsibility of the Olympic Games.

原始的选项顺序

- A) He valued the social responsibility of the Olympic Games.
 - B) He objected to the commercialization of the Olympic Games.
 - C) He thought amateurism was a good way to eliminate class prejudice. ✓
 - D) He was named the father of the modern Olympics for reviving the ancient event.
-

24. Which of the sentences below best fits in the blank?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Then how did the Olympic Games gradually transform from amateurism to professionalism?
- B) But was it necessary to remove the word “amateur” from the rules, making it easier for athletes of lower classes to find financial support?
- C) Then what eventually led to the disappearance of amateurism from the Olympic Games?
- D) But were the Olympic athletes of antiquity really the noble, disinterested amateurs that so many believed them to be? ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) Then what eventually led to the disappearance of amateurism from the Olympic Games?
- B) Then how did the Olympic Games gradually transform from amateurism to professionalism?
- C) But were the Olympic athletes of antiquity really the noble, disinterested amateurs that so many believed them to be? ✓
- D) But was it necessary to remove the word “amateur” from the rules, making it easier for athletes of lower classes to find

financial support?

25. What can we learn from Gardiner's study of the ancient Olympic Games?

考试时的选项顺序

A) The ancient Olympic Games were not accessible to the non-noble athletes at first.

B) Professionalism led to the decadence of the ancient Olympic Games. ✓

C) The financial, social and political influences on sport began earlier than expected.

D) Most events in the ancient Olympic Games required massive capital investment.

原始的选项顺序

A) Professionalism led to the decadence of the ancient Olympic Games. ✓

B) The ancient Olympic Games were not accessible to the non-noble athletes at first.

C) Most events in the ancient Olympic Games required massive capital investment.

D) The financial, social and political influences on sport began earlier than expected.

Questions 26-27 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

When confronting a situation freighted with anxiety and ambiguity—a pandemic, a recession, a job loss, an unwanted family change—most of us can imagine no upside. We become paralyzed, caught in a state I call *unproductive uncertainty*.

When threatened with unproductive uncertainty, we may become so focused on the immediate situation that we overlook the broader possibilities. This not only creates disquiet but can also lead us to make rash decisions or forgo opportunities because we don't even recognize them. Psychologists call this tendency to miss the bigger picture status quo bias, big-fish-small-pond effect, and relative deprivation.

One of my favorite illustrations of how narrow thinking leads to poor decisions comes from Malcolm Gladwell. Examining why university students choose to pursue STEM degrees (science, technology, engineering, and math), he found that at a typical U.S. university, students whose SAT scores put them among their school's top third had a 50% chance of pursuing a STEM degree, while those in the bottom third had only a 15% chance of doing so. He argued that the bottom third looked around, realized they weren't as smart as their peers, and so chose easier majors. But when he analyzed SAT scores and STEM degrees among Harvard students, he found the same distribution. Why? Because human nature leads us to make decisions on the basis of our lived

experience rather than with an eye on the bigger picture. The lowest-scoring Harvard students are certainly smart enough to succeed in STEM disciplines, but they can't see that bigger picture and thus don't give themselves the chance. By contrast, the innovators I studied have learned to look for possibilities where others can't imagine them.

If we can remember there is a context vaster than we might initially have thought, filled with more possibilities than we might have envisioned, we are much more likely to find an optimal outcome. Most important, with that broader mindset we can *weather* the discomfort of unproductive uncertainty with greater optimism and calm. That's true whether the uncertainty relates to relatively small issues, such as missing a flight and wondering what to do with the unanticipated extra time, or to larger ones, such as losing a job and having to rethink our direction and priorities. We're able to recognize that even in worst-case scenarios, we have options marked by great beauty and recovery.

26. Which of the following better defines the big-fish-small-pond effect?

A) Equally able students will have lower academic self-concepts in selective schools than in less selective schools. ✓

B) Students in selective schools will have higher academic self-concepts compared to those who have comparable ability but attend regular schools.

答案 : A

27. What does the word *weather* in the last paragraph probably mean?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Suffer. B) Describe. C) Predict. **D) Survive. ✓**

原始的选项顺序

A) Predict. **B) Survive. ✓** C) Suffer. D) Describe.

Questions 28-30 (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

Directions: Read the excerpt from *Global Catastrophes: A Very Short*

Introduction (2006) by Bill McGuire and answer the questions according to it.

Global warming is about much more than hotter summers, winter floods, and farting cows. There is absolutely no question that the Earth is warming up fast, and few climate scientists would argue with this. The dispute lies in whether or not the warming we are now experiencing simply reflects a natural turnabout in the recent global temperature trend or results from the polluting impact of human activities since the industrial revolution really began to take hold. What I find extraordinarily irresponsible is that this dispute continues to be presented, at least in some circles, as a battle between two similarly sized and equally convincing schools of scientific thought, when in fact this is far from the case. Forecasting climate change is extremely difficult, which explains why models for future temperature rise and sea-level change are constantly undergoing revision, but the evidence is now irrefutable: Human activities are driving the

current period of planetary warming.

Notwithstanding a few maverick scientists, oil company apologists, and the president of the world's greatest polluter, the overwhelming consensus amongst those who have a grasp of the facts is that without a reduction in greenhouse gas emissions things are going to get very bad indeed. Amazingly, this prospect is still played down and intentionally hidden behind a veil of obfuscation by some, most recently by the—in my opinion—self-deluded Danish statistician, Bjorn Lomborg. In his widely savaged book, *The Skeptical Environmentalist*, Lomborg denigrates global warming and its future impact, while at the same time, through highly selective references to scientific research, coming to the conclusion that all is right with the world. Just in case you have come across this work and been lulled by its friendly, do-nothing message into a false sense of security, let me bring you back to reality, if I may, with a few pertinent facts.

During the past 70 years, the Earth has been hotter than at any other time in the last millennium, and the warming has accelerated dramatically in just the past few decades. No doubt everyone has at least one older relative who is constantly harking back—through a rose-tinted haze—to a time _____29_____. Meteorological records show, however, that this is simply a case of selective memory, and in fact 19 of the hottest years on record have occurred since 1980, with the late 1990s seeing the warmest years of all across the planet as a whole. The Earth is now warmer than it has

been for over 90 per cent of its 4.6 billion year history, and by the end of the twenty-first century our planet may see higher temperatures than at any time for the last 150,000 years.

The rising temperature trend we are seeing now is not simply a climatic blip or hiccup, nor can it be explained entirely, as some would still have it, by variations in the output of the Sun, although this clearly does have a significant effect on the climate. Rather, it is a consequence of two centuries of pollution, which is now enclosing the Earth in an insulating blanket of carbon dioxide, methane, nitrous oxide, and other greenhouse gases. Since the late eighteenth century our race has been engaged in a gigantic planetary trial, the final outcome of which we can still only guess at. Unfortunately for us the experiment has now entered a runaway phase, which, due to its inherent inertia, we cannot immediately stop but only slow down. Even if we were to stabilize greenhouse gas emissions today, both temperatures and sea levels would continue to rise for many hundreds of years. The big question of our time is—do we have the resolve to do even this or will we run from the problem and let the devil take the hindmost?

28. Which of the following is NOT true according to the text?

考试时的选项顺序

A) We cannot deny that the changes in solar radiation have made a major contribution to the rising temperature. ✓

- B) Bjorn Lomborg underestimated the potential influence of global warming although he cited scientific research.
- C) The author disapproves of the debate on the cause of global warming between two similarly sized schools.
- D) Because of the inertia, people can hardly put an end immediately to the impact brought by global warming.

原始的选项顺序

- A) The author disapproves of the debate on the cause of global warming between two similarly sized schools.
- B) Bjorn Lomborg underestimated the potential influence of global warming although he cited scientific research.
- C) We cannot deny that the changes in solar radiation have made a major contribution to the rising temperature. ✓
- D) Because of the inertia, people can hardly put an end immediately to the impact brought by global warming.
-

29. Which of the following best fits in the blank in Paragraph 3?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) when summers were hotter and the skies bluer ✓
- B) when both summers and winters were much cooler
- C) when pollution was not as severe as it is now

D) when human activities were fewer

原始的选项顺序

A) when both summers and winters were much cooler

B) when pollution was not as severe as it is now

C) when summers were hotter and the skies bluer ✓

D) when human activities were fewer

30. What is the text mainly about?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Why our experiment is out of control.

B) How hot the weather is compared to the past.

C) How human activities speed up planetary warming.

D) What is under debate about global warming. ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) How hot the weather is compared to the past.

B) What is under debate about global warming. ✓

C) How human activities speed up planetary warming.

D) Why our experiment is out of control.

Directions : In Part III, you will read passages on the same subject. You will be required to identify the writer's position and evaluate the effectiveness of the writer's arguments. (Time allowed: 35 minutes)

Questions 31-40 (Suggested completion time: 35 minutes)

Directions: Read three passages about coffee and health. Answer the questions according to the passages.

Passage A

Caffeinated drinks—such as coffee, tea, soda, and energy drinks—pep you up temporarily, but they may have a more insidious effect. They may worsen depression, insomnia, and anxiety.

Caffeine and depression.

Several studies have looked at caffeine intake and depression. For example, one study found that, among healthy college students, moderate and high coffee drinkers scored higher on a depression scale than did low users. Interestingly, the moderate and high coffee drinkers also tended to have significantly lower academic performance. There is a reason for this effect and it relates to the chronic effects of caffeine on the brain.

Other studies have implicated that depressed patients tend to consume fairly high amounts of caffeine (e.g., greater than 700 mg/day, or about 7 cups of coffee). In addition, caffeine intake has been positively correlated with the

severity of symptoms in psychiatric patients, especially related to panic disorders and depression.

Caffeine affects cortisol levels (the stress hormone). In one study, researchers gave healthy men and women different doses of caffeine throughout the day and found that the caffeine spiked their cortisol levels.

Caffeine and sugar can be a bad combo.

The combination of caffeine and refined sugar seems to be even worse than either substance consumed alone. Several studies have found a strong association between this combination and depression. In one study published in *Behavior Therapy*, 21 women and 2 men responded to an advertisement requesting volunteers “who feel depressed and don’t know why, often feel tired even though they sleep a lot, are very moody, and generally seem to feel bad most of the time.”

After baseline psychological testing, the subjects were placed on a caffeine- and sugar-free diet for one week. The subjects who reported substantial improvement were then given either a capsule containing caffeine and a Kool-Aid drink sweetened with sugar, or a placebo capsule containing cellulose and a Kool-Aid drink sweetened with an artificial sweetener, for up to six days.

About 50% of the test subjects became depressed during the period where they were getting caffeine and sucrose. The reason? Researchers believe it’s because caffeine worsens blood sugar control and when combined with sugar,

causes blood sugar volatility that really stresses out the brain.

Caffeine may impact sleep.

Large amounts of caffeine can also negatively affect circadian rhythm and sleep cycles, which can result in feelings of depression.

I'd advise anyone who is prone to depression, insomnia, anxiety, or any psychological disorder to avoid caffeine as much as possible. If you can cut sugar out of your diet too, even better.

Passage B

The mood enhancing effects of coffee are unquestioned. Just ask anyone—literally anyone—who has ever had a cup of coffee in the morning about the burst of can-do productivity they feel about halfway through that first cup. You gotta ride that wave and get the majority of your work done before it wears off. But coffee may also have significant benefits on serious mental health issues as well. A new study finds that _____ 34 _____.

For the study, which can be found via the National Coffee Association, Harvard Medical School professor of neurology Dr. Alan Leviton performed meta-analysis of a variety of current research available on the topic and included over 300,000 participants, more than 8,000 of those experiencing depression. Dr. Leviton found that those who “consumed higher levels of coffee were at lower risk of depression than people who consumed less or no

coffee,” with coffee’s “peak protective effect appeared to be among those who consumed 400 ml/day (i.e., 13 ounces).”

Of the research used in the meta-analysis, one study, performed as part of the Korean National Health and Nutrition Examination survey, found that those who drank two or more cups of coffee a day had a “32% lower prevalence of self-reported depression” than those who didn’t drink coffee at all. Another study, this one examining over 14,000 graduates at the University of Navarra in Pamplona, Spain, found that participants who consumed four or more cups daily had a “significantly lower risk” of experiencing “physician-diagnosed depression worthy of antidepressant medication.”

Though the exact mechanisms are unknown, Dr. Leviton suggests five possible explanations. Both coffee’s anti-oxidative and anti-inflammatory properties are given as potential reasons for the phenomenon. The reasons being, per the study, are that “blood levels of oxidative-stress indicators are raised in people who have a major depressive disorder,” and that “depressed people tend to have higher blood levels of inflammation-related proteins than people who are not depressed.” Other potential explanations include caffeine, which in mice “reduces the occurrence of helpless-like and motivational behaviors that are characteristic of mouse models of depression.” Coffee’s positive effects on the gut microbiome as well as the bowels are mentioned as possible factors as well.

While coffee is truly a magical elixir, it is no substitute for actual medical advice from a professional. So if you are experiencing any symptoms of depression, reach out to a medical professional. But keep drinking coffee. They aren't mutually exclusive.

Passage C

California might soon start requiring Starbucks to warn its customers that coffee causes cancer. Has California gone nuts, or is there something to this?

A lawsuit filed in 2010 by a group called the Council for Education and Research on Toxics is in its final stages, and the judge might rule soon unless the defendants settle the case. Several of the defendants, including 7-Eleven, have already settled and agreed to post warnings in their stores.

The basis for the lawsuit is that brewing hot coffee produces acrylamide (丙烯酰胺), which is on a list of substances that California claims cause cancer or reproductive toxicity. (It's a very long list.) Even though acrylamide has been on the list since 1990, it wasn't until 2002 that Swedish scientists discovered that acrylamide is present in many foods.

As the American Cancer Society (ACS) explains, "Acrylamide is found mainly in plant foods, such as potato products, grain products, or coffee. Foods such as French fries and potato chips seem to have the highest levels of acrylamide."

Uh oh. Coffee, French fries, and potato chips. Where's the joy in life without these?

But wait a second: How come people aren't keeling over with cancer left and right, especially in our coffee-loving, french-fry-loving society? (And what about the French?)

It turns out the evidence against acrylamide is pretty *sketchy*. If you give it to mice in the lab, at doses 1,000 times greater than the amounts found in food, it does seem to increase their risk of cancer. But mice are not people, and 1,000 times is a whole lot of acrylamide. The ACS concludes that "it's not yet clear if acrylamide affects cancer risk in people."

It's just as easy to find claims that coffee prevents cancer. A 2017 review found that one cup of coffee a day is associated with a slight reduction in the risk of liver cancer and endometrial cancer. A 2010 review of over 500 studies found the same reductions, but a slight increase in the risk of bladder cancer among heavy coffee drinkers. Another large review in 2017, by Robin Poole and colleagues in the UK, found not only a reduced risk of cancer, but a reduction in heart disease and overall mortality.

The Poole study concluded: "Coffee consumption seems generally safe within usual levels of intake, with the largest risk reduction for various health outcomes at three to four cups a day, and more likely to benefit health than harm."

Coffee lovers, rejoice! But let's not kid ourselves: No one is drinking coffee for its health benefits, are they? The stuff just tastes good.

Finally, in answer to my own question at the top of this article: Yes, California has gone a bit nuts. Or, as the nonprofit American Council on Science and Health put it: "If coffee is deemed carcinogenic, then the State of California will be required to give up all pretense at common sense and sanity."

An afterthought: The lawsuit may be just about money. As *Bloomberg News* explained, in a story about the California coffee case: "Unfortunately, it is very easy for 'bounty hunters' to file Prop. 65 (Proposition 65, a California voter initiative designed to help Californians make informed decisions about protecting themselves from chemicals that could cause cancer, birth defects, or other reproductive harm.) lawsuits against even small businesses and the cost of settlement and defense often exceeds other types of abusive litigation." The American Council on Science and Health was even more blunt, calling it an attempt to grab "a giant bag of money."

Let's hope the judge in the California case pays attention to the science. Meanwhile, the rest of us can focus on more important questions, such as: Dark roast or light? French press or drip?

31. According to Passage A, what is the relation between caffeine and depression?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Caffeine has been found to stimulate human stress hormone. ✓

B) Caffeine causes depression and brain damage for heavy coffee drinkers.

C) Caffeine has a positive influence on the patients suffering depression.

D) Heavy coffee drinkers tend to show lower performance, resulting in depression.

原始的选项顺序

A) Caffeine causes depression and brain damage for heavy coffee drinkers.

B) Heavy coffee drinkers tend to show lower performance, resulting in depression.

C) Caffeine has a positive influence on the patients suffering depression.

D) Caffeine has been found to stimulate human stress hormone. ✓

32. According to Passage A, why can caffeine and sugar be a bad combo?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Because people taking diet with caffeine and sugar

generally seem to feel bad.

B) Because a caffeine- and sugar-free diet brings great improvement to the subjects.

C) Because the combination causes blood sugar swings that increase stress on the brain. ✓

D) Because a combo of caffeine and sugar makes people tired and even sleepy.

原始的选项顺序

A) Because a combo of caffeine and sugar makes people tired and even sleepy.

B) Because people taking diet with caffeine and sugar generally seem to feel bad.

C) Because a caffeine- and sugar-free diet brings great improvement to the subjects.

D) Because the combination causes blood sugar swings that increase stress on the brain. ✓

33. What is the best title for Passage A?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Combo of Caffeine and Sugar—Big Destroyer to Mental Health

B) Can Caffeine Worsen Depression and Anxiety? ✓

C) Keep away from Caffeinated Drinks

D) What Should We Know About Caffeine?

原始的选项顺序

A) What Should We Know About Caffeine?

B) Keep away from Caffeinated Drinks

C) Can Caffeine Worsen Depression and Anxiety? ✓

D) Combo of Caffeine and Sugar—Big Destroyer to Mental Health

34. Which of the following best fits in the blank in Passage B?

考试时的选项顺序

A) coffee has auxiliary functions in dealing with depression

B) drinking coffee protects people from negative emotions

C) moderate coffee drinking is beneficial to human health

D) coffee drinkers are less likely to suffer from depression ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) coffee drinkers are less likely to suffer from depression ✓

B) moderate coffee drinking is beneficial to human health

C) drinking coffee protects people from negative emotions

D) coffee has auxiliary functions in dealing with depression

35. What can be learned from Dr. Leviton's explanations in Passage B?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Coffee has positive effects on humans both mentally and physically.

B) Coffee can prevent the rising of the levels of oxidative-stress indicators. ✓

C) The experiment on mice proved that coffee can highly motivate people.

D) Inflammation-related proteins are major contributors of depression.

原始的选项顺序

A) Coffee can prevent the rising of the levels of oxidative-stress indicators. ✓

B) Inflammation-related proteins are major contributors of depression.

C) The experiment on mice proved that coffee can highly motivate people.

D) Coffee has positive effects on humans both mentally and physically.

36. According to Passage C, why might 7-Eleven post warnings in their stores?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Because Starbucks was required to warn its customers about the harm of coffee.

B) Because acrylamide was determined as a harmful substance in California. ✓

C) Because 7-Eleven reached a compromise with the plaintiff in the lawsuit.

D) Because the Council for Education and Research on Toxics lost the case.

原始的选项顺序

A) Because Starbucks was required to warn its customers about the harm of coffee.

B) Because 7-Eleven reached a compromise with the plaintiff in the lawsuit.

C) Because the Council for Education and Research on Toxics lost the case.

D) Because acrylamide was determined as a harmful substance in California. ✓

37. According to Passage C, the word *sketchy* in Paragraph 7 probably means _____.

考试时的选项顺序

- A) acceptable and appropriate in a particular situation
- B) causing or entirely worthy of ridicule or derision
- C) not complete or strict and thus not very useful ✓
- D) able to persuade people to believe a particular thing

原始的选项顺序

- A) acceptable and appropriate in a particular situation
 - B) able to persuade people to believe a particular thing
 - C) not complete or strict and thus not very useful ✓
 - D) causing or entirely worthy of ridicule or derision
-

38. It can be inferred from Passage C that _____.

考试时的选项顺序

- A) the reviews of studies prove that coffee lowers the risk of getting cancer
- B) acrylamide was not discovered in plant foods such as coffee until 2002
- C) the American Cancer Society is dissatisfied with the State of California

D) the California coffee case probably reflects a kind of abusive litigation ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) the reviews of studies prove that coffee lowers the risk of getting cancer

B) acrylamide was not discovered in plant foods such as coffee until 2002

C) the California coffee case probably reflects a kind of abusive litigation ✓

D) the American Cancer Society is dissatisfied with the State of California

39. Which of the following is NOT true concerning Passage A and Passage B?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Both passages state the close relation between coffee and depression.

B) Passage B doesn't mention any negative impact of drinking coffee.

C) Passage A emphasizes the negative effects of coffee on human health.

D) Both passages are written in a subjective style, stating

personal opinions. ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) Passage A emphasizes the negative effects of coffee on human health.

B) Passage B doesn't mention any negative impact of drinking coffee.

C) Both passages state the close relation between coffee and depression.

D) Both passages are written in a subjective style, stating personal opinions. ✓

40. Which of the following is true about the three passages?

考试时的选项顺序

A) All the authors agree that coffee is safe within moderate levels of intake.

B) The mood enhancing effect of coffee is recognized in all the passages.

C) None of the authors try to dissuade everyone from drinking coffee. ✓

D) All the three passages cite experiments in which mice were tested.

原始的选项顺序

- A) All the three passages cite experiments in which mice were tested.
- B) The mood enhancing effect of coffee is recognized in all the passages.
- C) All the authors agree that coffee is safe within moderate levels of intake.
- D) None of the authors try to dissuade everyone from drinking coffee. ✓

2020 阅读大赛初赛 (2020 年 10 月 11 日)

Directions : In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Questions 1-3 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following quotes. Match the quotes with the people.

Please note there are two extra options you do not need.

- A. Winston Churchill
- B. William Blake
- C. George Washington
- D. Stephen Hawking
- E. Plato

1. However difficult life may seem, there is always something you can do and succeed at. D

答案 : D

2. We make a living by what we get, but we make a life by what we give. A

答案 : A

3. Wise men speak because they have something to say; Fools because they have to say something. E

答案 : E

Question 4 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

“Going green” starts at home, and you don’t have to completely change the way you live to make a difference. Living more sustainably has a lot to do with making _____ changes. You can start with simple things like turning lights off when you leave a room, taking shorter showers, and not using as much hot water.

4. The missing word may be _____.

A) subtle ✓ B) constant C) affordable D) fundamental

答案 : A

Question 5 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

McGill’s Scholarships and Student Aid Office offers a merit-based Entrance Scholarship Program and a need-based Entrance Bursary Program for all newly accepted, first-year, first-degree undergraduate students. All students are encouraged to explore the full range of funding opportunities available to them. We also highly recommend our Frugal Scholar Money Management Program that can help you with financial planning and debt management.

5. Where is the text most probably taken from?

考试时的选项顺序

A) A student manual. ✓ B) A bank notice.

C) School safety regulations. D) A school financial report.

原始的选项顺序

A) School safety regulations. B) A student manual. ✓

C) A bank notice. D) A school financial report.

Question 6 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Applying theories of animal and human behaviour to robot technology, a psychologist working with robot scientists at Manchester University is helping a robot balance better.

“Robots are yet to match the abilities of those in science fiction hits like *Star Wars* and *Blade Runner*, and none have mastered walking on two feet,” says psychologist Warren Mansell, lead author of this study.

6. What is the writer’s main purpose?

考试时的选项顺序

A) To show scientists’ efforts in developing robots.

B) To state the improvements of the robots with cross-disciplinary skills. ✓

C) To explain why robots cannot balance themselves.

D) To express the expectations of future robots from a psychologist’s view.

原始的选项顺序

- A) To show scientists' efforts in developing robots.
- B) To explain why robots cannot balance themselves.
- C) To state the improvements of the robots with cross-disciplinary skills. ✓
- D) To express the expectations of future robots from a psychologist's view.

Question 7 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Sustainability in fashion is a hot button topic, with retailers large and small racing to prove their green credentials, but the desire for new attire churns and the industry remains one of the world's largest polluters as climate activists and watchdogs sound alarms.

The industry is the second largest consumer of water and is responsible for 8-10% of global carbon emissions, more than all international flights and maritime shipping combined, according to the United Nations Environment Program.

Harmful chemicals, global transport of goods, and non-biodegradable packaging add to the environmental cost. The combined impact has put the industry under scrutiny among consumers who want to know where—and how—their clothes are produced. They're demanding ethical practices and responsible retailing.

7. What is the text mainly about?

考试时的选项顺序

A) The high environmental cost of fashion industry. ✓

B) The green revolution of fashion industry from top to bottom.

C) The key propelling force of slowing down fashion industry.

D) The pioneer of sustainability in fashion industry.

原始的选项顺序

A) The pioneer of sustainability in fashion industry.

B) The high environmental cost of fashion industry. ✓

C) The key propelling force of slowing down fashion industry.

D) The green revolution of fashion industry from top to bottom.

Question 8 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

An owl's supposed wisdom is based on the shape of its face. We have an instinctive emotional connection to the child-like appearance of animals and birds with large eyes, so maybe we imbue it with human qualities like wisdom or intelligence. The owl also has to turn its head to stare, giving the impression of undivided attention.

However, it isn't among the social birds, which are considered intelligent.

These include crows and other corvids, starlings and house sparrows, which have all shown problem-solving ability, and parrots, which can associate words and phrases with objects and events. Many social birds have a wide vocabulary including calls for certain predators. Some even learn to dupe rivals by mimicking predators' calls to scare other birds away from food sources.

Owls are mainly solitary. While they are marvellously adapted predators, their behaviour is very hardwired, and their vocalisation limited. Owls have many special attributes, but being avian *eggheads* isn't one of them.

8. What does the word *eggheads* probably mean in the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Intelligent animals. ✓ B) Versatile animals.
C) Social animals. D) Adaptable animals.

原始的选项顺序

- A) Social animals. B) Versatile animals.
C) Adaptable animals. D) Intelligent animals. ✓

Question 9 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the lecture notice and answer the question according to the notice.

Congress Hall, London

TBC

PLEASE NOTE: Due to government advice, we have decided to **postpone this event**. We are rescheduling this event to a later date and will publish the new date as soon as possible.

When we think of autism we usually think of challenges and deficits. We talk about how autistic people might have issues with communicating, difficulty making friends or understanding other people. Recently, we have started to understand that there are also many strengths linked to autism.

Join leading cognitive scientist, **Anna Remington**, and multi-award winning and internationally recognised teen autism campaigner **Siena Castellon**, for an evening exploring the gifts and challenges of autism including a Q+A session with our speakers. You will be guided through the evening by a **New Scientist** host.

9. Which of the following is most likely the topic of the lecture?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) How to cure autism?
- B) Pioneers of the autism movement.
- C) Latest research into autism.
- D) Is autism a gift? ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) Is autism a gift? ✓

B) How to cure autism?

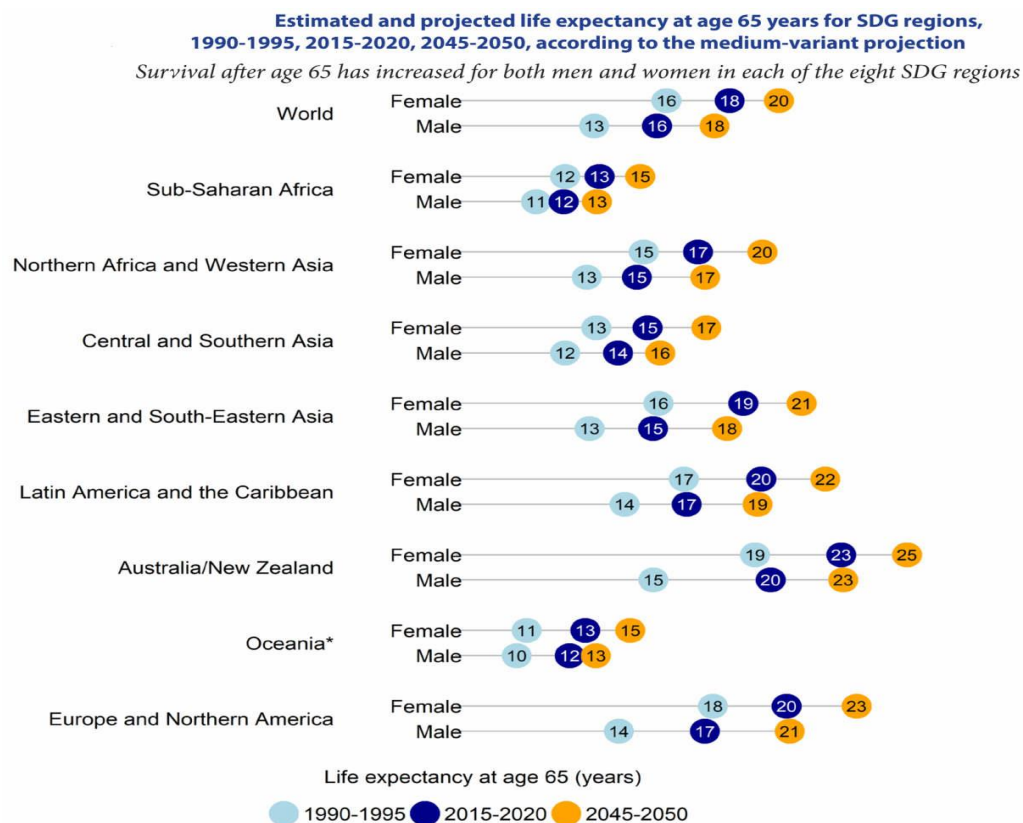
C) Pioneers of the autism movement.

D) Latest research into autism.

Question 10 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Throughout most of the world, survival at older ages is improving.

The life expectancy at age 65 reflects the average number of additional years of life a 65-year-old person would live if subjected to the age-specific mortality risks of a given period throughout the remainder of his or her life. Study the following figure and answer the question according to the information in the figure.



Data source: United Nations, Department of Economic and Social Affairs, Population Division (2019). *World Population Prospects 2019*.
* excluding Australia and New Zealand

Note: SDG regions refer to those regions used in *The Sustainable Development Goals Report*

10. Which of the following is INCORRECT according to the figure?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) In 2015-2020, life expectancy at age 65 has increased to 20 years for women and 17 years for men in Latin America and the Caribbean and it is to increase further.
- B) Globally, between 1990 and 1995, 65-year-old women could expect to live an additional 16 years and 65-year-old men an additional 13 years.
- C) In 1990-1995 and the present period, the largest absolute gains in survival past age 65 were observed for men and women in Australia/New Zealand.
- D) In 2045-2050, survival after age 65 for both men and women in Northern Africa and Western Asia is expected to exceed the world level. ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) Globally, between 1990 and 1995, 65-year-old women could expect to live an additional 16 years and 65-year-old men an additional 13 years.
- B) In 1990-1995 and the present period, the largest absolute

gains in survival past age 65 were observed for men and women in Australia/New Zealand.

C) In 2045-2050, survival after age 65 for both men and women in Northern Africa and Western Asia is expected to exceed the world level. ✓

D) In 2015-2020, life expectancy at age 65 has increased to 20 years for women and 17 years for men in Latin America and the Caribbean and it is to increase further.

Directions : In Part II, you will read short texts on different subjects. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 55 minutes)

Question 11 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following definition of a logical fallacy. Answer the question according to the definition.

Ad Fidentia

Ad Fidentia is a fallacy to attack the person's self-confidence in place of the argument or the evidence.

11. Which of the following provides a typical example of *Ad Fidentia*?

考试时的选项顺序

A) If Lander makes us buy a parking sticker, soon there will be separate parking facilities for faculty and students. And the next thing you know, we won't be able to find a parking space.

B) You say that aliens didn't build the pyramids. How can you be so sure? Do you have a degree in Egyptology? ✓

C) I can't stop eating these chocolates. I really love chocolate, or I seriously lack willpower. I know I really love chocolate; therefore, I cannot lack willpower.

D) Sarah did not want to eat liverwurst for dinner, but her mother told her to think of all the starving children in the world who do not have food at all.

原始的选项顺序

A) You say that aliens didn't build the pyramids. How can you be so sure? Do you have a degree in Egyptology? ✓

B) I can't stop eating these chocolates. I really love chocolate, or I seriously lack willpower. I know I really love chocolate; therefore, I cannot lack willpower.

C) Sarah did not want to eat liverwurst for dinner, but her mother told her to think of all the starving children in the world who do not have food at all.

D) If Lander makes us buy a parking sticker, soon there will be separate parking facilities for faculty and students. And the next thing you know, we won't be able to find a parking space.

Question 12 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the example of a logical fallacy and answer the question according to the example.

Yes, teacher, I think that lying is wrong, but she is my daughter, and she is normally such a good kid!

12. Which of the following logical fallacies does the example illustrate?

考试时的选项顺序

A) **Corrupt Source:** It is a fallacy which occurs when untrue information attributed to the source is used to support a proposition.

B) **Special Pleading:** It is a fallacy to involve a person applying rules and standards to others while exempting him- or herself, that is using double standards to excuse an individual or group. ✓

C) **Equivocation:** It is a type of ambiguity in which a single word or phrase is ambiguous, which contrasts with amphiboly, which is grammatical ambiguity.

D) **Black-or-White:** It is a fallacy which occurs in arguments that have a disjunctive premise—that is, one that gives alternatives—when one or more alternatives are incorrectly omitted. The fallacy tries to force you to choose either black or

white when gray is an available alternative.

原始的选项顺序

A) **Black-or-White:** It is a fallacy which occurs in arguments that have a disjunctive premise—that is, one that gives alternatives—when one or more alternatives are incorrectly omitted. The fallacy tries to force you to choose either black or white when gray is an available alternative.

B) **Special Pleading:** It is a fallacy to involve a person applying rules and standards to others while exempting him- or herself, that is using double standards to excuse an individual or group. ✓

C) **Equivocation:** It is a type of ambiguity in which a single word or phrase is ambiguous, which contrasts with amphiboly, which is grammatical ambiguity.

D) **Corrupt Source:** It is a fallacy which occurs when untrue information attributed to the source is used to support a proposition.

Questions 13-14 Reasoning (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

13.

Global warming may allow deadly jellyfish, now mostly found in tropical and subtropical waters, to conquer new turf in temperate

waters as sea surface temperatures rise. People die each year from jellyfish stings, far more than from encounters with other marine creatures, including sharks. That could be a big blow for tourism. Many species of fish are known to dine on jellyfish, while jellyfish prey on fish eggs and, occasionally, on fish themselves. So in order to help the tourism, some politicians appealed to the fishermen to catch as many fish as possible within a mile of the beaches.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the appeal in the text?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Overfishing is actually one of the chief suspects in the rise of jellyfish. ✓

B) Even if not all the jellyfish are killed, the appeal would reassure tourists.

C) Tour agencies are willing to pay the cost of implementing the appeal.

D) Not all tourists enjoy swimming, so jellyfish isn't a vital reason for the fall of the tourism.

原始的选项顺序

A) Tour agencies are willing to pay the cost of implementing the appeal.

B) Even if not all the jellyfish are killed, the appeal would

reassure tourists.

C) Overfishing is actually one of the chief suspects in the rise of jellyfish. ✓

D) Not all tourists enjoy swimming, so jellyfish isn't a vital reason for the fall of the tourism.

14.

Rice prices have risen in some countries during the coronavirus pandemic. With restaurants closed, people have been eating at home more than ever. It can be concluded that rice producers have been artificially inflating prices and governmental price regulations are necessary to control rising prices.

Which of the following, if true, casts the most doubt on the conclusion drawn above?

考试时的选项顺序

A) The dry season starts in November and usually lasts through April, curbing rice production in many areas. ✓

B) Rice prices rose several times last year, though never before at the rate recently observed.

C) The government has demanded that rice farmers use new technological instruments.

D) Technological improvement in rice growing and harvesting has decreased production costs.

原始的选项顺序

A) The dry season starts in November and usually lasts through April, curbing rice production in many areas. ✓

B) Rice prices rose several times last year, though never before at the rate recently observed.

C) Technological improvement in rice growing and harvesting has decreased production costs.

D) The government has demanded that rice farmers use new technological instruments.

Questions 15-16 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

Women are making progress in the C-suite (the group of officers of a business organization who have the word “chief” in their titles), where the percentage of women has increased from 17% to 21% over the last five years. That increase may seem small, but it does show that many companies have added women to the C-suite: Today, 44% of companies have three or more women in their C-suite, up from 29% in 2015.

“The average top team has one, two or three women now,” says Lareina Yee, a senior partner at McKinsey, who is the company’s chief diversity and inclusion officer. “Even though that is not a full step to gender equality, we think it’s really important because when you have women at the most important decision-making table weighing in, that matters for companies.”

Yee says this small increase in representation at the top can also have *ripple effects*.

“When you think about the women in the organization, someone who’s a first manager or a V.P., she can look up at the top and see role models, and women doing it. She’ll have more confidence that she can as well.”

Another sign that progress could continue to close the gap: Women are still asking for promotions and negotiating salaries at the same rate as men, which has been the case for the past five years.

And not only are more companies offering paternity leave, as opposed to just maternity leave for women, but more men are also taking that time off. In 2019, the report found, men were roughly as likely as women to take leave when they became a new parent.

“That is a step in the right direction because you actually want all of your employees to be able to take time for families,” Yee says.

15. What does Yee mean by *ripple effects*?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Women workers will have stronger desire for personal promotions. ✓

B) Women workers will gain more confidence in themselves.

C) Women workers will be better represented in their company.

D) Women workers will make more contribution to their company.

原始的选项顺序

A) Women workers will gain more confidence in themselves.

B) Women workers will be better represented in their company.

C) Women workers will make more contribution to their company.

D) Women workers will have stronger desire for personal promotions. ✓

16. What is the best title for this text?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Persistent problems with the gender gap

B) Importance of having women executives

C) Progress to close the leadership gap ✓

D) Benefits of gender equality for companies

原始的选项顺序

A) Progress to close the leadership gap ✓

B) Persistent problems with the gender gap

C) Importance of having women executives

D) Benefits of gender equality for companies

Questions 17-19 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

Childhood education in ancient Greece was highly dependent on one's gender.

Preparing for life in the public sphere, wealthy boys during the classical period went to schools where they faced both physical and mental challenges.

Relegated to the private sphere, girls' educations were typically haphazard, often occurring at home, if they occurred at all.

In the fifth century B.C., Greece's greatest minds were preoccupied with the most effective ways to raise children. Isocrates, a Greek rhetorician and contemporary of Plato, boldly proclaimed what he saw as Greece's leadership in education: "_____ 17 _____."

The teaching that Isocrates praised was known by Greeks as *paideia*, a term derived from *pais*, the Greek word for child. In ideal terms, *paideia* was intended to allow male children to purge the baser parts of human nature so they could achieve the highest moral state. _____ 18 _____, it

also provided society with well-prepared men to take on the political and military burdens of citizenship as adults.

Paideia, however, was not intended for female children. Generally, only wealthy families could afford the full range of educational opportunities, and in nearly all cases, those children were boys. Most daughters, even well-off ones, received an informal education at home. In classical Greece, women were not educated for service in public life, as only men could be citizens. Although evidence has come down of some important exceptions, in general the role in life allotted to girls was in the home.

_____19_____. Child-rearing customs that developed in Greece's Archaic period, from the eighth century B.C. onward, were restricted to a tiny elite of young male aristocrats. They centered on rules and moral dictums—the respect that one owed to parents, the gods, and strangers, for example.

As the literature of Homer spread through the Greek world, the heroes of the *Odyssey* and the *Iliad* were held up as examples to inspire young men. A prized quality in the Homeric hero was *arete*, a blend of military skill and moral integrity.

With the Homeric foundation, scholars began to develop more complex ideas around education. In the fifth century B.C., around the time of Socrates, a new kind of professional teacher, the Sophist, became popular in Athens. Teaching their students rhetoric and philosophy, Sophists infused the traditional values

of *arete* with a new spirit of intellectual inquiry. It is during this period that the word *paideia* is first found. The movement advocated higher education for young Athenian men starting around the age of 16.

17. Which of the statements below best fits in the numbered space in the text?

考试时的选项顺序

A) The ancient Greek was a large school and a large workshop of art with the earliest and most far-reaching model of childhood education.

B) The main function of education is not to put knowledge into the soul, but to bring out the latent talents in the soul by directing it towards the right objects.

C) So far has Athens left the rest of mankind behind in thought and expression that her pupils have become the teachers of the world. ✓

D) The basic pursuit of the education of the Athenian state is to create the best possible citizen for the benefit of the community and not for his own personal development.

原始的选项顺序

A) So far has Athens left the rest of mankind behind in thought and expression that her pupils have become the teachers of the world. ✓

- B) The main function of education is not to put knowledge into the soul, but to bring out the latent talents in the soul by directing it towards the right objects.
- C) The basic pursuit of the education of the Athenian state is to create the best possible citizen for the benefit of the community and not for his own personal development.
- D) The ancient Greek was a large school and a large workshop of art with the earliest and most far-reaching model of childhood education.
-

18. Which of the expressions below best fits in the numbered space in the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- | | |
|----------------------|---------------------------|
| A) In terms of scale | B) On rare occasions |
| C) In a positive way | D) On a pragmatic level ✓ |

原始的选项顺序

- | | |
|----------------------|---------------------------|
| A) In a positive way | B) In terms of scale |
| C) On rare occasions | D) On a pragmatic level ✓ |
-

19. Which of the sentences below best fits in the numbered space in the text?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) The theory of paideia encompassed all efforts by the

state, parents and instructors in making young Athenians worthy citizens.

B) The content of paideia was gradually enriched as elite education faced increasingly more challenges.

C) The objective of paideia was to instruct and induce young Athenians to become virtuous by embracing certain ethical values.

D) The notion of paideia did not suddenly emerge in the time of Isocrates, but developed slowly over time. ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) The content of paideia was gradually enriched as elite education faced increasingly more challenges.

B) The notion of paideia did not suddenly emerge in the time of Isocrates, but developed slowly over time. ✓

C) The objective of paideia was to instruct and induce young Athenians to become virtuous by embracing certain ethical values.

D) The theory of paideia encompassed all efforts by the state, parents and instructors in making young Athenians worthy citizens.

Questions 20-21 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

I've taught dozens of people to play the guitar, and I've learned to predict who will learn to play well: those who enjoy the atrocious music they produce as a beginner.

If people tell me in the first session how they picture themselves being applauded for their great skill or how they want to be famous and play in a rock band, I know there is heavy sledding ahead. They are a long way from any such outcome, and grasping at it will make learning the basics that much harder, because immediate consequences dominate over delayed consequences.

Whatever goal we try to achieve, our first steps will most likely be less than perfect. There will be a lot of stumbling, falling, and dragging ourselves along. This is normal and natural. And yet our minds often judge us for falling short of what we think our progress should be. We convince ourselves that success is an end state, rather than an ongoing process of learning, and we catch ourselves buying into thoughts like: "I will feel confident when I marry an attractive spouse." "I will no longer struggle with the pain of my childhood when I'm famous." "I will stop worrying about the future when I have a lot of money." "My anxiety and self-doubts will go away when I get a promotion."

We deflect our attention away from the intrinsic value of our current efforts (including the learning we can gain from our stumbles) and focus on the need

of achievement and what it will mean to us—all in order to satisfy our yearning for competence.

We all yearn to be able to act effectively in the world: to live, love, play, and create skillfully. That starts at birth and babies will work for many, many hours learning to do the simplest thing. It's good we arrive that way—we have so much to learn.

But then symbolic reasoning and problem-solving show up and by kindergarten, the mind is already trying to satisfy this yearning, by focusing on the end result of competence, rather than on the individual small steps along the way.

Ironically, this often leaves us feeling overwhelmed and scared, and undermines our pursuit of competence by leading to procrastination or even workaholism.

If we truly want to achieve our goals, we need to *pivot* the yearning for competence toward building habits of values-based actions that are truly meaningful to us, while allowing for trial and error, instead of waiting to spring forth from the head of Zeus. And it's easier than you might think.

20. Which of the following is closest to what the writer intends to convey in this text?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Compared to the desire for competence, the inherent

value of your efforts along the way is what really counts. ✓

B) The key to success is being passionate about what you're doing and always give it your all.

C) The starting point of all achievements is a desire to be the best one can possibly be.

D) Success is a peaceful mind, a direct result of self-satisfaction in knowing you've achieved the best you are capable of.

原始的选项顺序

A) The starting point of all achievements is a desire to be the best one can possibly be.

B) Compared to the desire for competence, the inherent value of your efforts along the way is what really counts. ✓

C) The key to success is being passionate about what you're doing and always give it your all.

D) Success is a peaceful mind, a direct result of self-satisfaction in knowing you've achieved the best you are capable of.

21. What does the word *pivot* in the last paragraph probably mean?

考试时的选项顺序

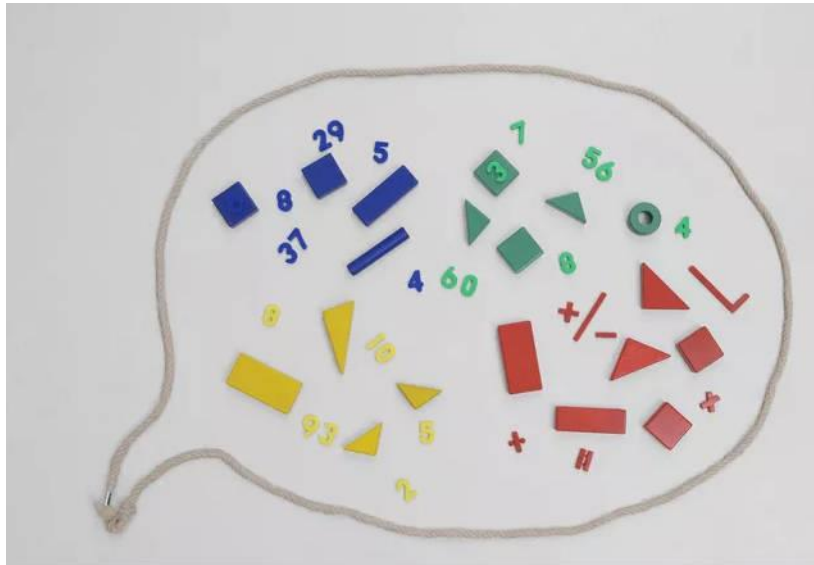
A) Commit. B) Provoke. C) Divert. ✓ D) Subdue.

原始的选项顺序

A) Commit. B) Divert. ✓ C) Subdue. D) Provoke.

Questions 22-24 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.



Mathematics is called the language of science. Italian astronomer and physicist Galileo Galilei is attributed with the quote, "Mathematics is the language in which God has written the universe." Most likely this quote is a summary of his statement in *Opere Il Saggiatore*:

[The universe] cannot be read until we have learnt the language and become familiar with the characters in which it is written. It is written in mathematical language, and the letters are triangles, circles and other geometrical figures, without which means it is humanly impossible to comprehend a single word.

Yet, is mathematics truly a language, like English or Chinese? To answer the question, it helps to know what language is and how the vocabulary and

grammar of mathematics are used to construct sentences.

What Is a Language?

There are multiple definitions of “language.” A language may be a system of words or codes used within a discipline. Language may refer to a system of communication using symbols or sounds. Linguist Noam Chomsky defined language as a set of sentences constructed using a finite set of elements. Some linguists believe language should be able to represent events and abstract concepts.

Whichever definition is used, a language contains the following components:

There must be a **vocabulary** of words or symbols.

Meaning must be attached to the words or symbols.

A language employs **grammar**, which is a set of rules that outline how vocabulary is used.

A **syntax** organizes symbols into linear structures or propositions.

A **narrative** or discourse consists of strings of syntactic propositions.

There must be (or have been) a group of people who use and understand the symbols.

Mathematics meets all of these requirements. The symbols, their meanings, syntax, and grammar are the same throughout the world. Mathematicians, scientists, and others use math to communicate concepts. Mathematics describes itself (a field called meta-mathematics), real-world phenomena, and abstract concepts.

The Argument Against Math as a Language

Not everyone agrees that mathematics is a language. Some definitions of “language” describe it as a spoken form of communication. Mathematics is a written form of communication. While it may be easy to read a simple addition statement aloud (e.g., $1 + 1 = 2$), it’s much harder to read other equations aloud (e.g., Maxwell’s equations). Also, the spoken statements would be rendered in the speaker’s native language, not a universal tongue.

However, sign language would also be disqualified based on this criterion. Most linguists accept sign language as a true language. There are a handful of dead languages that no one alive knows how to pronounce or even read anymore.

A strong case for mathematics as a language is that modern elementary-high school curricula use techniques from language education for teaching mathematics. Educational psychologist Paul Riccomini and colleagues wrote that students learning mathematics require “a robust vocabulary knowledge base; flexibility; fluency and proficiency with numbers, symbols, words, and diagrams; and comprehension skills.”

22. What does Galileo Galilei’s statement in *Opere Il Saggiatore* indicate?

考试时的选项顺序

A) The universe is humanly incomprehensible without a language.

B) In the study of the universe, mathematics is the most powerful tool.

C) Scientists use mathematics to communicate their concepts about the universe.

D) Mathematics is a language for mankind to understand the universe. ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) The universe is humanly incomprehensible without a language.

B) Mathematics is a language for mankind to understand the universe. ✓

C) In the study of the universe, mathematics is the most powerful tool.

D) Scientists use mathematics to communicate their concepts about the universe.

23. What is the author's purpose of including the example of sign language in this text?

考试时的选项顺序

A) To give readers more insights into this topic.

B) To defend the argument for mathematics as a language.

✓

- C) To stretch the definition of language.
- D) To show his argumentation is objective.

原始的选项顺序

- A) To show his argumentation is objective.
- B) To give readers more insights into this topic.
- C) To defend the argument for mathematics as a language.

✓

- D) To stretch the definition of language.
-

24. What can we learn from Paul Riccomini and his colleagues?

考试时的选项顺序

- A) Mathematics learning requires extensive reading.
- B) The techniques for learning mathematics are effective in language education.
- C) A good command of a language facilitates mathematics learning.

D) The way we learn a language can be applied to mathematics learning. ✓

原始的选项顺序

- A) Mathematics learning requires extensive reading.

B) A good command of a language facilitates mathematics learning.

C) The way we learn a language can be applied to mathematics learning. ✓

D) The techniques for learning mathematics are effective in language education.

Questions 25-26 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Read the two texts and decide whether the following statements are True or False according to the two texts.

It is too simplistic to say that cutting livestock numbers everywhere is the most efficient way of reducing emissions, as your article suggests (Governments urged to set deadlines for cutting livestock production, 12 December, 2019). The world's livestock systems differ too significantly for them to be generalised, and doing so hinders the countries that are practising sustainable farming methods and which have an ambition to do even more.

Compared with the mass-scale intensive systems in the US or Brazil, our livestock systems are unrecognisable. British farmers do not clear rainforest to make way for beef production. Our meat does not come from the ashes of the Amazon. We value our carbon sinks.

Grazing cattle is the most sustainable way to use the 65% of UK farmland that is unsuitable for growing any other crop. It is hugely beneficial for the soil, helps lock up carbon, and is the best way to turn inedible grass into highly

nutritious protein for a growing population to enjoy.

What's more, British farmers have an ambition to become net zero by 2040.

We want to lead the way in climate-friendly meat and dairy and pave the way for others to follow. This needs to be recognised.

—Stuart Roberts

Vice-president, NFU (National Farmers Union)

Damian Carrington (*The Guardian's* Environment editor) is correct that people in wealthy countries need to eat less meat. But to make targets for reductions in meat consumption is to put the cart before the horse. Excessive meat production is a symptom, not a cause, of the problem. Once we start to eliminate the use of fossil fuels, economic forces will reduce livestock numbers to sustainable levels because there will be increased demand for land for biomass, and because artificial fertilisers will almost certainly be in short supply.

Until that happens there is a danger that focusing on meat and livestock will be a futile distraction from the task at hand which is to put an end to the use of fossil fuels.

—Simon Fairlie

The Land magazine

25. Both Stuart Roberts and Simon Fairlie agree on the adverse impact livestock has on the environment.

A) True B) False ✓

答案 : B

26. Simon Fairlie thinks what really counts now is not to reduce meat production but to stop using fossil fuels.

A) True ✓ B) False

答案 : A

Questions 27-28 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

There are a few key industries that serve as pillars of the United States economy: transportation, agriculture and manufacturing. Moving things, growing things and making things. Each of these industries is poised to evolve enormously from new technology. Some have already begun adopting new and improved methodologies.

Those involved in industrial production have long been involved in installing sensors on factory equipment and taking measurements. Useful for predictive failure analysis, plant maintenance and safety issue mitigation, this production-based Internet of Things (IoT) technology has been called “machine to machine” communication or “M2M” for short. The concept of embedded technology is not new to the industrial sector, but the applications of such data gathering are still being fully realized.

Manufacturing was the catalyst for a global economic overhaul in the mid-16th and early 17th century. Industrial innovation allowed for the (semi) automation of previously manual tasks, increasing the efficiency of production exponentially. It's no surprise, then, that new technologies such as sensors and networks are eagerly adopted by manufacturing to improve yields, reduce rework and produce more goods faster.

The new domain of IoT involves embedding sensors, software and connectivity directly into the products being manufactured. Here again, the results can be used for predictive failure analysis, maintenance and safety issues, but at the individual device level. Indeed, IoT can be used both in the device itself as well as in the factory where it is produced.

For example, imagine a well-known appliance manufacturer is able to determine, within seconds, the impending failure of a critical machine on the production line. They could dispatch workers to repair the device before it reaches critical failure, or schedule work off-shift to minimize the impact on the day's output.

Similarly, imagine they are working to embed sensors in the more failure-prone elements of the appliances. By offering connectivity through home Internet, products can link back to customer service agents who can, if necessary, proactively ship replacement parts and schedule service calls for appliances which may soon fail. Thus, the manufacturer is able to not only produce a superior product but to produce that product in a superior manner.

27. What is the major change in the new domain of IoT?

考试时的选项顺序

A) It allows manufacturers to implant sensors in individual products. ✓

B) It can estimate when errors may occur in the manufacturing process.

C) It can automate manufactured products without human control.

D) It helps to keep factory equipment in good condition.

原始的选项顺序

A) It can estimate when errors may occur in the manufacturing process.

B) It can automate manufactured products without human control.

C) It helps to keep factory equipment in good condition.

D) It allows manufacturers to implant sensors in individual products. ✓

28. Which of the following benefits of IoT is NOT mentioned in this text?

考试时的选项顺序

A) It can address machine failures before they actually

happen.

B) It helps increase productivity and reduce the chances of repetitive work.

C) It can translate customer data into better mode of production.

D) It is very helpful to companies from product design to testing to launch. ✓

原始的选项顺序

A) It can address machine failures before they actually happen.

B) It can translate customer data into better mode of production.

C) It is very helpful to companies from product design to testing to launch. ✓

D) It helps increase productivity and reduce the chances of repetitive work.

Questions 29-30 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the excerpt from *Global Catastrophes: A Very Short Introduction* by Bill McGuire and answer the questions according to it.

Imagine the worst possible vision of hell. The vile stench of sulphurous gas pervading a world of darkness broken only by a dull red glow on a distant, invisible horizon. Heavy, grey ash pours from above like gritty snow, clogging the eyes, nose, and ears as swiftly as you can remove it. Choking and retching you ram your fingers into your mouth to try and gouge out the ashy slime that forces its way in with every struggling breath, but to no avail. Suddenly a blinding flash reveals the nightmare landscape of Tolkien's Mordor—all familiar features blotted out and buried by ash accumulating at half a metre an hour. A titanic crash of thunder heralds the return of the darkness and the onset of a truly biblical deluge. Within seconds the ashy drifts are transformed into rushing torrents of mud that almost sweep your feet from under you. As the falling rain and ash combine, you are battered by pellets of mud that begin to weigh you down under a sticky, ever-thickening carapace of Vulcan's ordure. There is no sign that the Sun ever bathed the landscape in its warming rays, but it is far from cold. In fact, your body is slowly roasting in the stifling heat of nature's own oven, your sweat sucking you dry as it drains from every pore to mix with the muddy rivulets covering every inch of your skin.

However awful it might sound to those of us who live far from the slopes of an erupting volcano, there is nothing usual about the above scene. But what if it was enacted 1,500 kilometers from the eruption? Then it really would be something very special, because it would mean that the Earth was being rent by one of nature's greatest killers—a volcanic super-eruption. These gigantic

blasts dwarf even the greatest eruptions of recent times, and in comparison the cataclysmic detonation that blew Krakatoa (Indonesia) apart in 1883, killing around 36,000 of the inhabitants of Java and Sumatra, pales into insignificance.

Fortunately for us, super-eruptions are far from common, and it is estimated that throughout the last two million years of Earth history, there have been perhaps two such blasts every hundred millennia. The last such cataclysm shattered the crust at Taupo in New Zealand's North Island, 26,500 years ago. This, however, does not mean we can sit back and relax for another 24 millennia or so. Like buses, natural phenomena display scant regard for a timetable, so another super-eruption could be with us in 10 years—or even 100,000 years down the line. The really scary thing, however, is that, unlike 'normal' volcanic blasts, there is no possibility of avoiding the devastating consequences of a volcanic super-eruption. Those of us tucked away in the most geologically friendly countries will still find our cosy world turned upside down by the next super-eruption, even if it occurs in a distant land on the other side of the planet. This is because of the severe impact it will have on the climate, the ash and gas ejected high into the atmosphere dramatically reducing the solar radiation reaching the surface and triggering a freezing volcanic winter worldwide.

29. How many allusions are used when the author depicts the worst possible vision of a volcanic super-eruption?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Four B) One C) Three ✓ D) Two

原始的选项顺序

A) One B) Two C) Three ✓ D) Four

30. Which one of the following best states the author's main point of this text?

考试时的选项顺序

A) Super-eruptions have severe impact on human beings

who live near the volcanoes.

B) The worst possible vision of a volcanic super-eruption is

like a hell.

C) Super-eruptions are rare yet we can't wait for the dreadful
disaster to happen. ✓

D) The next super-eruption may occur in a hundred millennia
or anytime soon.

原始的选项顺序

A) The worst possible vision of a volcanic super-eruption is

like a hell.

B) The next super-eruption may occur in a hundred millennia
or anytime soon.

C) Super-eruptions are rare yet we can't wait for the dreadful

disaster to happen. ✓

D) Super-eruptions have severe impact on human beings who live near the volcanoes.

Directions : In Part III, you will read passages on the same subject. You will be required to identify the writer's position and evaluate the effectiveness of the writer's arguments. (Time allowed: 35 minutes)

Questions 31-40 (Suggested completion time: 35 minutes)

Directions: Read three passages about the relationship between art and science. Answer the questions according to the passages.

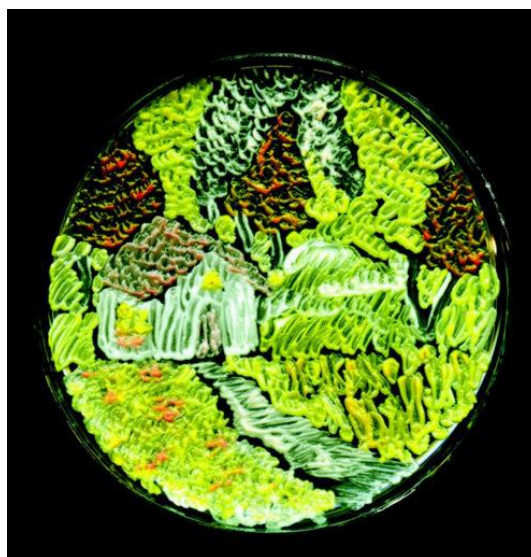
Passage A

The sciences are a mixture of many disciplines. To most, it would be a strange combination. Science is usually seen as rigid and analytical, while art is viewed as free-flowing and abstract. The fact is, the two are in a *sympiotic* relationship. The sciences need people who can be creative and artistic in design. As a result, art finds new ways to be seen in our world. I am both a photographer and a biology major, so I see how they can be intertwined every day.

When I first met with my research adviser, she asked what my skills outside of the sciences were. I mentioned my passion for photography as well as my time writing for the Odyssey, an online writing community. She immediately said I would be good at designing experiments. Being creative in each field of science means offering a new perspective that one might have thought of

being useful before. For example, high speed photography was used to determine why we smell an earthy aroma after it rains. Art always provides us with new ways to visual data, scenarios and so much more as well.

After finishing a presentation in my photographer class, my professor remarked, “You can certainly tell you are a biology major from these photos.” To some, that could come across as an insult, but to me, it was a huge compliment. The theme for the project had been “Black and White” and I chose to do it on infrared photos of the plants in my university’s greenhouse. As both a biologist and a photographer, I wanted to show a unique perspective on a common subject. The picture (___32___) is a close-up photo of an orchid’s labellum that was a part of my project. Nobody realized it was part of an orchid until I explained how I took the photo. It was something new and it was because of my background in biology that I thought it could be used artistically.



Another contribution art receives from scientific advancement is the addition of new media to present their ideas. As from new photographic techniques like infrared and physiograms, new “scientific” arts have become popular online. The most notable would most likely be microbial art like the photo above. Perhaps the most famous example would be the microbial take on Van Gogh’s *Starry Night*. There is obviously a multitude of techniques and media artists and scientists can use to create imaginative works of art.

The arts and sciences need each other. Both types of intelligence should be fostered in our children equally as the others. Maybe it is time we add an “A” to STEM (science, technology, engineering and mathematics). What is the point of being book-smart, but not being able to apply your knowledge in a creative manner to solve a problem? Uninventive art will not stand the test of time. Science and art are deeply related. There is no way around it.

Passage B

A great deal of creativity is required to make scientific breakthroughs, and art is just as often an expression of (or a product of) scientific knowledge. Consider the science behind mixing paint in the correct proportions, or creating perspective in a drawing, or even imagining the dance of a quark.

Visual art has been used to document the natural world for thousands of years, from cave drawings of animals that help today’s researchers figure out

yesterday's fauna, to paintings of centuries-old experiments that show us how they were conducted. One of the most famous examples of the interconnection between art and science is the work of Renaissance master Leonardo da Vinci.

While his *Mona Lisa* is probably the most famous portrait ever painted, da Vinci's scientific drawings are smaller in scale and intricately detailed and annotated; and they demonstrate that he was no less skilled as an inventor and researcher. In fact, da Vinci's talent as a bridge ____34____ was proven in 2001, when artist Vebjorn Sand built the da Vinci-Broen bridge in Norway using the artist's never-realized plans for a bridge meant to stretch across the Golden Horn in Istanbul. Rejected as an architectural impossibility by the Ottoman Sultan who commissioned it, the bridge was built 499 years after da Vinci designed it, proving the Sultan wrong.

While da Vinci conducted his own experiments and studies, other artists were keen to observe and document a rapidly evolving body of scientific knowledge. For instance, Rembrandt's painting *The Anatomy Lesson* depicts a scientist with a partially dissected corpse and a throng of interested spectators eager to understand the workings of the human body. Among the most interesting examples of the artist as ____35____ of scientific progress are the paintings of Joseph Wright of Derby, who worked at the close of the 18th century and was part of a small circle of intellectuals known as the Lunar Society (so-called because they met on the night of the full moon, so their horses could see the

way home).

Wright's famous painting, *A Philosopher Giving that Lecture on an Orrery, in which a Lamp is put in the Place of the Sun*, depicts an intimate gathering around a mechanical model of the solar system. Documenting the growing popularity of science among the public at large, the painting records a range of reactions to this marvel, from wonder to introspection.

Beyond the use of art to document scientific progress, Marianne North's paintings of tropical plants serve as both historic and scientific records. Active in the mid to late 19th century, North traveled extensively on her own, a feat unheard of at the time for a woman. She was never formally trained in painting, but with her talent and productivity, she produced over 800 paintings that currently hang in the Marianne North Gallery in Kew Gardens, London. Her work transcends traditional plant specimens, which are collected, dried, preserved in herbaria and used to establish a record of species.

While those samples document discovery and provide a necessary historic record, North's brilliantly colored paintings bring those species to life in their natural habitats as part of their ecosystems. Charles Darwin considered North's paintings to be excellent examples of his theory of natural selection. One can see quite clearly from her work the adaptations that tropical plants have made to survive in different areas around the world, and the similarities between geographically close species. North has maintained a legacy not only through her artwork but also through several species for which she provided

the first illustration and were later named after her.

Many examples of art intersecting with science exist around us, but these few highlighted here illustrate how art is crucial in helping us understand our scientific legacy and how science is well served by applying an artistic lens. Together, art and science help us interpret, study and explore the world around us.

Passage C

Admittedly, art and science take two different highways. Yet, they often go side by side in the same direction. What's more, there are connector paths that are already established between them.

Science and art can complement each other not on the basis of their similarities but rather on their differences, which allows for an inventive dialogue.

Linked by their end goal, that of the search for an understanding of the world and of life, scientists in their labs and artists in their studios can use their own specificity to reciprocally demonstrate the ethos of the other.

A scientist-artist, Zachary Copfer, combines a photographic process with biological practices to create unusual pieces of art.

The technique of "Bacteriography" is similar to the darkroom process in photography. However, it uses ultraviolet rays and a colony of living bacteria in a petri dish.

Copfer, who created amazing portraits of historical science and art figures, is not sure whether he's "a microbiologist masquerading as an artist, or an artist masquerading as a microbiologist".

The Materials Research Society (MRS), an organization that works for interdisciplinary dialogue between scientific societies, understands the artistic lining of science.

For about a decade, MRS has been holding the "Science as Art" challenge twice a year. At this event, scientists showcase their materials, such as nanoparticles and crystals, as stunning image artworks.

Falling between the two fields of art and science, art therapy is a discipline of the human sciences. It extends the field of psychotherapy by adding art as a tool in the healing process.

"Art Therapy" brings together several artistic practices (such as painting, dance, photography, etc.) which are used for therapeutic purposes along with scientific theories of psychology.

In all, the border between art and science has always been blurred. Although the development of specialization and the institutionalization of these fields has led to a minor separation in some areas of how art and science interact, it has not severed the ties completely.

In fact, it could be said that the links between science and art are closer than ever. Both studies are attempting to understand the universe either through introspective contemplation or through experimentation and study.

In a world that is only increasing in the speed at which society and, in turn, our reality is changing, science and art need to work together more than ever. Together, they can improve and develop the collective human consciousness.

31. The word *symbiotic* in the first paragraph of Passage A means closest to

_____.

A) cooperative

B) dynamic C) natural D) organic

✓

答案：A

32. Which is the picture that the author of Passage A refers to in Paragraph 3?



A)



B)

✓

C)



D)



答案：B

33. Which of the following statements can NOT be inferred from Passage A?

A) Art is a subject as important as STEM for elementary education.

B) Creativity is a must shared by scientists and artists.

C) Artistic talent is something to be valued among science majors. ✓

D) Science and art coexist and benefit each other in multiple ways.

34-35. Which two of the following words best fit in the numbered spaces in Paragraphs 3 and 4 of Passage B respectively?

- A. scientist
- B. painter
- C. recorder
- D. engineer

答案 : C

34. D

答案 : D

35. C

答案 : C

36. Which of the following statements shows the significance of Marianne North's paintings for science, according to Passage B?

A) They provide evidence for Darwin's theory of natural selection. ✓

B) They help scientists to discover more species in different areas.

C) They record the ecological environment, aiming to improve it.

D) They have made Marianne North both a scientist and an artist.

答案 : A

37. According to Passage C, what can we learn about Zachary Copfer?

A) He is a photographer but majors in biology.

B) His professional identity seems to be unclear to him. ✓

C) He is famous for his novel ways of experiment.

D) He likes portraits of historical celebrities.

答案 : B

38. Which of the following is NOT mentioned in Passage C?

A) Art and science have been mixed together for thousands of years. ✓

B) Both science and art help humans to understand the world.

C) The materials the scientists showed in “Science as Art” look like artworks.

D) “Art Therapy” uses art as a tool to heal patients.

39-40. Decide whether the statements are True or False according to the passages.

答案 : A

39. The three passages have reached one point in common: Science and art are mutually beneficial to each other.

A) True ✓ B) False

答案 : A

40. All of the three passages employ good examples of photos to illustrate the relationship between science and art.

A) True B) False ✓

答案 : B